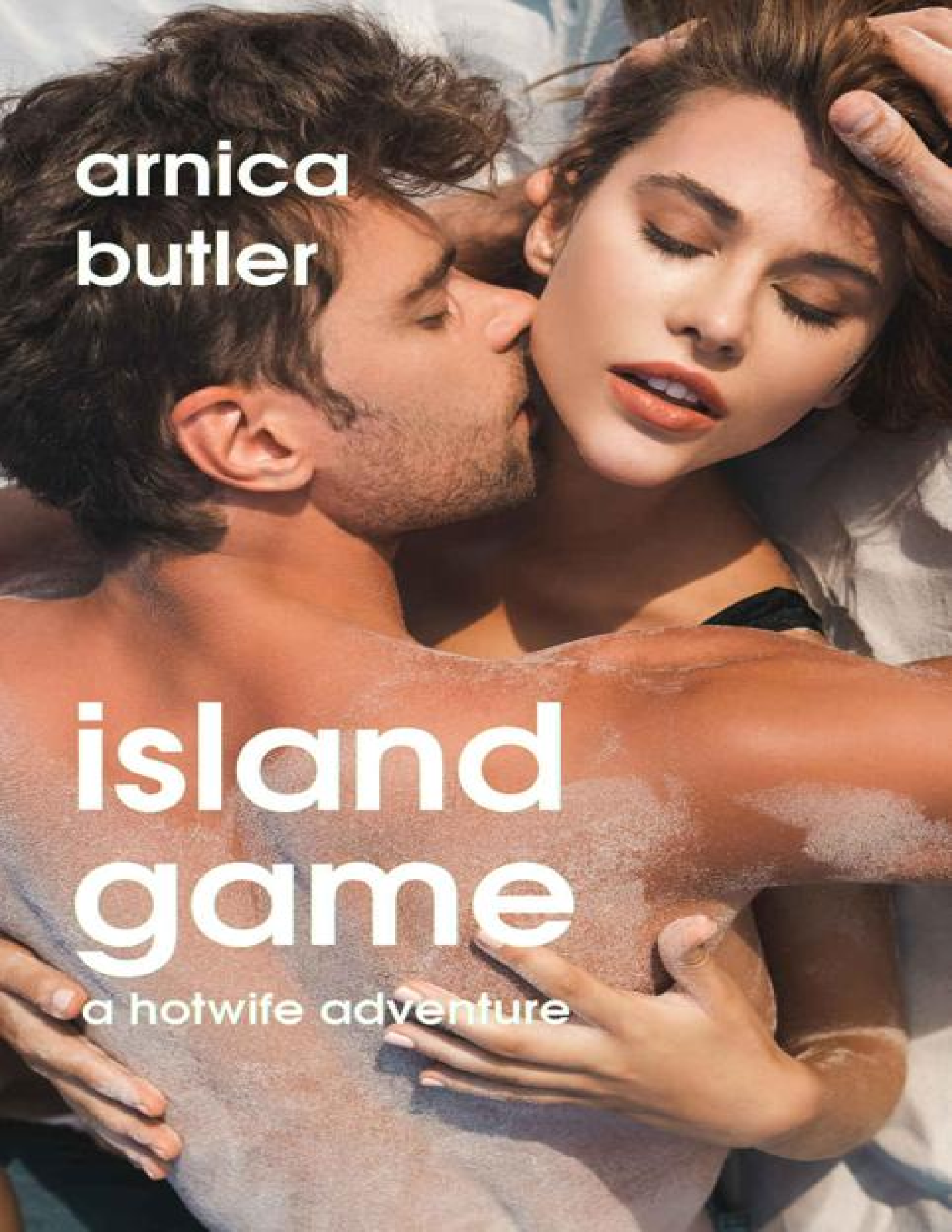


A romantic couple is shown in a close embrace. The man, on the left, is shirtless and has dark, wavy hair. He is leaning in to kiss the woman's cheek. The woman, on the right, has long, wavy brown hair and is wearing a black strapless top. She has her eyes closed and a soft smile. They are both covered in a light-colored, powdery substance, possibly sand or a cosmetic product, which is visible on their skin and hair. The background is a soft, out-of-focus blue and white, suggesting a beach or a tropical setting. The overall mood is intimate and sensual.

**arnica
butler**

island game

a hotwife adventure

ISLAND GAME

A HOTWIFE ADVENTURE

By Arnica Butler

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CHAPTER 1

The margarita descended into his field of vision, the stem invisible in the glow of the sun, the base shining like the contours of a spaceship, an orb of lime-yellow liquid above it. All ten of Emma's fingers gripped the rim from above like claws. "Incoming," she said dryly.

An ice-cold drop of water departed the mother ship and made him shiver when it touched the bare skin of his chest. Dane blinked, straining to see where to grip the drink, his vision adjusting to the brightness of the noonday sun. He had fallen into a beachy, half-sleeping stupor with a shirt over his face, and had a vague memory of Emma saying "Well, it's time for a margarita," her muffled footsteps in the sand fading away, and then returning.

But that could have been minutes, hours, or days ago.

When he heard her returning, his dreamlike state had only been partially dissolved. Sitting up, he realized he had overheated in the sun. His chest was damp with sweat.

"Thanks," he said, still blinking. Emma patted him on the head and he heard her footsteps in the sand, headed back to the bar. They had learned the hard way that the plastic stems of the margarita "glasses" snapped if you tried to hold the gigantic goblet by anything but the huge cup, until you had at least half the margarita finished, and even then, you were gambling.

Time returned to its normal pace, and Emma was right back, stepping over her lounge to plop into the chair and pull her feet together, which was also a technique for balancing the margaritas that she had learned the hard way.

Neither of them bothered making a joke about how stupid the margarita glasses were.

"No good prospects up there, either," she said. She stabbed at the icy drink with a straw, balancing the base of the cup on one slender thigh and holding the rest steady with her right hand. She brought the straw up to her mouth, one finger over the top of it, and then released the trapped liquid onto her tongue. "This might be a bust."

Dane's nose and forehead screamed at him as he gulped far too much margarita at once. He sucked in a deep breath of air and winced. "It's still...

a great... time... sweetie," he said, in a pained voice.

Emma lifted her sunglasses to her forehead and looked at him, shaking her head. "Why do you keep *doing* that?" she asked, laughing lightly. She dropped the sunglasses back onto her nose. "I *swear*."

A larger-than-usual wave made a crisp landing on the shoreline, almost as if to emphasize her point, which was that Dane was an idiot for giving himself a freeze-headache every time he started in on a new margarita.

"I need some water," Dane said. He set the margarita on a small table they had dragged from their rental house, specifically for this purpose, and released it like he was placing the final touch on an elaborate house of cards, which made Emma smile. More than one margarita had gone the way of the dodo because the table could not be placed level to save their lives. Or their drinks.

He stood up carefully. "Maybe you missed something."

Emma stabbed the drink mirthlessly. "Doubt it."

Dane gave a glance to the right and left of them, down and up the expansive, white sand beach. Hawaiian shirts fluttered away from white, whaleish bellies balanced over pale, hairy legs, as far as the eye could see. Isla Caza, as far as their plans went, had so far been a little disappointing.

It's what you get, he thought, more amused at this point than anything, when you let yourself be sucked in by Airbnb "porn."

"Get me one, too," Emma said, as he walked toward the bar.

There was, at least, nothing to complain about with regard to their rental, which was a luxury home they had obtained for a steal - \$300 a night more than any other house on the beach, but it had its own pool and they admittedly felt pretty baller. You could have a decent stay in Isla Caza for \$50 a night, but for \$350 you could have a whole villa and an infinity pool.

It was an absolutely gorgeous vacation spot, if you were up to doing nothing more than lying on the beach, drinking margaritas, and relaxing.

Which, Dane and Emma had decided with resignation on their third day, was probably all they would get up to in Isla Caza, because the hunting was terrible. And it was too bad. This was the first time they were going to use a particular ploy, and the possibilities had excited them both.

There just weren't very many... good options. The bartender *might* have been game, but someone seemed to have informed him that trying to fuck vacationers' wives on their honeymoon was going to cost him his job.

In a place where the average income probably hovered around \$10K a year, it was unlikely that even Emma, and all her delights, would lure the bartender to risk his job, and the tips that came with it.

Dane bought two waters and returned to their spot on the beach. The shade of the palm tree had shifted, and he started to drag his lounge chair away.

"*She's* here," Emma commented.

Dane had already seen her. It was unfortunate *she* was a she, because a male version would have been nice to have around. "She" didn't have a male counterpart, either, which served to fuel Dane and Emma's curiosity. That, and the fact that there wasn't much else to be curious about.

When they both looked over at her - taking no pains to hide what they were doing - she was laying out her sarong. A sarong that, it seemed, was all she ever brought with her to the beach, other than a bottle of baby oil.

She was currently shaking her lengthy mane of blond-streaked hair as she reached behind herself to untie her bikini.

"She's going to do the oil," Emma teased Dane.

The mystery woman's skimpy black bikini had been freed from her torso, and her full, grapefruit-sized breasts, with an appealing natural teardrop shape and wide aureole the color of milk chocolate, were free. Emma brought another straw-full of margarita to her mouth as she watched, which Dane found arousing, because it didn't take much for his mind to connect Emma's lips closing around the straw, to Emma's lips closing around one of the erect, chocolate-chip nipples in the center of Mystery Woman's breasts.

The woman was, as expected, pouring clear baby oil on her arms, working a sheen all over her toasted almond skin.

The beach wasn't necessarily topless, but the woman had an attitude of not giving a shit. So far, no one seemed scandalized, except perhaps for the one-piece-clad wives of the white whales beneath the Hawaiian shirts, but if those ladies were glaring, they were doing it surreptitiously.

The woman sat, rubbed her breasts with both hands, and rolled down slowly, revealing incredible core strength. She shifted, her breasts jiggling alluringly, and then lay still. She would probably remain there for hours, before sitting up, making herself shiny again, and lying face down to even it out.

"I wonder what she's doing here," Dane said, for what seemed like the hundredth time.

Emma wriggled into her lounge again, sunglasses down. "Probably staying at a great house and wondering where all the people her age are. Like us." She sipped her margarita.

"You should go talk to her," Dane suggested.

Emma laughed, dismissively, which was a routine they had gotten into. Emma flirting with girls wasn't really their thing, and it wasn't even Dane's thing in some secret part of his mind. But he figured that, like him, almost every guy was at least open to the idea of seeing his wife slither around in baby oil with another hot woman.

Especially when his usual fantasy - the one Emma happily catered to - did not look like it would materialize any time soon.

This time, however, Emma's laugh ended abruptly, and she closed her mouth. Dane couldn't see if her eyes were open behind her sunglasses. Her lips curled into a smile - Emma's devious smile - and she said: "Huh. Maybe I will, actually."

Dane raised his eyebrows and wriggled awkwardly into his own chair. "Really," he commented.

"Maybe she's *local*," Emma said. "Maybe she knows where some... more interesting people are."

There was a silence between them as they settled into drinking their margaritas and watching the waves. They had decided the day before that all was not lost: the beach was lovely, they were having a nice vacation anyway. Opportunity seemed very unlikely to present itself, and they had scoured the island in vain searching for it.

"She probably *is* where the interesting people are," Dane said, after a very long pause.

Emma rolled her head toward him. Her mouth was formed into a very funny shape she used to indicate that she didn't know what he was talking about, without saying anything.

It was a private joke between them, with a lengthy origin. Even though they had no sound, Dane had always heard sounds when he saw .gifs. Emma had enjoyed calling him crazy and dedicated a great deal of time proving to him that they did not have sound, including disassembling .gif files and explaining the components to him. Months later, a newspaper article had confirmed that a certain percentage of the population also

“heard” .gifs, probably as a result of synesthesia. He had thrown the article triumphantly on Emma's lap when he read it.

Emma's reaction had been to say, "huh," and turn all of her short verbal expressions into silent facial expressions - which he could not, in fact, "hear."

He found it pretty funny, actually.

"*We* are the interesting people," Dane explained.

"Oh dear," Emma said, and started sucking up a great quantity of her margarita. Finishing it off, she stared out at the ocean.

Dane watched her.

And waited.

Finally, she crinkled her nose and smacked herself in the forehead. "Gahd!" she exclaimed, rubbing the bridge of her nose, where her brain-freeze took its toll.

"Why do you keep *doing* that?" Dane chuckled. "I swear."

Emma nodded. It was another joke.

"I *am* going to talk to her today," she said, after a lengthy pause.

"About what?"

Emma's lips quivered with her characteristic mischievousness.

"Topicality discourse markers in proto-Indo-European languages. What do you think?"

Dane was so accustomed to Emma's rapid-response cynicism and wit that he didn't respond except to smile.

"Probably where to buy some *ceviche* that won't make me sick," she said after a while.

"Good opening line."

"Thank you."

*

Emma wasn't actually going to use any line like that on the mystery woman, but she *did* want to talk to her. Emma didn't really get into girls, though she'd done a bit of pretending because past boyfriends had liked it. But the woman on the beach had a particular kind of allure that Emma was both attracted to and intimidated by, and Emma didn't like being intimidated by anything, even if it was only in her own mind.

The question was one of how to approach the Mystery Woman.

She brought nothing to the beach with her except her sarong and sunglasses, so there was nothing for her to leave behind. She did nothing, drank nothing, and had only gone to the water once to cool off in the past three days. She sunbathed topless, put her bikini top back on, tied the sarong around her waist at a perfect, sexy angle, and, somehow sand-free, walked away with a sultry lope. Her pouty and serious mouth never changed, and it was impossible to know what she was thinking because her eyes were hidden behind large, dark sunglasses when supine, and they were closed when she lay on her stomach.

"I'm going to follow her," Emma told Dane, who seemed to be asleep again. She looked over at him: he was worse than a child in a car if he lay down in the sun. Mystery Woman was getting up, shaking her sarong, tying it around her waist. There wasn't much time. Dane didn't move.

Emma watched as the woman walked away, tying the bikini top as she moved.

Emma stood up, slung her beach bag over her shoulder - across her chest - and picked up her shoes, before scrambling in the direction that the woman's swinging mane of sun-bleached hair had disappeared. She became aware of her buzz as soon as she started walking unsteadily on the sand.

She smiled to herself. She was probably not going to appear very stealthy, but she was also drunk enough not to care.

The woman was headed between the buildings some way down the beach, and Emma ran a little to make sure she didn't lose her. When she rounded the corner, she was breathing a little heavily, and stopped short - and clumsily - when she saw that the woman was at the end of the sandy passageway, next to where the sand ended and the sidewalk began, bracing herself against the concrete building and slipping shoes on her feet with the same minimalist sexiness she did everything.

The woman gave her hair a toss and looked - as far as Emma could tell - directly at her. She rose a few inches as she stepped into a heeled sandal, and the hand against the wall fell to her hip. It occurred to Emma that she was probably a dancer - her posture was effortlessly perfect, and her hands floated with the movement of her wrists and arm with a grace that had to be practiced.

The mouth did not change.

In the world of fight and flight, Emma was neither, because few dangers presented themselves in her life. But she was, in moments like this,

more confrontational than shy. The Mystery Woman was intimidatingly beautiful, and one of those women whose mouth was always poised disdainfully. But Emma was not going to scurry away from it.

She gave her own hair a toss, and grinned. Emma was not a "sultry-sexy," and she didn't pretend to be, nor did she have the inclination, as many women did, to try and imitate another woman's sexuality. Emma was green-eyed and petite, with pale skin that freckled before it tanned, and the toned body that compact and naturally athletic women have without effort. Her breasts were perky, her nose was perky, and her mouth was cherubic and pink.

Smoldering was not her thing. "Cute" was the descriptor most men used for her.

Unless they got to *know* her, know her, at which point her filthy mind and libertine sexual creativity migrated her to the "ludicrously hot" category.

"How do you keep people from stealing your shoes?" Emma asked cheerfully, stepping towards the Mystery Woman.

"I don't," the woman replied, almost instantly. A very faint accent - too faint to identify - tinged her speech. She lifted her sunglasses. The pouty mouth made a different expression, which wasn't a smile, but it was easy to see she wasn't the smiling sort. "These aren't even my shoes."

Emma gave her a smile to let her know she got the joke.

The woman shrugged. "They stay cool here," she explained, as Emma approached.

Emma leaned on the wall to put her own sandals on, which were decidedly hot. "Good idea," she said. "So, you seem like a local. Do you, uh, know anywhere where I can get some *ceviche* that's, you know, reputable?"

"I'm not local."

Emma closed her mouth with a snap, saying "Oh," as she did. "I just thought..."

"This place is a huge disappointment," the woman continued, talking over Emma. "Not much life on the beach. Don't you agree?"

A flicker of what Emma thought of as a flame - the excitement of playing her games - had only to lick at her insides for a moment. There wasn't much else to do, and she had spent so long working on her cover story that would, by all appearances, get no use here in Isla Caza. But

really, she would never know why, exactly, she decided to do what she did next.

She said, smiling innocently:

"Well, I don't... I'm here on my... extended honeymoon. So, you know..." she sighed. "It's just me and my fian- husband." She appeared flustered, though she wasn't. "But yeah, it's sort of..." she shrugged. "Are you here by yourself?"

There was a pause before the woman spoke, her lips pursed in an odd expression.

"By myself," the woman echoed. "Yes."

Emma stepped toward her, and they began to walk onto the sidewalk together. "Why did you *come* here?" she asked.

The woman was tying her long hair up without a tie of any kind. "I have a house here," she answered. Her voice was almost a purr. "A family thing. Usually it is rented."

"I see," Emma said.

"*Isla Caza* used to be a very hip destination," she said, pushing her sunglasses up. They were walking along in the shade. Her eyes were big, a golden-flecked chocolate color that made them glitter like polished amber. "But this is strange this year, all of these old men."

Emma smiled to herself.

The woman stopped moving slowly as they neared the corner, so Emma had the sensation more of coming ashore than pausing on the street. The sunglasses went down again. "I'm Brigitte," she said, and the provenance of her thin accent seemed suddenly very French. "That is my house, on the corner." Her dancer-trained arm lifted, her wrist loose, the finger floating behind it, as she indicated, vaguely, the roof of a house surrounded by greenery and a rather worn wall, which was the norm in places like this. Her body turned, almost in a pirouette, and she pointed down the street they had been following. "I think there is a reputable fish place called *El Pescadero* that way, perhaps one kilometer. But I myself cannot recommend the *ceviche*."

She dropped her arm.

"Okay," Emma said cheerfully. "Well, thanks. And, uh... I guess I'll see you around. Oh. I'm Emma."

Another pause, one that Emma would only think about later.

"But of course we will see each other," said the enigmatic Brigitte, who had already begun walking as slowly as she had come to a stop, and so she was leaving already, hair tumbling from the loose gathering she had just made, in sexy, sun-bleached waves.

*

"I have *no* idea," Emma said, collapsing in her lounge after dropping her shoes and startling Dane awake. "How *old* she could possibly be. But her name is *Brigitte*, as in *Bardot*. Seriously. She just said that to me: 'I'm *Brigitte*.' And I think she's French. What else would she be with a name like that? And she is cooler than school. And I know where she lives. And she recommended a restaurant. And - and I have no idea why I did this or whether we'll ever see her again, but just in case we do - I told her we're here on our honeymoon and all that."

Dane was sitting up, his fingers under his sunglasses, rubbing his eyes. "What?"

"Brigitte," Emma said, exasperated. "Mystery woman?" She gave him a playful smack. "*Boobs*."

"Oh, *her*," Dane said. "Wait... you talked to her?" He rubbed his face. "How long have I been asleep?"

"Her name is Brigitte."

Dane snorted. "No it isn't."

"I swear. It is."

Dane looked around for the bottle of water he'd tucked into a shady patch under his lounge, which by now had shifted away, and the water was warm. He scowled. "Well, what'd you tell her that story for?" he complained, after taking a swig of it.

Emma shrugged. "I dunno. Practice."

Dane shook his head. "Why is she *here*?"

"Family house."

He wiped his forehead. "Jesus, I got way too hot."

"Want to go back to the house?"

He smiled. "Do you think Brigitte is coming back?" he asked suggestively.

Emma grinned and shrugged. It was joke, in a way. Brigitte was not what they were looking for, and they both knew it. Emma folded her legs

underneath her and looked out at the water. "I'm starving."

They looked at the water for a long, beach-slow moment. "Want to try this restaurant she recommended?"

"Ceviche?" he asked dubiously.

"Come on."

Dane held his stomach. "Ugh, I dunno," he groaned. Dane was, as a rule, more cautious than Emma about seafood in foreign climes, and while the fish was obviously fresh here, Dane was not one to gamble on fish that was only cooked on a chemical technicality.

"They'll have something cooked-cooked," Emma insisted. "Besides. Maybe there will be someone interesting there."

"Right," he said cynically. He sighed. "I need to cool off."

Emma stood up. "Okay. Pool, sex, and then you take me to dinner."

Dane arched his eyebrows. "Does it have to be in that order?"

Emma smiled, kicking his leg gently and running her hand along her thigh. "Not necessarily," she said, in a sultry voice.

CHAPTER 2

They did end up doing things in that order, and Emma found that Brigitte's directions were terrible, so they arrived at *El Pescadero* very hungry, hotter than before, and slightly damp with sweat. It was an open-air restaurant a few blocks in from the beach, with plenty of fans swirling on the ceiling, providing a nice breeze. They sat next to the street to people-watch and ordered beer, which came with already-melting ice cubes floating helplessly in the warm liquid.

They were used to it after a week of warm beer and clinked their glasses together. Emma fearlessly ordered ceviche and Dane ordered a grilled whitefish, and they snacked on chips and salsa while Emma rubbed her bare foot against his ankle and looked around.

"Whoa," she said, after about ten minutes. "I think I see... a prospect."

Dane's body rippled a little, and he leaned forward, picking a chip out of the basket. "Stop fucking with me," he said.

Emma leaned forward on her elbows, her eyes glinting mischievously. It was impossible to tell if she was trolling him or for real, which was the sort of thing he loved about Emma. "I'm serious," she said quietly, dipping her chip into the salsa. "He's at the bar."

Dane leaned back, refusing to look, even if his cock was twitching to life at the mere prospect of Emma telling the truth. Sensibly, he had been here a week and knew better than to get his hopes up, and he was calculating the odds of running into an attractive male on the exact same day that Emma had finally spoken to the only attractive woman on the island. The odds were not coming back favorably.

But like all men, he was infused with an absurd optimism when it came to sex, and so, even though he knew it was probably a joke, he turned after a few minutes to follow the path of Emma's gaze.

His heart gave a furious kick when he saw the man, and he turned back slowly to Emma, who was making a .gif face that meant: *what are the chances?* She grinned.

Dane pushed a chip into his mouth. The chances were very poor, he was already reasoning: it was for this reason that they went to tropical

locations with many tourists for extended periods of time: not every fish took the bait, as delectable as Emma was.

"How do you want to play it?" he asked casually, anyway. "You still want to be newlyweds?"

Emma sipped her beer and thought. The man was at the bar, alone. She needed to somehow float into his orbit, and even then, it was a long shot: their plan of being corruptible newlyweds had been concocted after another vacation in which newlyweds and unattached people had been in huge supply, and a lot more mingling had taken place, thus providing more plausible scenarios for flirting and games than they could count.

Here, it would be more of a challenge. And anyway, there was no guarantee she'd even like the guy once she got close to him.

She shrugged and wiped her hands together. "It's a long shot," she said. "But I'm up for a challenge."

Dane grinned. "So...?"

Emma shifted her jaw, calculating. Then she tipped her head to the side. "I think *you* should get a phone call."

Dane slid the chips toward himself and ate one. "I'm so hungry, though."

"I'll get it boxed up for you."

He looked at her over the beer, and then slammed his. He set the glass down, sighing. "All right. Sacrifices must be made. It's just... that cooked fish actually sounded pretty tasty."

"Get something at the little place by our house," Emma said, laughing and giving her hair a toss. "He just looked over here," she whispered.

Dane fished his phone out of his pocket and swept his fingers over the screen. Emma could see that he was turning it on airplane mode, and she ran her foot along his calf as she focused on the chips. Just in case the man at the bar was watching.

"Yep," Dane said, looking at Emma with a grin.

Emma did a terrific job of acting, not knowing whether she was being watched or not. For a computer geek, she was an incredibly good actress. She leaned her hand on her head and crumpled so convincingly that Dane felt a stab in his heart for taking his fake phone call.

"Just one minute, sweetie," he said, and scooted his chair out. Holding the phone to his ear, he leaned in close to Emma as though to whisper his

excuses to her. She looked annoyed, but goosebumps traveled down her shoulder as he whispered: "Good luck, my little vixen."

Then he edged out of the restaurant and onto the street.

Emma looked up at the waiter who approached, confused, at that moment, with the two plates. She made her eyes big, and disappointed, and asked him if he could box up Dane's order. In all likelihood, the man at the bar wasn't even watching, but why not pretend?

She summoned an angry expression and took her own order from the waiter's hand. "Bring me a margarita, too," she added.

The waiter, a much-too-young kid with a generous smile, looked uncertain, but perhaps he had seen the scene play out before. "One margarita," he said, and left quickly with Dane's fish still in his hand.

Emma looked at her ceviche sullenly, which wasn't easy because she was hungry as hell. But her love of their game defeated her hunger, and she held her sullen pose until the waiter returned with her margarita. The man at the bar, she noted with satisfaction, was still there, and though she couldn't tell if he was watching her or not, she kept up her act.

After all: this place was pretty lame, and he was alone. Who else would he be watching?

She took a bite of ceviche. It was quite good. It was going to be hard, eating it slowly, and probably none of this was going to pay off.

But the butterflies of excitement she felt just playing the game, however futilely, helped her eat slowly.

Anyway, if there was one thing Emma enjoyed as much as she enjoyed hotwifing, it was seemingly impossible challenges.

She leaned on an elbow, and bit into a chunk of ceviche, as sadly and sexily as she could possibly do it.

*

"Bad night?"

Emma was in full actress mode by the time the man spoke, so much so that she could hardly tell if the slow blink of her eyes, and the delay between his question and the flutter of her wet eyes to look in his direction, were real or not. She put a finger to her lip, did her best to look confused, smiled shyly, and dropped her hand. "What? Sorry... no," she looked at her empty glass. "Just..."

"I'll buy you a beer," he said.

A tingle traveled up Emma's spine. She had migrated to the bar, and sat perpendicular to him, when an older couple she could see was leaving soon had been between them, near the corner. As she had hoped, the couple had left, and now it was just her and the man, seated close to each other. But it gave the appearance of happenstance. Which was what she had wanted.

She hadn't been able to get much of a read off him, or even look at him much, at least not directly. She had been prepared - overwhelmingly so, because she was a picky person in general, and more often than not, her "conquests" ended in disappointment - for him to be less attractive up close, or to be what she called "middle-managementy," - which was never a good sign of a good lover.

Good lovers, in her experience, either came from lone wolves, slightly criminal guys, or ruthless top management-types.

Occasionally, and in very deliciously perverse ways, from military guys.

But never middle management types.

"I'll buy you a beer" was not middle-management speak. It was more of an order, hard to decline, and "beer" was such a strange drink to tell a woman to drink. It made the man instantly more appealing to her.

"Oh," she said, doing her best to appear flummoxed. Her heart was racing, adrenaline starting to pump into her veins. "I couldn't..."

But while she was looking flummoxed, laying out her traps, the man had - and this made her wet enough and excited enough to consider abandoning her original plan - ordered the bartender to serve her a beer by merely pointing in her direction. It was already being set in front of her.

"Um," she said, and looked at him directly for the first time. There was no point hiding the flush that came over her, and anyway, it would work in her favor if she stuck to her plan. Or didn't.

He wasn't a GQ model, that was for sure, but that was the sort of thing that could be a tick in his favor. Usually, guys who were unusually beautiful were incredibly lazy in bed because of it. He had on a baseball cap, but he wore it in a sinister way, and the logo on it was not from sports, or vehicles, or anything she recognized. He was still wearing his sunglasses, even though it was getting dark. His features were plain, and salt-and-pepper stubble - the sort of sandpaperiness, legitimate five-o'clock shadow most

men never actually got at five o'clock - gave a hard edge to his square, unremarkable features.

Without him saying anything, it was a good guess he was the kind of man who told people what to do, and then saw them do it.

Her pussy was turning to liquid as she considered the possibility that he was used to women doing the same. And, if she had his number right, he was *precisely* the kind of conquest-driven man who would love to lure sweet, innocent Emma from her inattentive newlywed husband. *Dane* wasn't a middle-management-type at all, but he was willing to play the part.

She hesitated, looked behind her, and then turned back to the beer. "I don't want to be rude or anything, but... I'm not exactly sure I should, uh... let you buy me a drink."

He had his own beer - served in a bottle - to his lips, and he paused to grin. "You can buy it if you want." He took a sip, still looking at her over the bottle.

Emma was caught slightly off-guard: he was going to be a bit more slippery than she had imagined.

Fun.

It was hard not to smile to herself. But this was a game, and she was determined to play it. After all, she and Dane had looked forward to it for so long, and she couldn't squander this opportunity.

She looked down at the beer, and her next move occurred to her. Pretending to get suddenly infuriated by the thought of her thoughtless husband, she took a deep breath and sat up straight. "You know what?" she said. "I *will* let you buy me a beer."

The man set his bottle down. It rang empty. He tapped the bar quickly with one hand, and a hiss came from between the bartender's hands as if he had been standing with a beer ready, awaiting that cue to open the bottle.

"That's the spirit," the man said, with a smile, to her.

Emma, shifting slightly on her stool and feeling the slick wetness between her thighs, lifted her glass to her lips and smiled shyly. Her hand shook as she raised the glass, which wasn't terrible: he would think she was nervous.

But nervous and excited so often look the same from afar.

She reasoned that she would lay the groundwork for her plan: to be a naive and unsuspecting newlywed wife ripe for the plucking. But if it

turned out that the man was going to disappear that night, she would abandon ship and try to get him to fuck her anyway.

Women might get mad if you lied to them all night, and then admitted you were just trying to trick them into a sexual game, and then said you were willing to scrap the game plan and just have a one-night stand.

Men... not so much.

But it turned out that he was here for the season, alone, and didn't offer an explanation for why.

"What about you?" he asked, as if he hardly cared about the answer. "You're not exactly the typical *Isla Caza* crowd. Air Miles?"

He said this almost condescendingly, like a man who owned his own jet might. At the very least, like a man who didn't bother with pocket change like that.

Emma let out another trembling sigh, truly impressed with her own acting. She'd had too much to drink, but it was part of her act, and it seemed to be helping the believability factor. She pretended to be torn, and then bit her lip as if in indecision. "Actually, this is... my honeymoon." She pushed a strand of her hair away from her face. "*Our* honeymoon," she added, as if correcting herself. She played with the paper take-out box, using a fingernail to click the lip up and down.

The man stared at her - or so it seemed, because he was still behind his sunglasses - and let his beer hover over the counter. "That guy," he said, at last. His tone was so completely neutral that there was no way to interpret the comment.

The beer came to rest on the bar. He pressed his lips together, and Emma indulged in the delicious fantasy of feeling those same lips travel the length of her thigh, stubble rough against her skin. She shuddered a little.

The man's eyebrows lifted, and the sunglasses rose ever-so-slightly. "And why is it that guy has left a pretty little thing like you all alone at a bar on your honeymoon?"

Emma was getting into her role. If there was one aspect of the games that she and Dane played that she liked more than the hot sex, it was the acting. She looked over her shoulder, like she was about to tell an off-color joke, and then back at her hands. "Well, I mean... he's got a pretty demanding job."

Most guys would have asked what his job was, but the man at the bar did not. He lifted his beer bottle to his lips, paused as though he were going

to say something, and then took a swig.

"What's your name?" he asked, taking off his sunglasses. His eyes were dark: she would see, later, in the sun, that they were blue, but a dark blue, almost navy. His gaze was wolfish, and Emma inhaled with a sharp stab of pleasure.

"Oh," she said. "Sorry. I didn't... I'm Emma."

He smiled. "Of course you're Emma."

She did her best to look confused, because if she were as Emma-like as she was pretending to be, she wouldn't know what he meant by that. Men thought Emmas were wholesome and freckled, girl-next-door types. She looked the part.

"I..." she said, to his silence. "What's your name?"

"Emma," he said, setting his beer down, his eyes carving into her. "I don't think you need to know the names of all the big, bad wolves lurking in bars while you're on your honeymoon. What would your husband say?"

Emma's mouth actually fell open a little with surprise. Her panties were warm with her wet juices. She had absolutely no idea what to say to that, as Emma-the-newlywed, or Emma herself.

Maybe it was best to just get this guy in bed before she lost the opportunity, but at the same time, he was playing along so well that it seemed like a waste not to try to "get corrupted" by him.

She shook her head and tried to look contrite. "Right," she said. "I... uh... should probably go." She stepped off the barstool, deliberately wobbling. "Whoa," she said, looking down at her feet as if she didn't understand why they were misbehaving. "Gosh. Okay. Thanks for the drinks," she said, looking from her feet to the man's face.

He stood up without saying anything, peeling hundred-dollar US bills from a thick roll of money he seemed to have produced from thin air. The sunglasses had disappeared. He was walking toward her, a determined and almost predatory expression on his face.

Emma's breath caught in her chest: this time more real, and fearful, than before. Now that he was standing, and his full height and the coiled strength in his body were moving toward her, and he looked like he was going to devour her, she became - for not the first time ever, but the first time in a long time - afraid that maybe she had chosen a man who was a little too much for her to handle.

He stood at the corner of the bar, hands in pockets, stare unwavering. "Which way," he said, and the intonation was so bland that she didn't, right away, hear it as a question.

"Wh... which...?"

"Way. Are you staying? On the beach."

She had already mentioned that she was staying in a house on the beach, somewhere back when the conversation had been bar chit-chat, complaints about the beach full of retirees. So there was no retracting the comment, no way of knowing what his intentions were in asking her the question.

"I'm just..." she pointed her finger loosely in a direction that could have been straight into the ocean. "It's only a few blocks."

"I'll walk with you."

"I don't think ..."

He stepped closer. "This town," he said quietly. "Is full of muggers and pickpockets. Right, Sandy?"

The bartender was drinking a beer. They were the last people in the restaurant, darkness had set in long ago, and Emma realized she had no idea what time it was. "Sandy"- who looked as much like a "Sandy" as the mystery man looked like a "Zhang" - set the beer down.

"Is true," Sandy said.

"I'm going that way anyway," mystery man said. And he walked out toward the street, passing Emma, not bothering to see if she would follow him.

"You should go with him, miss," Sandy said, and Emma caught the nametag on his shirt as she looked over at him. It read "Alejandro."

"There are all kinds of the bad people."

Emma nodded, and turned, and followed the man, who had slowed his pace to wait for her, but in a way that - infuriatingly, and scarily, and admittedly, arousingly - indicated that he knew she would follow.

They walked straight toward the beach, down a street that was mostly empty.

"What time is it?" Emma said.

"Probably ten," he answered.

They were arriving at the beach, and Emma paused to take off her shoes, but legitimately became unsteady - she was drunker than she thought - and had to reach a hand out to steady herself. The man's forearm was solid

muscle, his skin warm and dry, and she felt his muscle contract beneath her palm, which she found arousing in some strange way she couldn't explain.

"I think... I better just... I can walk from here, alone," she said. This was half part of her game, which she sort-of wanted to continue, and half an idea she thought really would be on the safe side.

Not that if mystery man tried to put the moves on her, she would resist all that much, but still. This wasn't a rape fantasy.

She stood up straight, holding her shoes, and looked at him again.

His face remained expressionless. He simply shook his head slowly.

"I can't let you do that."

Emma looked up and down the beach. Some wind picked up her hair and she drew it away from her face. She laughed, almost helplessly - almost genuine helplessness, because she really wasn't sure what to do in this situation - and shook her own head. "I just wouldn't want to be doing anything inappro -"

"This beach is dangerous at night," he said simply, talking over the last part of her unfinished sentence with a methodical, stoic voice.

She made a face. "I don't... believe that."

"It is."

Emma's defiant side was triggered. "Oh yeah? Who's to say it isn't *you* that's dangerous?"

It was out of her character, and he seemed to see that. But his reaction was nothing more than very slight quiver of the corner of his mouth. The sort of quiver that meant: I *am* dangerous.

But not how you think.

Then, quite suddenly, he stepped backward, giving his head a jerk in the opposite direction, to the street. She was obviously meant to go with him.

She hesitated, her head spinning: she had become so absorbed in this guy, and maybe so drunk, that she had almost forgotten she was playing a game at all. In fact - and this was very, very bad, actually - she had forgotten almost entirely about Dane. "What?" she said to the man.

"I'll get you a cab," he said. "Is that better?"

"I'm just... like ten or eleven houses that way," she said, pointing, her shoe dangling in her hand.

He was already dialing his phone, had it pressed to his ear. "It's the cab or I walk with you," he said, but broke off to speak rapidly in an odd-

sounding Spanish into the phone. Looking at her the whole time.

Which made her burn. And remember her plan from start to finish.

Snapping back into character, she clumsily put her shoes on, and stepped onto the pavement from the sand. She started to tip - again legitimately - and without breaking off from what he was saying, he shot his hand out to steady her, closing his fingers around her slender forearm.

They were strong fingers, not hands that drummed boardroom tables all day.

The phone call concluded, he slipped his phone into his pocket and slowly relaxed his grip on her arm, in perfect concert with the rate at which she regained her balance.

They walked to the street.

A cab rolled to stop almost instantly, and he opened the back door.

"I don't really know my address," she said.

"There are no correct addresses here."

"Oh. Yeah. Right. Uh..." she leaned in to look at the cab driver.

"Eh!" the man exclaimed with a grin. "Rafe, man, que tal te va la vida?" And then rambled on for a moment in Spanish, his eyes quickly flicking to Emma.

"Emma here doesn't speak Spanish," the man said.

The driver grinned at Emma. "Oh hey, that's no problem. I speak English and Spanish better than Rafe, everyone say so. Hop in."

"My house is really, really close," Emma said, embarrassed.

"Then your fare, it's really, really cheap." He looked at the mystery man as Emma hesitated and then climbed in, and the two rattled away in amicable Spanish for a few minutes. It was enough time, and jovial enough, that Emma started to feel silly for thinking there was anything sinister about the mystery man.

Finally, he looked down at Emma, gave her a searing look that made her wet again, and closed the door. Through the rolled-down window he said, "I already told him more or less, you just have to point out your house."

Emma tucked a strand of hair away. "I... hey, thanks," she said. "Sorry I got, uh... weird."

"Can't be too careful."

"Seems silly now," she said quietly, looking at her lap.

He stepped back from the cab. "See you around, Emma the newlywed." He patted the top of the car.

Emma's gut felt like it was being stabbed through by a hot iron. "Thanks," she said quickly, and then added, "for the chivalry."

But they were already pulling away, and the driver was making a wide u-turn in the narrow street, which looked like it would take them thumping over the curb, but did not.

The man was standing, hands in pockets, eyes on the taxi, and Emma, like a wolf, as they drove away.

"What did you say his name was?" Emma said, finding her voice. The drive was going to be less than a minute long, and she needed to get down to business fast.

"You don't know him?" the driver said, turning around fully to look at her. "That's Rafe, man."

He said the name "Rah -fey."

"Rafe," Emma said. "What's that, like, short for Raphael?"

The driver shrugged.

"Is he local?"

The driver smiled. "No, man, he is like some kind of very expensive guy, you know. Maybe Italy."

"He speaks Spanish, though," Emma pointed out.

The driver let go of the steering wheel with both hands to close the fingers of one hand together into a small space and point with the other hand. The car drifted to the left and he used his knee to steady it. "Little tiny bit of funny accent. Okay, okay," he said, taking the steering wheel back into his hands. "Which one is your house?"

Emma pointed, ducking her head to look out the window. "Right here is fine," she said. She fumbled with her purse, looking for money, realizing she'd left Dane's dinner sitting on the bar.

The driver held a hand up. "Is all taken care of, senorita," he said.

"Well, I... at least let me give you a tip or something -"

"Rafe he already take care of the whole thing, I cannot take a tip, senorita. Please. Rafe would no' be very happy if I did that."

Emma, her hands inside of her purse, blinked. "Uh... you sure? I..."

"I'm suppose to make sure you get in the house is all."

Emma stared at him a moment, and then, because she had nothing to say and no idea what was going on, she said, "Okay," and opened the door,

stepping out into the night.

Not knowing what else to do, she entered their rented house.

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She closed the door and leaned against it.

"So?"

Dane was waiting, sitting in a chair, phone in his hand.

"Is he any good?"

From the time she had realized she had forgotten his dinner, and in fact, almost forgotten about him and their game, Emma had been scrambling inside her mind for the answer to this question. He *was* good, so good in fact that he might be *too* good, because this was the first time she had ever gone on a fishing expedition and come back with what might actually be a shark.

Was it a good catch?

She let out a tense sigh, not meaning to sound as flustered as she did. She stepped out of her shoes. While still looking down, because she didn't really want to catch Dane's eye, and it made her feel terrible, she said:

"Meh, I don't know. He's... yeah, maybe okay."

She looked up at Dane, who had his arms over the armchair and was staring at her. The outline of his erection was pleasing, almost comforting.

She had said the right thing. She would probably never see Rafe again, and it was, on the whole, better if she didn't. He wasn't going to play her game; he was too... much. Of something.

"I thought for sure you'd found something," Dane said, as she walked toward him seductively. "You were gone forever." She swung her hips, and climbed onto his lap, which is what she would always do when she went out hunting for men, whether it worked out or not. It was their game, she was free to do what she wanted, and Dane *wanted* her to do it.

So why, as she walked toward him now, did she have a feeling in her chest that did not belong there?

She settled on his lap, and he wasted no time running his hands over her hips, under her dress, back down to beneath her panties, where his fingers plunged into the hot wetness that had welled up over the evening. Her body responded to his touch: she was wildly aroused, more so than usual.

Dane looked at her curiously. "He seems more than just *okay*," he said, as she let her weight settle onto his hand, her pussy sucking his thumb inside of her. An involuntary moan rumbled deep in her throat. Dane's finger pushed against her g-spot, which he found with ease. He knew just how to please her, and she knew just what he wanted.

But something was stopping her, at least for a few moments, from leaning forward to whisper what he wanted to hear. That the man at the bar was perfect, that she couldn't wait to let him fuck her, that she thought he was probably the kind of man who would fuck her in the ass all night, and send her home covered in his cum with her holes swollen and stretched.

And Rafe seemed like the kind of man who would do that very thing, and maybe even more, and he seemed like the kind of man to tie her up in very filthy ways and fuck her mouth while she gagged, the kind of man who had a very big cock, and liked to have it serviced with a smile.

And these were all things that Dane wanted to hear.

So she said them, and they were pretty much true, and they were just what Dane wanted.

But as she rubbed the head of her husband's cock against her clit, telling him that Rafe was going to make her ride him just like this, but she wouldn't be able to get him all inside, there was a flicker of something very unfamiliar inside of her.

Not enough to stop her.

Not enough to impede the screaming orgasm that sent her juices gushing down Dane's balls.

Just enough to make her think about in the dark, lying next to Dane, her eyes on the gray ceiling. Thinking, until she realized what it was, and her heart stopped cold for a moment, the thud resonating in her ears:

It was fear.

CHAPTER 3

Dane watched Emma dressing from the bedroom, an airy, sunlit expanse of white tile, sheen curtains that moved like pole dancers in the sea breezes, and stark, perfectly matched Airbnb decor that looked like it belonged in the pages of a magazine. The upstairs was dominated by the master bedroom and the enormous en-suite bathroom of natural-toned tiles and bamboo wood, with mirrors reflecting everywhere that allowed him to see her body from every angle as she shimmied into a green swimsuit the color of her eyes. A faint tan had begun to spread into the pale natural creaminess of her skin, bleeding like stain on expensive wood from her thighs and abdomen, shoulders and neck, into the shapes of her various swimsuits. Emma, fair and prone to delightful freckling, did not tan quickly or carelessly: they had been here for a week and a half and she had turned into the color of a weak, cream-dashed tea in her darkest places.

Before she shimmied the scraps of green fabric over hips and breasts, he had enjoyed the show of her rubbing sunscreen into every part of her body, even the places the sun would never see. Her body was flawless, naturally lithe and toned. Probably sensing that he was watching, she had spent extra time caressing the white cream into her nipples, between her thighs and over the smooth waxed lips of her pussy, leaving a dribble of white lotion clinging to the very tidy strip of feathery brown hair that led from inches above her gash to its warm pink center, like a reminder of cum dribbled onto her after a sloppy exit from her cunt.

In the bathroom, she turned and examined herself from various angles, scrutinizing her appearance, which drove him wild, because Emma's attention to detail increased with her appetites, and she was being very, very meticulous this morning.

At last satisfied by a few micro adjustments of the fabric against her skin, she let her hair down from the loose bun she had gathered above her neck. It fell into messy, large waves that only developed if she spent days at the beach and allowed her usual fine, shiny look to go wild with wind and salt.

He smiled when she gave the mirror a pouty look, her pink lips puffed out by a single puff of air - a trick a model friend of hers had told her about to capture the expression of a cover girl while avoiding ridiculous duck-lips. Her face, in spite of her extremely careful sun-screening, was beginning to freckle: faint, delicious, almond-colored specks were strewn over her nose and cheeks, enhancing almost to the point of caricature Emma's girl-next-door look. She leaned toward the mirror, and he was distracted by the round, taut curves of her ass as the green bikini rose slightly with the motion, displaying the crevice where butt met thigh, his favorite place to lick because it made Emma's pussy turn to liquid and she mewled uncontrollably when he did it. When his eyes drifted back to her face, she was applying dark brown mascara very carefully to her eyelashes.

Her green eyes, orbs the color of an expensive emerald, were Emma's only tell: in the right light, they glimmered with mischief and gave away far too much of her wild personality. Framing them with long lashes was a seductive move, and Dane knew she was doing it deliberately, creating a very carefully constructed lure for the big fish she had discovered at the bar.

She stood back from the mirror, her hands moving inside of a small makeup bag to get some gloss from one of the many little jars in her bag of tricks. Her fingers moved over her lips and they suddenly looked wet. Another motion deposited a cherry red stain in the center, which she spread out expertly - another model's trick - to give her lips the appearance of having been bitten recently and for the first time.

Satisfied, she gave her body another perusal from every angle, and then her eyes met his in the mirror.

"No!" she said, holding up a finger, because he must have raised his eyebrows in interest of the most carnal kind. "It took me like half an hour to get this look and I'll have to start all over."

She teased him with her walk into the room, knowing perfectly well what she was doing. But this was part of the game, and they hadn't been playing it for days, at least not with any seriousness, because there hadn't been anything to catch. She put a hand on one hip and posed. "Do I look newlywed enough? Corruptible?"

Dane's cock was painfully hard. He grinned and threw the covers off, so she could see for herself. Her eyes drifted over his cock, and she gave a self-satisfied smile, turned on one heel, and, pausing only to scoop a sheer

green cover-up from a chair piled with her clothing, left the room. "Perfect," she purred.

Dane strolled to the shower, giving himself only the briefest of glances in the many mirrors. He was in his early thirties, still fit, and in possession of a decent cock - especially when erect. In the shower, he leaned against the tiles, under the large showerhead that scattered a semi-salty lukewarm rain on his whole back, he jerked off in a matter of minutes. It wasn't difficult: the scent of a good, fun time was in the air, and even if Emma didn't think it was likely to pan out, the *opportunity* was at least out there, in play, and that was a lot closer to their fantasies than they had been just a day before.

The scent of coffee was in the air when he started drying off, which he did carelessly, slipping into his only swimsuit and padding out the bedroom door without giving himself a second look. His sandy brown hair was thick, a little wavy, and fell into what Emma called a very GQ style all on its own. Also, Dane didn't care what he looked like, because it was Emma who was bait, and not him.

She handed him a mug of coffee and leaned her elbows on the counter to read the English-language newspaper that was somehow delivered to their doorstep some mornings. Emma wasn't a news hound, she just liked it because it seemed to have a very clever headline writer with a sardonic sense of humor. Everything sounded as scandalous as possible. She also enjoyed that it was delivered at random.

Emma laughed quietly to herself before reading a headline aloud. "*Playa Rocos*o Reconsiders Warning Signs For Surfers After Ghastly Collision With Rocks Sends Tourists To Clinic." She scanned the article and laughed again. "This guy needed three stitches on his foot. His friend drove him there on a Vespa."

"The horror," Dane chimed in, sipping his coffee.

"Doesn't 'rocoso' *mean* rocky?" Emma pondered aloud.

Dane smiled. "So. What's the plan for today?"

Emma lifted her eyes and gave him a searing, fun look, the green glinting as if from underneath. What she had done with her mascara was a nice touch, looking perfectly natural while making her eyelashes long enough to whisper of sluttiness in any man's subconscious. "I thought we could maybe wander down the beach a little... sort of in, I don't know... that direction." She pointed to her right, which was in the direction of *El*

Pescadero. "Stretch out, take in some sun, look like newlyweds, and then... maybe you could leave me for an important phone call again." She sighed. "Bored, I will await your return, and perhaps a knight in shining armor will save me. If not, maybe I'll go shopping. For a new suit."

"Mmm," Dane said.

The plan wasn't likely to work out: statistically speaking, it was a long shot. He couldn't get a very good read of what Emma thought her chances were with Rafe, the lone potential male on the whole island, or so it seemed. Which was unusual, because Emma usually sized things up in a hurry.

But he attributed it to the unique challenge they had trapped themselves into, of pretending to be on their honeymoon. It had seemed very fun when they had cooked it up months ago, basing the idea loosely on some erotica Emma had read, but their time in Isla Caza was dwindling, and he was getting antsy for Emma to get some action.

"Maybe we should just put all our cards on the table with this guy," he said, after contemplating things for a moment. He took a sip of his coffee and looked out at the beach.

Emma took a long time to answer. When he looked over at her, she was studiously immersed in the newspaper. "Em?"

"Uh, yeah," she said, distractedly, and seemed to tear her eyes from the paper. "I mean, yeah, like I said, I thought about it, but I already told him that story, so... you know."

Dane made a face and brought the coffee to his lips. "I'm sure he wouldn't be overly offended by the right change of story."

Emma's eyes closed halfway, like a cat's. It wasn't as if Emma had never lured anyone to bed with her, so he was just repeating something she already knew. "I don't know," she said, eyes suddenly open and pupils narrowing with the rush of light. "I'll see what happens." She shrugged. "Not likely to even see him again anyway."

Dane looked at her over the rim of his coffee cup. "Your call," he said, sipped, and set the cup down. "I give you full permission to change the story as you see fit."

"Giving up on the challenge?" Emma said, returning her eyes to the newspaper.

That was more like Emma.

"It's kind of fun," she commented. "Otherwise, it's a bit like shooting fish in a barrel."

"Only one fish in this barrel," Dane said, coming around the counter and sliding his hands around her waist, down to her bottom, cupping the solid weight of it in his hand. He kissed her shoulder, and up-close to her skin, he saw the faint outlines of three freckles threatening to emerge, almond-skinned instead of weak tea, along her collarbone.

His cock didn't bother sending a message through the processing center of his brain; instead, the idea went straight to his fingers and made him stroke the underside of her buttock lightly, along the line where it met her thigh.

She leveled him with an icy glare. "Rein in your stallions, cowboy," she said quietly, a devilish grin on her lips.

He bit into her skin and let his hand fall. "Yes, ma'am," he whispered.

Because whatever it looked like at any given moment, and however much it seemed to be a purely equitable dance of sexual desires, in this area of their marriage it was ultimately a truth that both of them knew implicitly: Emma was the boss.

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Emma sighed loudly and rolled onto her stomach, hand draped over her navel. "I'm hot. What time is it?"

"Two."

"And nothing."

"Nothing but leering old men."

Emma sat up and ripped the book he had not been reading from his hands, to crawl onto him and settle her weight against his groin, bringing his cock, which had only finally settled back down, to instant life. She kissed him, and pushed her pubic bone into him, smiling when she felt him throb against her.

"What are you doing?" he murmured, sliding his hand up her back and to her neck. "I thought you didn't want to mess up your lip gloss."

She bit gently into his lower lip. "We are supposed to be newlyweds," she said, and bit him gently again. Her eyes met his, and the electricity in them traveled straight through his body, hot in his balls, radiating the length

of his cock, throbbing, trapped, in the bulb of his crown. "I'm just keeping up appearances."

She was moving, her weight lifting, her skin slipping against his fingers, before he could answer.

"I have to go for a dip," she said. His hands slipped over the sheen of sweat on the front side of her body.

He watched her go, Enjoying the way she had to twist slightly as she waded into the moderate surf. The green fabric, he knew, would cling to her body, and the cool water would harden her nipples, and the shape of her breasts would strain against the soaked, darkened green, revealing her shape as completely as if she were naked.

It would have been almost unbearably fun if there were anyone here to play with, but it would still be a visual treat when she emerged.

The waves licked at her waist, and then midway up her chest, at which point she turned to avoid splashing her face. Cooled, she walked out of the water, and the suit clung to her breasts just as he had anticipated. The bottom half of the bikini, weighted slightly, made a suggestive slide partway down her narrow hips, enough that the tiniest glimmer of her untanned skin peeked over the edge. Emma, probably very deliberately, did not adjust it, simply walked with her rolling siren-walk, the promise of showing more unkempt by the bikini bottom.

Her skin was glistening, droplets pearled on the oil of her sunscreen, when she curled up next to him on the towel again. She leaned back on her elbows to watch the surf. "Okay. Well," she looked up at him. "Want to abandon me here for a bit?"

Dane scanned the beach. "He's not here," he said doubtfully.

"Make a good show of it anyway," she said, leaning over to bite his forearm.

"What is this guy, CIA?" he joked.

Emma rolled her eyes and settled on her back on the beach towel. Her breasts swayed seductively as she adjusted herself into a comfortable position. "Humor me," she said, eyes closed, a grin on her lips. "But get me a margarita before you go."

Dane scowled as he looked around him. "I think the nearest one is all the way back by our place."

Emma laughed, feeling for her sunglasses and putting them on her eyes without looking into the sun. "All the way back by their place" was

about the equivalent of one and a half city blocks for them, so she didn't have to comment any further.

Dane dusted his hands off and hopped to his feet. "One margarita for my darling newlywed wife," he said cheerfully.

"Kiss me," she said, smiling, her hand drifting to his ankle.

He crouched down and placed his mouth close to hers, hovering over her lips, still wet-looking and cherry red in the center.

Then, an adolescent compulsion overtook him, and he licked her nose, which set her shrieking happily and rolling to the side, flinging her arms backward to slap him. He was, however, anticipating this move, and had jumped to his feet and away, so all she hit was his calf.

"Asshole," she said, rolling back onto her back and rubbing her hand under her nose.

But she was smiling.

*

She was there.

Names were never Dane's strong suit, unless he found a woman especially attractive, or unless the name belonged to a man his wife was planning to fuck, so he was a little disconcerted that "Brigitte" surfaced so easily in his mind, luridly, like the memory of a sexual moan.

She was sitting, cross-legged, on a stool at the margarita bar, elbow on the ledge, apparently looking at the surf. Her long, sun-bleached hair drifted in the breeze, but she was otherwise as immobile as a statue as he approached.

A statue shiny with baby-oil, incredibly detailed, down to the pale soles of her feet and the sand along her long, tanned thigh. Her suit today was black, extremely skimpy, and the top looked as if she had barely bothered to knot it in the back. The fabric hung in small triangles over her chest, the strings limply holding them in place, but it looked like the wind might blow it all off any moment.

And Brigitte had the eternal expression of a woman who simply did not give a shit.

Dane approached the bar at the far corner and leaned against it to catch the attention of the bartender. To his surprise - and sending a cool chill down his spine, with an unexpected flick to his balls - Brigitte rolled

her stool to face him and dropped her hand at almost the same time that the bartender placed a margarita in front of her. "Where is the wife today?" a voice, accented, low, and sultry, which only could have come from Brigitte, traveled along his skin like a tongue and made his hot neck feverish.

"Emma, yes?"

She said this as she lifted up her sunglasses, and her alluring, amber-flecked eyes struck at him again, this time in the chest. She said it as if she were perfectly aware that a conversation had been had between Emma and him, about her, as if she knew exactly what had been said, and also as if, like everything else, it was utterly inconsequential to her. She closed her lips around the straw in her margarita and sucked on it, amber eyes never once breaking with his gaze.

Dane's stomach gave a flip, and it was a feeling he hadn't had for so long it threw him completely off: for a few seconds too many he was in the kind of frozen freefall he hadn't experienced since Jamie Mitchell, future homecoming queen, had asked him if she could borrow his pen to write something on her hand the second day of high school.

"She, uh," he said, and cleared his throat, because his voice broke up in a sticky, frog-like bark. "We're down the beach there."

He pointed. The bartender was smiling in his direction. Brigitte's eyes moved in micrometers, shifting to take in the other direction of the beach, and then back to Dane. But he was looking studiously at the bartender. "Can I, uh, get a... get two margaritas. Jose. Same as always. Please."

Jose nodded and got to work, turning his back on Dane and Brigitte, who still seemed to be looking right at Dane, saying nothing. He could feel her gaze, and it felt like she was peeling away his skin. His palms, he could feel, were getting damp.

The blender hummed. A gull screeched. Dane cleared his throat again, and to his immense horror, felt his head turning, a stupid smile on his face, and his mouth, inexplicably and completely out of his control, forming words.

"It's a nice day," his mouth said, idiotically.

Brigitte's eyes blinked slowly, and her mouth changed shape, as if she were contemplating not what he had said, but how incredibly stupid it was that he had said it. She brought her margarita to her lips and sipped again, her eyes - thankfully - sliding sideways to look out at "the nice day."

She sipped, and then scowled, and without looking back at Dane or the bar, set her drink down again. "This is no place for people your age." Without a pause, she continued, in Spanish: "Jose, me regalas un pitillo, me apetece uno."

Jose sang something without turning around, and it made Brigitte roll her eyes and murmur something in an entirely different language under her breath. Then a string of Spanish left her mouth, full of cusswords, Dane was pretty sure, and ending with "*maricon*." She swiveled around to lean on the bar.

Jose was turning around with a blender-full of margarita and two glasses. He set them down on the bar, without pouring, and disappeared under the bar almost like a magician.

"*Y fuego*," Brigitte purred, as if to nobody at all.

She started to lean over the bar, long neck stretched out, breasts dangling, liberated from the cover of the loose top, aureole and nipples, impossible to un-see. Jose popped back up, bringing a cigarette to meet her lips as if the entire thing had been choreographed and practiced a thousand times. A lighter flicked, and the cigarette was lit. Brigitte coiled up again on the stool and her top went back into place. "*Merci*," she said, looking out at the surf again, blowing a stream of smoke through pursed, pouting lips.

Dane didn't like smoking, but when foreign women like Brigitte did it, it was another beast entirely. Jose poured his drinks.

Brigitte, he could feel, was watching him, eyeing him with the disinterested, mildly disdainful expression that seemed to be her natural default, as he took out his money to pay.

"You are Americans?" Brigitte said, her long arm swinging out over the sand to ash, while the rest of her body was motionless.

"Uh, yeah," Dane said, a little confused, almost afraid to look at her again. When he did, she had a sculpted, tanned arm draped over the back of the stool, an incredulous expression on her face, her lips almost smiling, her eyes unreadable. One arm was bent to prop her up on the bar. "You are tipping him too much," she said, nodding her head at Jose, who grinned. "He is not worth so much, you should only give him fifty *centavos*."

Dane felt the usual discomfort he experienced when he behaved like an American abroad, and was chastised about it by a foreigner, and was opening his mouth to say something in his own defense, like that he didn't mind tipping Jose, who seemed like a nice guy... but Jose was already

laughing to himself and Brigitte had an actual smile on her face as the two of them had a rapid-fire exchange in what seemed like two languages, while each of them chuckled lightly.

"*Putain*," Brigitte said at last, and the conversation ended. She smoked again and looked over at Dane. "Your *margaruite* are getting hot."

"Margaritas," Jose corrected.

Brigitte hissed playfully at him and put her cigarette out in an ashtray he seemed to preternaturally sense that she wanted and set on the bar, just as she was pointing the butt toward where it would eventually rest.

"They are shit if they are warm," she said, and then added something in French that made Jose smile and nod before turning around to the bar without saying anything.

Brigitte was looking at Dane, and without speaking she seemed to be ordering him to hurry up and get out of there.

So, unnerved for reasons he was entirely unable to think of, he picked up the margaritas.

And then, like a total ass, he lifted one in a gesture of cheers and said - like a total ass - "Okay. Well. See you around."

He was already turning, so he wasn't sure if he saw it or not, but Brigitte, sexy, often topless, unnerving, French Brigitte, made a little circle with her ankle and her manicured toes, and said nothing. But her lips curled into a smile.

The spirit of which Dane knew he would spend a lot more time than he should dissecting in his mind.

*

The margarita had gone to her head more than usual. Maybe because it was hot, maybe because she'd had too much to drink and too little to eat the night before. Either way, she had worked up a pretty good buzz by the time Dane theatrically answered his phone, not taking it particularly seriously.

"Yes. Dr. Pangloss. I am here," he had yelled, and she had kicked sand at him as he retreated, saying something about TPX reports with a wink.

He really was a funny guy. She watched him walking back to the beach, through the craggy limestone-like figures of sunbathers, hollering,

no doubt, something hilarious to which not one of them paid any mind.

Probably, she thought with a smile, they didn't even hear it.

He was still as good-looking as when they'd met: tanned, trim, attractive arm muscles beneath his linen shirt. Smart. Funny. Good in bed.

She leaned back on her elbows for a bit and surveyed the ocean waves, keeping her husband's retreating form in her mind as long as she could. Who cared if their games came to nothing here? It was a gorgeous island, they were having a good time. Recent events had stirred a little intoxication into the mix, even if it ultimately came to nothing.

She shrugged, as though she were having a conversation with someone and no longer wanted to have it. Then she pushed up, dusted off her hands, and, telling herself she was better off never running into the dark Rafe again anyway, slipped the sheer green cover-up over her head. The material had baked in the sun and almost too hot to touch.

She gave a glance at the ocean: maybe it was better to cool off first? But headed off to the street, shoes in hand, bulging beach bag slung over her shoulder, admittedly thinking of her perfect lip gloss, her wavy hair, the way her skin had acquired a nice sheen from the last layer of sunscreen and the sweat that had beaded up in sensual places.

Rafe was nowhere to be found on the beach, or the streets near the beach, in the shops or the restaurants she passed. She told herself, almost impatiently, that *of course* it was the case that he was nowhere to be found. She also told herself that she wasn't looking for him, as she kept her eyes rigidly on sarongs and scarves, earrings and necklaces, none of which she had any intention of buying. She walked past *El Pescador* without looking in, eyes strained with that peculiar pain that comes from trying to use peripheral vision, determined not to look in, knowing that she would find his silhouette easily if it was there. Her heart was racing, the shaky adrenaline of new and exciting conquests was in her blood as she walked by the restaurant.

It wasn't more potent than usual, she reasoned with herself, almost arguing. There was some part of her mind that was trying to warn her about something, and another part of her mind that was pretending there was no need.

She kept walking down the street, away from the beach, uphill, even as the stores thinned out and the street became residential, even as locals leaning on the doorways of non-beachy stores and bakeries watched her

with the stare that those unaffiliated with the tourism industry all seemed to share, brows furrowed in slight confusion.

The hill kept going for what seemed like an eternity, with no side street taking her over to a new block to head back down to the beach, which she wanted to do without having to pass the same staring workers on the way down. At a curve in the road that had looked hopeful, and then just continued with no intersection in sight, she let out an annoyed sigh and turned around to face the beach.

"Oh," she said aloud. The view was stunning. A street dog, who had probably begun following her out of curiosity and because she smelled like coconut oil, stopped mid-stride and looked at her suspiciously.

The street was almost empty of people. Houses behind bars gazed silently at the crumbling street. The bars on windows gave everything in the tropics an ominous feel, even if they were largely decorative, or so Dane reassured her. She looked up the hill, squinting to try and make out whether the road ever diverged. But she could see, looking over the houses and the glimpses of streets cutting through them, that the grid-patterned planning of the beach area fell apart up here, and she would probably only get lost.

She sighed and turned down the street again, suddenly keenly aware of her sheer suit cover, and the fact that she looked lost, and the stare of the street dog, whose watchful eyes moved in its stiff head as she crossed the street to pass by it as far away from it as she could.

She gave her hair a shake. At the top of the hill, as everyone knew, there were enormous houses with floor-to-ceiling windows that belonged to wealthy people, and they surely had to come down here sometimes to the beach. So she didn't look *that* out of place.

She was, however, very thirsty, and uncomfortable, by the time she had passed the same staring workers, through a quiet sea of hisses and clicking sounds that she felt sure were for her. She could see the purple roof of *El Pescadero* as she walked, very briskly, down the steep hill, and there was no question that whatever happened next, she was going in there. For water.

She had forgotten entirely about him in the mildly panicked descent, and was thirsty enough that even as the tourist area folded around her with its familiarity and relative safety, and the walk seemed like a silly thing to have done and to have gotten rattled by, she still didn't think of him. It was

cool in *El Pescadero*, and the breezy air made by the fan circling above breathed on her sweaty skin and gave her a slight chill.

There was a new bartender, not that she'd have noticed, and the people in the shade of the restaurant registered only as shapes.

"Can I have a water, please," she croaked, and she must have looked like she needed it, because the bartender was already nodding and fetching a bottle from under the bar, without asking all the usual questions about what kind of water she wanted: carbonated or not, "espring" or mineral, and a thousand other things she didn't care about. He even rummaged around for a cold one - which was relative in these parts - and offered her some ice.

She collapsed on a barstool, drinking greedily, letting her bag fall to the floor.

It was only after she'd pretty much made a spectacle of herself, as she cooled from a feverish heat that had muddled her thinking, that she realized that he was there. Sitting at the end of the bar, a different seat than the one he'd occupied last time, immobile, dark, muscular, eyes behind sunglasses still, no baseball hat today. His dark hair was thick, youthfully cut, rakishly attractive. She locked her eyes on the wall in front of her and tried to act as if she still didn't know he was there, but her heart started to beat so quickly her hand shook as she set the glass down.

Jesus. She suddenly didn't know where to look, or how to act. Was she thirteen or something?

And there it was again: a feeling she hadn't had for a very long time. She'd been hotwifing for years now, she had Dane's permission to do whatever she wanted, this was their game. The feeling she was doing something *wrong* had disappeared from her life.

But that wrongness was the very feeling that was snaking around inside of her. It was seductive, arousing, and... definitely not a good sign. She stared at her water glass. The ice had almost melted, she should probably just drink what was left, leave a tip, and walk out without looking in Rafe's direction. Tell Dane she'd had no luck, never mention any of this again.

On the other hand, it wasn't as if luring Rafe in wasn't exactly what Dane *wanted* her to do.

It was, after all, what they did.

She was still deliberating the finer points of what was going on in her mind, when a large, frosty margarita appeared in front of her. "Mister Rafe

said you look like you need a drink," the bartender told her.

Her reaction time was slow. She blinked at the lime-colored drink, and reached out to touch it, almost like it was a portal to another universe. She stared at it too long, thinking of what she would say next, to Rafe, who was already on her mind, who she would need to appear to be surprised to see... so she jerked her head in his direction, and cringed because she realized this revealed that she knew he was there all along.

Absolutely nothing occurred to her to say.

He was pushing something into a tortilla, which he held expertly in his left hand and brought to his mouth, tipping his head to pop it all in without spilling anything. She stared; he munched. Mouth closed, a slightly European air about the way he ate, though she couldn't say why, exactly. He finished chewing, crumpled a napkin in his left hand, and let it drop into the basket.

"You went on a hike," he said, his inflection leaving the door firmly closed on any response from Emma, whose mouth had begun to fall open slightly. She was almost positive that her heart was beating so frantically, and her blood pressure was so high, that her pulse was throbbing visibly in her throat.

Another beat passed, while an epic storm of thought took place in her head, and much too late for it to not sound silly, she managed to say: "Hey."

Rafe pushed the basket forward and said something in a very, very low voice to the bartender, who was turned away from Emma so she couldn't see his expression. He collected the basket and disappeared around the other side of the bar, toward what was probably a kitchen.

Rafe had unfolded another big pile of money, not as if he wanted her to see it, or not to see it - precisely as if he didn't care whether she did or not, which she found unnerving. He took two bills, which looked like American fifties, out of the pile and placed them on the bar. He did this neatly, folding them into a precise squarish shape and placing an empty glass on top of them. He still had said nothing, and she couldn't tell if he was looking at her through his dark glasses. Her eyes couldn't be torn from his lips, the way they were sensually shaped and expressionless, slightly sinister, framed by blackish stubble that once again she could not help imagining against her skin. This time, she felt the phantom sandpapery skin between her breasts. A very brief fantasy flashed through her head, and the sandpapery feel dissolved into a hot, hard, veined, skin-feel, his face

floating above her with the same expression on it as now, as hot, salty liquid fell in ropes on her chin.

Her pussy throbbed again, she closed her eyes to shake the fantasy away, and a shudder of pleasure traveled through her that left her skin cool and her head swimming, almost like she had experienced a miniature - very miniature, but still - orgasm.

Fuck, she thought, as Rafe stood up, tucking the money into a back pocket of loose linen shorts. He still had said nothing. He was walking toward her, like he didn't see her, looking out at the street. Her heart leaped. Soon she would have to look up, or turn, if she wanted to see him.

"Thanks," she blurted. She waved her hand wildly to gesture at the drink, just as she started to say, "for the drink," but it was not where she thought she'd left it, and she tipped it over with her wild, waving hand, and then tried to reach for it with the other, which only sent it careening over the bar, with a terrible splintering sound when the glass hit the tiled floor.

Her neck was already hot, her ears burning. She was glad she had turned to try and catch the drink, because she didn't have to see Rafe's reaction.

"Shit," she whispered, pushing off the lowest rung of the barstool to stand up and look over the edge at the margarita that had been flung all over the tile, encrusted with shards of glass.

The bartender was coming, she was holding her hand, palm out, toward him, in her characteristic American way, waving, telling him she would clean it up.

And then his hand was closed around her forearm, warm and dry, slightly rough, pushing her arm down, pressure on her left shoulder, calm and insistent and utterly *commanding*. He was next to her, he smelled like sandalwood and tobacco and something else masculine. "He'll get it," he said, and his breath was warm on her neck as her bottom settled onto the stool. He guided her hand to rest on the bar, but didn't release it, or her shoulder, and his touch burned through her from head to toe.

Her mouth was open, and a bubble of air left it like a hiccup, which she turned into an "Oh."

"My God," she added, a moment too late for it to seem like part of the same sentence.

His hand left her shoulder, rose to his sunglasses, removed them, and hung them on his collar. He sat next to her, facing her, fingers still curled

around her forearm. When she looked at him, his dark blue eyes struck her like hatchets.

"Do you want another drink," he said, his voice even, "or have you had too many already?"

"I..." her eyes drifted down to his hand, and his fingers snapped open, releasing her arm. He brought his left arm next to his right and folded his fingers together as she slid her hand back to her lap. He was already saying something to the bartender, who had swept everything away with a broom he had produced from nowhere, almost like he had known she would spill the drink and returned from the kitchen ready to clean it up.

"I'm so sorry," she told the bartender again, which only made him shake his head and grin, turn around, and start preparing something.

"I'm not drunk," she began, glancing back at Rafe, fighting with the very unusual sensation of feeling like she had been kicked sweetly in the chest when she found his blue eyes looking right at her, just as she had left them, hovering over the square jaw, the stubble, the aquiline nose, the impassive mouth.

And then his hand, the back of it, was on her forehead. Her body froze, he held it there, almost scowling at her, and then, as he dropped it, drew it along her right cheek so that it barely - ostensibly, accidentally - grazed her skin. Heat ran in waves along her spine, and she pushed her knees together in some sort of strange, knee-jerk reaction.

"Too much sun," he said. And then another stream of odd-sounding Spanish rattled from his mouth, directed at the bartender, who continued what he was doing and gave a nod of his head.

Emma put her own hand to her face, realizing too late that it was always silly to check your own temperature that way. Inside her head, she was still searching for something to say, though less frantically than before, because a vague sense of resignation was taking over her mind: she would probably not come up with anything, anyway.

Emma was not a tongue-tied type. Men did not unsettle her.

She unsettled men. Being unsettled by men was the sort of feeling she had abandoned long ago, a feeling for twenty-year-olds.

Rafe was sitting with his arms on the bar, fingers folded together, tendons and wiry muscles slightly tense in his forearms, a bit like he was waiting for his tab. Emma wiggled in her seat, because the silence and the

lack of motion were making her uncomfortable. Her skin still tingled where he had touched her.

The bartender reached backward, without turning or saying anything, other hand still working on the opposite worktable. He deposited a tall glass of white liquid on the bar, which Rafe slid over to Emma.

She took it and stared at it.

"*Horchata*," Rafe said.

The bartender turned around and set two enormous margaritas on the bar in front of them. "Drink that first," he said to Emma, his eyes dropping to the *horchata*.

"What's -"

"Rice water. Sugar. Some people hate it," Rafe said, stirring his margarita with a masculine motion, more like he was concocting a cement mixture than blending a fruity drink. He tossed the drink umbrella on the bar and said something to the bartender, again in Spanish, which made the bartender smile and pick it up, to toss into the trash.

Emma was still staring at him, hand on the glass of horchata, which was pleasantly cool. Rafe lifted his margarita and took a sip of it, turning to look at her over the rim. "Drink it," he said, his eyes on the margarita as he set it down.

He slid the margarita toward her, so that she had three drinks clustered around her motionless hands. And then he looked at her, expectantly, so she lifted the horchata to her lips and drank it.

"What do you think?" the bartender said, smiling at her.

She set it down and pressed her lips together.

"It's... uh... unusual."

The bartender grinned. Rafe was looking at her, his eyes burning so intensely that she could almost feel their heat on her skin. He seemed to be weighing the answer to the question very heavily.

"Drink it, it's going to rehydrate you," Rafe told her.

Emma sat up straight, a rush of well-being flowing through her, and a sudden wave of resistance gripping her. She shook her head defiantly.

"I'm... I think I'm fine, actually. Now."

Rafe looked at her for a few beats, while she slid the margarita closer, because in truth she did want something very cold at the moment. Then he made a fist out of one hand and rolled his knuckles over the bar. "Miguel, I need a beer," he said.

Miguel shook his head and folded his bar towel, as if this were something he had warned Rafe about already, before popping down to a refrigerator to retrieve a beer.

"Did you wear that on your hike?" Rafe asked Emma, rotating his stool to face her again.

Emma, still disoriented completely, put a straw between her fingers and sucked up some margarita, using the time it took to do so to think of what to say. She had lost control of the conversation, another disarming aspect of the dark-haired mystery man, and one she was very unaccustomed to.

She swallowed. "I didn't go on a *hike*," she told him, and was pleased that she turned her head toward him and gave her hair a sexy shake. The smile on her lips was flirtatious. Her facial features, she was relieved to say, were back under her control.

Her heart was still kicking at her chest like an animal, but Rafe couldn't know that.

The bartender set a beer on the bar and Rafe took it in his right hand without looking at it. "Do you know I live up there, in *La Colina*?"

"At the... colin...a?" Emma stuttered.

"Top of the hill," Rafe said, almost patiently. He took a sip of his beer, his eyes still dangerously set on her own. "And I do not walk up that street. Or down."

"Because it's dangerous?" Emma said, almost incredulously.

Rafe smiled. "Not for me." He let that sit there, between them, as he took another sip of his beer. "It's very steep," he continued. "It's too hot at this time of the afternoon." His eyes took a leisurely walk over her body, pausing at the swell of her breasts, lingering on her thighs. "You have freckles," he said, while still looking at her inner thigh, not trying to hide his gaze.

He gave her time to react to that, his eyes floating slowly back to her face, but all she had accomplished in that long time was to let her mouth fall open, partly in denial, because if there was one thing she had been hoping to avoid on this trip - or any - it was the appearance of freckles.

She desperately wanted to look down at her own chest and confirm that they had not appeared there, because she detested that, but she didn't want to give Rafe the satisfaction of knowing that he was making her care about her appearance.

"You're too fair for this sun."

Just who the hell, she wondered, prickling inside, did this guy think he was? She could feel herself getting ruffled, and she hated herself for it, but the words were leaving her mouth before she could get control of herself.

"I wear sunscreen," she objected.

Her voice sounded young to her, like the voice of her twenty-year-old self. The Emma who had lacked confidence, the Emma who let men take the lead, the Emma who let herself be rattled by men, instead of the other way around.

Rafe jerked his head, almost microscopically upward, a kind of tiny concession to a nod, an infuriatingly amused smile dusted on his beautiful mouth.

Then he faced the bar again.

Emma's blood boiled.

"So your husband has abandoned you to the streets of Isla Caza for a second day."

She took another time-buying sip of her margarita. This, she thought quickly, was more like what she had intended all along. This was along the lines of the game she had wanted to play, the game Dane wanted to play.

But suddenly, she found herself not wanting to play it.

Not *that* game.

Lurking around inside of her was a completely different kind of attraction, and part of her very much wanted to run away from it.

"He's... uh... got a conference call. So, I decided to get out, maybe see what the rest of the town looks like."

"A conference call," Rafe repeated. Disbelief was dripping from his voice, but Emma couldn't tell if it was disbelief that a man would get on a conference call in the middle of his honeymoon, or pure disbelief of the entire story she was telling.

"How long will he be on this conference call, your newlywed husband?" Rafe asked, sliding the second margarita closer to her.

Emma shrugged her shoulders and took a sip of her margarita.

"They're pretty long," she said, more uncertainly than she meant to - for this had always been what she planned to say if that question came up, but now she wasn't sure she should be saying it.

It was a comment designed to keep the door open for her to stay longer, be seduced.

Which was a very bad idea, she knew somewhere deep inside.

"So are you going to continue your exploration?" Rafe asked. "Of the town," he clarified.

Emma shook her head, eyes on his not for any other reason than she felt they were affixed to his gaze. "I think I'm done," she said quietly. "It's a little... sketchy up there."

"I could take you to my house," Rafe answered, almost before her sentence could have had time to make its way through his mind.

Her heart kicked against her chest with such force she was worried it could be heard. Her limbs went cold, and her imagination exploded with filthy scenarios that played all at once, taking her breath away.

"That's inappropriate," she said, almost whispering.

Rafe smiled. It was a sinister, wolfish smile, mouth closed. Emma tried to hold his gaze, but found she couldn't, and her eyes darted to her drink.

"Sit here and have a few drinks with me," Rafe said, standing up.

"But we move somewhere more comfortable." He called something to the bartender, who gave his characteristic nod, and began to walk away, into the restaurant, without taking his drink or looking back.

"I take it over to you," the bartender said, looking at her over his shoulder.

Stunned, Emma slipped off the stool, and because she found herself in the peculiar position of really not having any idea what to do, she followed.

*

"So, you have a house here?" Emma said, after sitting down at a small table in the corner of the restaurant, by a window that looked out on an alley and into another restaurant. Her knees had brushed against his as she swung her legs under the small table. It was inappropriately intimate, but there was no way to push her chair back, because there was a low wall behind her. So she sat, knees burning with the feel of his skin against hers, liquid seeping into her swimsuit.

Rafe raised his fingertips and rolled them over the table. "In La Colina," he said, with a smile to let her know she was repeating something

they'd already talked about.

"How long are you here?" she asked, feeling the need to fill time, to get his eyes to look somewhere else, to keep her stomach from twisting into knots in the silence. "Per year," she added.

"Maybe three months."

"Wow," she said. She put her hands in her lap as the bartender set their drinks in front of them. He brought only one margarita for her. Rafe looked up at him and asked for something, again in Spanish.

"You're not from here, though, right?" she asked.

He leaned back in his chair and appraised her. "No," he said, a note of question in his voice.

"It's just the driver," Emma said, as if Rafe had actually asked her a question. She lifted her hand, palm up, finger vaguely directed at the street leading to the beach. "He said you have an accent."

Rafe smiled and lifted his refilled beer to his lips, appearing to think about something that amused him. "Hmm." He drank. "He is a bit of an asshole."

Emma smiled. On the roller coaster of feelings she was on, she had reached a reassuring high with this comment. She smiled, feeling back in control, however slightly, of her flirtations. "So... where are you from?"

"Argentina," Rafe said. He set his beer down and squinted into the alley. "This is why I say he is a bit of an asshole."

They shared a smile, and it felt dangerous to Emma. And delicious. She didn't like the feeling of wanting Rafe to smile at her, with her. And she did.

She bit her lip, and impatiently pushed away the errant hope that fluttered through her mind, that she hoped her lip gloss and lip stain had remained as lusciously intact as they had been this morning. "So what do you do, that you can be here three months out of the year?"

He paused. It was too long to not be time for him to think, but there was no way of knowing what he was thinking about. "Art."

She could think of nothing to say.

"You mean, when you ask me, what I do for a living, yes?" he said.

"Right."

"Art."

"Uh... you're an artist, or you buy and sell?"

"Yes."

Her mouth was caught open.

"Both things," he told her, taking a lime from a bowl that the bartender brought at that moment and squeezing it into his beer. The bartender also set down two peculiar-looking shots, shaking his head and mumbling something in Spanish.

"What is this?" Emma asked incredulously.

"*Hesperdina*," Rafe said.

"*Mierda*," the bartender called back as he walked away, which was a word Emma knew and caused her to laugh.

"He doesn't approve," Rafe told her, picking up the shot with a claw grip that he almost magically turned into a quick motion to tip it down his throat. He only drank a large gulp and set the glass down. "You will probably hate it," he told Emma, "but it would be extremely rude for me to order you nothing."

Emma looked at the drink. "What's it like?"

Rafe smiled, and leaned back in his chair, extending his arms over the back. "Some things are simply impossible to describe, so you should just try them."

Indeed, Emma thought, lifting the drink to her lips with a smile.

*

Emma was gone for hours before he sent her a text, because he didn't want to pester her, and he also didn't want to send her a message and receive confirmation of the disappointment he was expecting. A good-looking man who made his wife's pussy as wet as it had been the night before was hard enough to find, but the chances of Emma running into that man again seemed slim.

His spirits were beginning to pick up as the hours dragged on without any news from Emma, so he sent a message at last, playfully, participating in what he pretty much considered to be their default game, just for fun.

Oh, maybe with a tiny bit of hope thrown in.

Still on call if you can believe it ;)

How is shopping?

And then, as he waited, and the minutes ticked by with no answer, and the sun began to set, his stomach began to twist into a familiar, excited knot.

Maybe, Emma had been successful.

Dane made himself a drink and settled into a chair by the pool to enjoy himself. Perhaps his favorite part of their lifestyle was the time that Emma was out, almost as though she was hunting something, and he didn't know where she was or what she was doing. Sometimes they arranged things for him to watch, and that brought its own charm. But secretly, he enjoyed letting a light, drunken high settle over him while he let his imagination run wild.

But as he sat there, staring into the shimmering water of their pool, he had to fight to keep Brigitte out of his mind. He pictured Emma, pictured the man from *El Pescadero*, and tried to put them together into lurid scenes - a task that should have been easy because Emma was quite a performer and had left a fertile playground of images in his mind.

But no matter how much he focused on Emma and Rafe, Brigitte's long legs and her bored expression of permanent, dangerously alluring dissatisfaction, wandered into his fantasy, and derailed him.

*

Several drinks in, Emma and Rafe had relaxed into what Emma would call a more "natural" conversation - or that was to say, a conversation that didn't feel to her like navigating dark waters at the edge of a cliff. He was an art dealer because he enjoyed having money, and an artist because he simply was.

"What kind of artist?" she asked.

Rafe had given her another one of his smiles - and he had so many, all of them tinged with an alluring malevolence of some kind. Each smile he gave made something claw inside of her. "What kind do you take me for?"

She cocked her head to the side, assessing him, forgetting completely that she was playing a role. Her thoughts returned to the mild roughness of his hands, the mere memory of which sent a shiver racing down through her core. Her mouth opened to adjudge him a sculptor, but she stopped herself short of saying so because she didn't want him to trace her thoughts, as he seemed so capable of doing. "Painter," she said, lightheartedly.

He held up his hands, examining them, turning them for her to see. It was so terrifyingly close to her line of thinking, almost like he *had* read her thoughts, known that she would go thinking of his hands, and wanted to show her that he knew.

"Not a painter," he said quietly.

Emma was again disconcerted, but starting to enjoy the feeling of it, the way one enjoys the sickening thrill of a drop on a roller coaster track. "I don't know any other kinds of artists," she said quietly.

She was happy that it made him smile, like he genuinely thought it was funny. And that feeling was sucked back out to sea by an incoming wave of guilt, giving it more force as it rolled in to nearly drown her.

Her phone buzzed in her purse, making her jump. Like Dane, wherever he was, could see her there with Rafe - Rafe who was supposed to be a mark, a guy she would screw and enjoy and abandon, all without ever caring if he liked her jokes or not. As if Dane knew that she was doing something just outside their boundaries.

She thought of ignoring it, but Rafe's eyes dropped to her purse. She fished the phone out and read Dane's text.

"Your husband is calling you home," Rafe said. It was an observation, behind which he placed very little readable emotion.

How is shopping?

Emma lifted her eyes over the top of the phone, and met Rafe's: dark, piercing, looking right into her.

"Uh... no, not exactly," she said, putting the phone on her lap, bending at the neck to type with two hands.

No time

She sent the message quickly. It was a message she had sent before, when flirting with a man could not be interrupted by a text at that particular moment. It was a text Dane was used to receiving, a text he would be excited to receive.

But the text, at least for her, had another meaning: she had no time. No time to explain, no time to think, no time to put into words how "shopping" was going. She was in a store where she had found something

she wanted, but which was not what she was looking for, and maybe too expensive, and probably she should leave it and go home and never think of it again.

That's how shopping was going.

She dropped her phone in her purse.

"Hmm," Rafe said.

"What?"

His eyes were on hers, and she forced herself to keep looking at him. "So he has texted you, at least," Rafe said, after a moment burned between them. "I was thinking it was very unusual that he didn't call you last night."

Emma's mind went entirely blank of language. Her mouth was ready to say something, but instead, it fell open, and her hands opened in an expression of exasperated confusion.

"I would want to know why my wife was at the bar for so long, anyway."

"Oh," Emma said quickly, grasping at the one thing she could think of to say. "So you're married."

"You thought I wasn't," Rafe said, almost instantly. He lobbed it almost like a confrontation, a correction to what she had said.

"I..." she closed her mouth and looked helplessly around. Then she laughed, out of the absurdity of the situation. "Honestly, I didn't even think to ask."

Rafe leaned his arms over his chair, elbows bent, chest tight against the light blue shirt he was wearing, the contours of his body mouth-wateringly clear. He raised his right hand, which was how he signaled for Miguel the bartender to come over. But his eyes didn't leave Emma's face, until she became uncomfortable, put her hand in her chin, and looked out the window, feigning interest in something in the alley.

He ordered more drinks, and Emma smiled at Miguel, who had the kind of affable face she felt like smiling at.

"So what is it your husband says?"

"He, uh... is going to be a while."

"So you are going to be here, alone, bored, drunk, if I leave you now?"

He didn't wait for her answer, which was good, because she didn't have one. Instead he smiled right away, put his hands on the table, and

stood up. For a moment her heart went tumbling. "I'm going to the restroom," he said. "Afterward we decide where we will go to next."

As he strolled away, Emma took out her phone - noticing that her hand was shaking slightly - and texted Dane furiously. Spell check garbled her message, but she sent it as-is, mostly because she didn't think she'd be able to repair it anyway.

I think I cab getting todd awesome tonight, but nowhere you can seriously. At the Pest Control right now

Which meant: I think I can get him to do something tonight, but nowhere you can see. At the Pescadero right now.

This was also a fairly standard message between them, minus the name of the restaurant, which had overwhelmed the autocorrect so hilariously. It was a message that Dane would be likely to sort out, a message within the confines of their rules. There were few rules between them, and she was within all of them, but hovering on the edges of those blurry lines.

No dating, which wasn't what she was doing - this was *like* a date, but that was a necessary part of their game, part of her being seduced, so it was fine.

No doing anything with him that she wouldn't do with Dane. Check so far.

She had to tell him everything. Check.

She had to do her best to get video or pictures. It could be done.

She had to put on a performance. No problem there.

And then, if she felt any sort of feelings creeping in - non-sexual feelings - she was supposed to walk away.

Rafe was leaving the bathroom when her phone buzzed, and she tilted it, still inside her beach bag, to read it:

Hot. Have fun. I can't wait to hear about it.

Rafe paused by the bar to exchange a few words with the bartender, and Emma was grateful for the chance to stare at him. His body was more appealing today than yesterday, she liked the blue shirt, the shape of his chest underneath it. She liked that he was not particularly beautiful: he did

not have the sort of face that would have made her turn around, but there was something about it, slowly transforming in her mind as his personality emerged, that made him more physically appealing to her with every passing second.

She checked in with herself: there was nothing there but the sexual attraction. Was there? Just because it was intense, just because it had more to do with his mysterious ways, with the way he spoke and the brewing darkness behind his eyes, didn't mean there was anything emotional to it. Not the way that she and Dane meant when they made their rules.

He was walking toward her now. Eyes on her, again. Hot-cold electricity coursing through her, schizophrenic, brushing through every part of her, settling almost always in her lower abdomen and between her legs. Under her bikini, her nipples were hard as if he had brushed them to life with his fingertips.

"So," Rafe said, sitting down. "Now we decide what to do next."

*

"You are having a lover's quarrel?"

Dane knew, without being able to see clearly, that the legs that had come to stop next to him, only a foot away, far too close to be someone he didn't know, belonged to Brigitte. So for a moment, he was convinced he was dreaming, or that Brigitte had inserted herself so fully into his musings that she had appeared, like a genie from a bottle.

Her calves were longer, leaner, than a normal woman's, the kind of legs that made models drift down catwalks looking like impossible gazelles. They crossed, and her body floated down to the sand to an effortless crouch, as she spread out her sarong, sat on it, and stretched her long legs in front of her in a fluid movement that belonged on a stage somewhere. Her toes curled at the end of a stretch, and then one rubbed along her calf.

"What?" Dane stuttered, still unconvinced he wasn't talking to himself, or asleep. "Oh, no... just..." he looked back at the house. Brigitte was looking at him, a bored expression on her face, and she didn't follow the turn of his head. Her strange-colored eyes were on his face when he turned back.

Dane shifted, suddenly unnerved.

Emma was a hot woman, but she was a cute-hot woman. A solid eight, leaning into a nine if she did certain things to her hair and her face. As hot of a woman as ever paid any attention to him, but even then, she was the kind of hot woman Dane had to do a *bit* of chasing after. Still, women like *Emma* occasionally got drunk and floated into his orbit.

Women like *Brigitte* - stratospheric tens, women you spent most of your life suspecting didn't actually exist - did not sit down next to him and stare at him like this.

Dane figured that it was probably in the hardwiring of any guy to estimate his own prowess with women much higher than it actually was, to have a relentless optimism about the intention of women who talked to them, to convince themselves that women were hitting on them when they probably weren't. After all, most people judge other people's intentions based on what their own intentions would be, if they were doing the same thing. And most men, when they smiled at a woman, or talked to her, or did pretty much anything in the general airspace of a woman, had at least some small design on hitting on her.

That was men for you.

But Dane, like most men, also did this mostly as biological imperative. He wasn't serious about it. He knew, deep down inside, that most women were not thinking about his cock when they gave him change at the grocery store. Just because thoughts about their pussy fluttered like trapped birds in the cage of his mind, thanks to his chromosomes being what they were, did not mean that the same thing happened to *them*.

But Brigitte was not handing him change. She was basically wearing underwear, sitting next to him on an all-but-abandoned beach - and not casually next to him: *next to him*, next to him. Her hair was down and a breeze caught it, causing long fine strands to scrape deliciously against his arm. She smelled like ocean, red wine, and lemon, a faint scent of baby oil disturbingly adrift beneath those adult layers.

And her eyes were on him in a way that left very little room for interpretation.

"You know that you two do not give off the impression of a couple on their honeymoon," she said. Her hands suddenly and mysteriously held a cigarette and a lighter, which she brought together to light, without asking.

"I... we... I don't know what to say to that," Dane stuttered.

Brigitte was unimpressed, looking out at the water now, blowing smoke at it with a puff that made her lips bloom into puffy cherries. She brought one arm around her neck to pull her hair to the side. "I'm out of wine," she said. "So I am going to the store. You don't have any, do you? It's a very long walk to there." She brought the cigarette to her lips.

"Wine?" Dane said, his head spinning.

Brigitte let the smoke she had inhaled leave her mouth in a curved, slow-moving cloud, that she sucked into her nostrils while she looked at him archly. "Wine," she repeated. "It is a drink they make from grapes."

"I, uh..."

He did have wine. Very much wine, none of which they were drinking because it seemed absurd on a beach, in this weather. But wine for Brigitte seemed like an idea that was not entirely good.

They were not, after all, swingers. Emma had the affairs, and he enjoyed her having them. He didn't have affairs, and even though that wasn't technically an explicit rule, it was something he knew they had agreed upon.

"If your Emma is here," Brigitte said suggestively, "Have her come out."

This was delivered with such inescapable innuendo that it could have had no other effect than to plant thousands of wild, dirty thoughts in his mind and make his cock hard, except that his cock was already hard, as he noticed, when all Brigitte's comment did was make his dick pulse painfully against its own skin.

"I have both," he said, hearing his own voice and disbelieving it. Brigitte gave him a long, cat-like blink. "Red and white. Wine," he clarified.

She laughed, clearly to herself more than anything, and in that laugh he understood that her accent was, as Emma had suspected, French - and she was laughing at his American sense of wine.

"I like both of these... colors. If they are good wines. I cannot afford to be..." she seemed to search for a word. "Difficult. Here."

Dane turned his head out at the ocean, arms still hooked around his knees, and gave the water a look in the hopes that it would speak back to him, tell him he was dreaming, or give him a solution to the problem-not-problem that seemed to be brewing next to him. "Okay," he said, almost sarcastic. If Brigitte was the universe playing a joke on him - as she surely had to be - he would have her know that he was not taking it seriously.

Even if he was, he realized, going to play along.
He stood up, and Brigitte continued smoking. "I'll be back."
A stream of smoke shot out toward the water in reply.

*

When he reached the small gate that let out to the beach from their property, he was unsurprised to see that the beach was empty, and relief, as well as a good-natured laugh at himself and his male folly, traveled through him at the same time.

But it was short lived, because the dark black of Brigitte's bikini was lying where he had left her, on top of her nude-colored sarong, and the meaning of all that piled clothing was staring him in the face, but his mind was utterly incapable of processing it.

Then she was stepping out of the water, lithe body bare from head to toe, skin glistening in the bright light of their patio, limbs rolling along, breasts swinging lightly as she pulled her wet hair over one shoulder. Water snaked down her body, disappearing between her legs, cresting on the hardened nubs of her nipples.

And Brigitte herself just kept walking, eyes on him, a smile that was both provocative and sinister on her lips.

He had frozen in place, bottle in one hand, plastic glasses in the other, and was staring openly. He knew he should move, look away, walk toward her or away from her, but could not summon the power to do any of that.

Brigitte stopped when she reached her sarong, let her gaze linger on Dane for what seemed like an eternity but was really only a moment too long, before bending over to suspend her bikini bottoms and dip first one foot, then the other, into them, and slip them over her sinuous legs until they rested - quite precariously - on her hips. When she stood up, he saw that she had hooked the bikini over her neck, but it was dangling there and covering nothing. She pulled the straps lazily around her back, tying them quickly, and then shifted her breasts into the fabric.

Dane looked up the beach one way, and down the other, perhaps seeking some validation from another beach-goer that the scene before his eyes was, in fact, taking place. Maybe he was hoping for a witness, one who could later explain to Emma, or the police, or whatever was going to come from this event - which at that moment didn't seem like anything good

- that he had in no way participated in, suggested, or assisted with, the removal of Brigitte's clothing.

He willed himself to move forward. Just standing there with the wine felt idiotic, and retreating was advisable on one hand, yet inadvisable on the other. Brigitte's eyes fell on the wine as he approached.

"Emma did not want to join us?"

Dane blinked slowly. What had he said about Emma? He couldn't recall. "She's, uh... no."

Brigitte shrugged, turned, and sat down on the sarong again. "The water is invigorating, you should give it a try."

Dane was standing next to her, so he sat down, out of lack of ideas about what else to do.

Brigitte's hand covered his when she reached for the wine bottle, and her finger very unmistakably stroked the back of his hand just before she took it from him. His cock throbbed, his chest went tight, and he tried desperately to cobble together a thought in his head.

But none came, so he sat there, staring, while droplets of water rolled over Brigitte's skin and her forearms prickled with goosebumps, and he tried not to let his eyes wander to the small triangle of fabric between her legs, or the bare slit he had seen and now knew was beneath it.

"This is a decent wine," she commented. "I don't like this twist-off top, but..." she sighed, the very sort of exasperated French sigh that screenwriters wrote into movies for cartoonishly French characters who disapproved of wine.

She handed the bottle back to him, so he unscrewed it and poured her a glass, balancing the other wine glass precariously on the sand. Brigitte picked it up and traded with him after he finished pouring her glass. "You should let that... breathe," she said, as he poured, so he stopped and looked up at her.

She shrugged again. "But it is not important."

They clinked glasses, and Brigitte took a sip of her wine, staring out over the ocean as though pondering a physics problem and not the flavor of an alcoholic beverage.

"This beach is supposedly very dangerous at night," she said.

"Really," Dane commented. "You don't seem very scared."

Brigitte stretched her legs again, and Dane had to force his eyes to remain on her face. "I don't know," she said, the bored tone returning to her

voice. "You are the only person I see out here."

"Well, I'm not dangerous."

"No?"

Brigitte's question was unmistakably flirtatious in tone, and her eyes twinkled when he looked at her, her mouth curved in an unexpected smile.

Dane's chest contracted, and a cool feeling seeped through his core, dissolving into the raging heat in his groin. With nothing to say, and no way of believing what was happening right in front of his eyes, he remained dumbstruck and motionless as Brigitte's hand somehow found his thigh, and her lips moved closer to his face, close enough that a trace of tobacco reached his nose in the heat of her breath. Her fingers moved over his thigh, and then, there they were: unmistakably caressing the contours of his cock with a gentle, maddening touch.

His mouth opened and emitted nothing more than a puff of air. Brigitte's mouth was moving closer to his. A final, completed thought flitted through his head, a single bat in an empty cave. *You should not be doing this.*

Brigitte's lips tasted like salt and wine, they were cool, and in their center, broke apart into a hot, wet, fruit. He inhaled, feebly voicing an objection in his throat, but his mouth was not moving like a man who wanted to be freed.

"I think you are a very dangerous man," Brigitte said, when at last she came up for air. Her lips were next to his, her fingers had traveled to the waist of his shorts and were wriggling into them, and he still hadn't reacted, except to stare at her as she smiled devilishly. His brain was making every effort to reason with his body, to move, to do something, but Brigitte's smile and her wild eyes held him prisoner while her fingers found his hard cock and wrapped around it. He felt the pads of her fingertips slide over his crown, making his body jerk and eliciting a knowing smile as they glided over the oozing precum. She made circles over his head, lightly, and he felt like her fingers had made a whirlpool that was sucking him under.

"I like dangerous things," she murmured. "And it seems very, very dangerous to fuck right here."

His shorts were being peeled away, and he looked down at his cock, springing to life in the open air. Brigitte had a wicked grin on her face. He watched her hand close around his cock, and he felt himself strain against her grip with a pulse.

"Uh... wait, wait," he finally managed to say. "Oh shit. Brigitte!" He grabbed her hand, and held it tightly, not wanting to jerk it away because she was gripping his cock so fiercely. "I can't, um... I can't do this."

Brigitte gave him a look that was almost challenging. She glanced up at the house, and then back at him. "Think of how exciting it will be," she said. "And you will never, ever be able to do it again, because you will never be on your honeymoon again." She bit into his lower lip. His grip on her wrist loosened in his distraction. "It can just be our little secret."

Her head was moving down, her lips getting closer to his cock, her eyes teasing him.

He found the strength to push against his heels, scooting himself backward, sand flying, one hand out to ward Brigitte off. She had, thankfully, let go of his cock. "Look," he panted. "I... can't... do this."

Brigitte seemed intrigued by this. She let her arm fall over her lap, facing him on one hip, legs extended, one draped sensually over the other, her other arm propping her up in the sand. Her hair was drying, wisps drifting in the ocean breezes. She looked back at the beach house, gave a little jerk of her head, and met his eyes again as an amused smile curled her lips. "You are really going to turn down this chance when you have obviously married a woman who is going to... how do you say, put out...like one of these machines, with claws where you try to grab a stuffed animal? Where you will never win."

She gave him a scoffing, sharp laugh, and shook her head. Somehow, as she had been doing this, the hand draped over her lap had floated to his leg again. "If this is your honeymoon, you are going to have a very long marriage. But..."

Her fingers were stroking his thigh, and they were driving him wild. He pulled his leg away, gritting his teeth. "Okay, look," he said, and even as he spoke, he wasn't sure why he was doing it. It was almost as if he needed to defend Emma's honor, and maybe head off the wounds he would sustain to his male pride if Brigitte believed he would let his wife boss him around and withhold sex. "It's, uh, we're not really newlyweds," he said.

Brigitte cocked her head and narrowed her eyes, but her mouth revealed the perverse interest she took in this.

"It's a game we play," Dane explained.

Brigitte looked instantly bored. "But why?"

"Uh... well, we have an arrangement," he began. Brigitte's interest was again piqued. Her fingers, dangerously, had begun traveling up his leg again.

"I let.. um, well, I want, Emma to sleep with other men. So... we, uh... she does that, and she has rules she has to follow, and, uh, so do... I..."

Brigitte glanced back up at the house and pushed herself close to him. "So she is not even there," she said.

"Uh... um, no, she's... "

He was unable to continue talking, because Brigitte had gripped his cock again and was sliding along the side of his right leg, her warm skin like silk against him. She was looking up at him, her eyes on his, the hint of submission and all the pleasures that could come burning into his staring eyes.

Her breath was hot on the tip of his cock when she said, her lower lip brushing over the ridge of his crown. "So then you really *could* get away with it..."

"I am not, uh... supposed to..." his voice trailed off, the voice in his head screamed *shit! shit! shit!*, but nothing impeded Brigitte from closing her lips around the crown of his cock.

She shifted over him like some kind of evil spirit, her weight never really touching him. His cock was enveloped in the heat of her mouth and her tongue began to work expertly around his head, swirling and licking. Her lips slid to the base of his dick, her eyes on his until she could look at him no more. His stomach was cramping from the way he was perched, energy coiled, as he stared down at her head bobbing on his cock. The cool wet of her hair tickled his thighs, he could see her ass in the air behind her head, the black suit pushed slightly to the side to give him a perfect view of her right ass-cheek. He had to fight the urge to reach forward and grab it, pushing her into a contorted shape and forcing his cock even further down her throat.

But just the thought of doing that, combined with the vacuum she was creating as she sucked him off, made him hurtle toward the point of no return.

And then suddenly he was over it, flying high into the sky before the inevitable crash to the ground. His hands were balled into the sand, his pelvis lifted from the ground, Brigitte sucking diligently. His muscles tensed, and he braced for an orgasm he knew was going to deplete him.

Brigitte, however, released him from her mouth with a wet slurp. He exhaled, a wave of deep pain rolling through him. He stared down at her: she was looking at him.

He panted, balls aching, wondering what was going to happen next.

Her tongue darted from between her lips, her fingers closed around his cock and squeezed, and he stared at her tongue, which moved all around his throbbing crown, never touching it.

She grinned at him. "Do you want me to finish?" she asked him.

Dane exhaled, shifting his groin around, trying to get himself inside of her mouth, but she avoided it without seeming to move at all, always smiling, her eyes twinkling.

Her tongue flicked out and licked up a pearl of precum that had oozed out while she teased him, and she ran her tongue along her upper lip, smearing it across the puffy flesh.

"I don't want to get you in trouble," she purred.

Dane let out a heavy puff of air, almost anguished. He reached for her head, too late: her hand had let him go, and she had backed away, into a crouch. She was rolling up to her full height before he even realized what was happening.

Somehow, she had taken the sarong with her, and was tying it around her waist. Dane looked down at his cock, and then back at her face. She smiled: not an altogether unfriendly smile. A cigarette had come, just as before, from nowhere, and she lit it with her lighter of the same unknowable provenance.

"This is going to be so much more interesting than I had expected," she said.

And then, she was walking away, and Dane was alone on the dangerous beach, dick screaming, balls aching, and blood pounding so hard through his veins that he couldn't hear anything but the roar of the ocean over a tinny ringing that he hadn't heard since he was thirteen.

She faded into the night within moments: only glimpses of her movement appeared in pools of light that spilled from the houses along the beach gave any indication she had ever been there at all.

That, and Dane's painful erection.

He looked to the right and left before standing up, and then waddled to the house, having almost completely and totally forgotten about his wife,

who was out there, hopefully getting her pussy stuffed with an enormous cock.

*

They went to another bar, walking quite a way down the beach and then deep into the non-tourist sector, down a labyrinth of streets. Emma was unsure if she would ever be able to find her way home, a sense of danger growing inside of her, as Rafe strolled along, asking her questions about herself, seemingly oblivious to the changed atmosphere around them. Like the night before, Emma felt danger tickling inside of her, and it was both vaguely upsetting and thrilling.

When they arrived, at last, they ducked into a worn-down building with little paint and no sign of life, nothing on the rusting door to indicate there was a bar behind it at all. Emma's heart stopped again as it occurred to her that she might be getting murdered this evening. She opened her mouth to speak, to refuse to enter, but as soon as the door opened, a crowded, warm atmosphere spilled into the street, and she could see that it was in fact a bar, and a lively one, in full swing. As they stepped inside, she could hear a lot of people calling to Rafe from every direction, which she took for a good sign. As soon as the door swung closed behind them, a band that had evidently been between sets began to play loudly.

"Uh," Emma said, looking down at her cover-up. "I think I'm a little under-dressed."

Rafe cocked his head. "This is a beach town."

Emma peered inside: it looked like everyone was wearing clothing. "Uh..."

But his eyes met hers, and with their intense prowess, shut her down. Rafe guided her in front of him, and closed his hands over her shoulders, sending a chill down her spine yet again. He gently prodded her inside. His back was against hers as he pushed her forward, down a narrow aisle, the thumb of his right hand stroking her almost imperceptibly, sending a wave of goosebumps along her neck.

His grip on her was firm, and the crowd parted for them as he navigated her to a packed corner. Rapid Spanish was exchanged between everyone, and the occupants of a table and three chairs got up, slapped Rafe on the back, paid no attention to her at all, and disappeared into the crowd.

She leaned toward him over the small table. "Did those guys give their seats up for us? I feel sort of bad."

Rafe smiled and shrugged. "What do you want to drink?"

They were yelling, because there was no other way to be heard, and even so, Emma was piecing together what he was saying by reading his lips. The bar was rowdy, stickily hot with the warmth that steams off hot bodies, and the music was fun, but incredibly loud, Latin-sounding, but Emma wouldn't have known what to call it.

The evening went on like this, and talking to Rafe was almost impossible, because of the loud music and also because people continually stopped by to chat with him, leaning into his ear, causing him to laugh. Emma began to let herself get absorbed by the atmosphere: she had never been in a place like it in her life. She and Dane didn't go this far off the beaten track, to where the locals congregated. Her fear dissolved as she realized that no one was paying any attention to her whatsoever. The music was good, and it was probably the best people-watching she'd ever experienced.

And when she looked over at Rafe, even if someone was talking to him, he would inevitably change the direction of his gaze to meet her eyes. A gleam was in them, and she couldn't be sure what it meant for him: bringing her to this bar didn't appear to be a blatant act of seduction, because he was barely talking to her. But his wolfish gaze burned through her every time she caught his eye.

When she had first started hotwifing, it had been more at Dane's suggestion than something she had ever considered deeply herself. But it had been empowering, and she had grown into the role. It had become a game just as much about role playing and theater as about sexual encounters for her: a place where she could be someone else. And the someone else she tended to be was never, ever ensnared by the men she got involved with. It was always the other way around.

Rafe was different, and she knew that. What that meant, she suspected, was that she should drop it like a hot coal, get a taxi, go home, and spend the rest of her days by the pool. She could tell Dane that it just didn't work out. That was the safest plan.

All these thoughts were swirling around in her head as she listened to the music and watched. There was no room to dance but most people were

anyway, in small spaces around their tables. It got rowdy, but it never had the feel of a dangerous rowdiness.

She hadn't forgotten about Dane, that maybe she should text him, but it wasn't something she *had* to do. She could be out all night, as long as she followed the rules.

And she wasn't breaking them.

Not *really*.

Eventually the music ended, and the bar rang with the loud voices of people who were drunk and had been yelling over the music so long they didn't know how to reduce the volume. Glasses clattered, people spilled into the streets. Rafe finished his drink and leaned across the table to her. "Did you have a good time?"

She nodded vigorously, which was an honest reaction to her experience. "I've never been any place like this before," she told him.

She elicited a smile - another unreadable expression that sent electric tremors through her chest and made the back of her arms cold with pleasure.

Rafe adjusted his watch - an expensive-looking piece she hadn't noticed until now - to face him. "We should probably get you home, *Cenicienta*." He took her hand from the table and lifted it as he stood up, so there was nothing for her to do but rise with him.

There was a walk, in the dark neighborhood. Somehow the patrons of the bar had disappeared into the night and could not be heard or seen. On a larger street, Rafe hailed a taxi with an impressive whistle, and leaned in to speak to the driver, while Emma stood helplessly, trying to think of a way to prolong the evening, wondering why he hadn't hit on her more, thinking it was for the best that he hadn't.

"This guy is a friend of Alejandro," Rafe told her, opening up the back door of the cab. "That's your driver from the other night. So you will arrive safe and sane."

"And sane?" she asked, smiling, an uncontrolled, drunken coquettishness seeping out of her that she instantly wished she could retract.

Rafe paused, looking up at the sky, a serious expression on his face. Then he began speaking in Spanish without turning around, and startled Emma for a moment until she realized he was speaking to the driver. Whatever they said to each other caused them both to laugh.

"It's an expression," Rafe finally said. "I'm afraid we cannot agree on the right translation." He stepped back from the door and waved her in.

Emma hesitated. The competing forces inside of her pulled against each other, a feeling that was in and of itself delicious, and refreshing. She dropped her eyes to look at the inside of the taxi, then back to Rafe, whose searing eyes and confidently smiling mouth stared back at her, jolting her yet again.

She stepped off the curb and paused. "I, uh..."

Rafe put both forearms over the top of the open door, leaning toward her, the door between them. He reached out with one hand, put a finger on her jaw, high up, next to her earlobe, and traced the line of it to her chin. She shuddered, and knew that it was visible to him when she did. "You should go home now, Emma-bride. If not, you are going to do something you regret."

A sharp inhale made her mouth open, there was a stillness in the air for a moment. Rafe dropped his hand back to the top of the door. His expression now was almost challenging.

"Maybe that's what I want," Emma stammered.

Rafe stepped away from the car door. His smile was infuriating: she knew it wouldn't leave her mind that evening, or perhaps ever. He leaned back, his feet following, his hands still crossed over the top of the car door, expensive watch gleaming. "It's a very dangerous game you are playing, Emma, you know that, yes?"

His hands dropped from the car door, into his pockets, eyes moving over her face to take in her reaction. Emma was cold with the kind of icy chill that comes with being caught, her heart leaping in her chest like a loose frog for a moment, until she realized that he couldn't possibly be talking about *the* game. Not her game. Rafe was talking about the game her character was "playing."

"Go home, Emma," he told her. He moved around the car door, pressed his fingertips into the small of her back, and gently pushed her toward the cabin. In her ear, hot fingers of his breath igniting the skin on her neck, he said softly: "But the next time, I won't give you a way out."

Her calf was at the bottom of the car, there was no choice but to fall in. She had no idea what her face looked like, no way of thinking about it, because the only thing she was aware of was the way her insides boiled. Rafe shut the door after she pulled her legs in, hit the roof of the car twice,

and the taxi pulled away from the curb, Emma sitting with her mouth open, still as stone, burning up on the inside like she never had before in her life.

*

She went around the back of the house because she didn't have the keys to the front, and if the place had a doorbell, she didn't know where it was. Anyway, she and Dane had kind of a routine when she came home from "dates," and it didn't involve him opening the door for her.

It was almost two in the morning, which shocked her: she didn't know where all the time had gone. The house was dark, and when she entered, there was no sound from any of the rooms to indicate that Dane was awake. Probably he'd had too much to drink, and while she knew that he'd wake up if she went upstairs to rouse him with a delicious blow job, which is something she usually enjoyed doing after a hot date if he had somehow fallen asleep waiting for her, she hesitated.

Her pussy throbbed with desire, but something stopped her from going upstairs right away.

She opened the refrigerator and scanned the contents: her head was spinning, and the last thing she needed was another drink, but a half-empty bottle of white wine struck her fancy and she snatched it. She poured heavily into a tumbler and took a sip, staring out at the pool and the ring of lit beach beyond their fence. Beyond the light it was black, the ocean a distant hiss.

She didn't hear Dane come down the stairs, so she jumped when he slid his hand over her shoulder, and the wine dropped from her hand to land upright on the counter, sloshing out of the glass. His lips crushed her neck, he had been going in for a sensual kiss.

"Jesus!" she said, turning toward him. Her jumpiness was just as suddenly embarrassing, a source of shame, as if Dane had crept up on her secret thoughts as much as her physical person. He was smiling, hands moving all over her body. "So?" he asked, turning her toward him. He lifted her up and set her on the counter.

She put her arms over his shoulders, returned his sensual smile, and felt a stab of guilt because there was something false in it.

"*You've* been gone a long time," He was asking as his hands moved under her cover-up, rolling it up in an efficient movement to get at what

was beneath. His fingers were already curling at the waist of her swim bottoms to pull them down.

His mouth was on hers before she could answer, urgent and hungry. Since she was wild with desire she sank into his kiss, eyes closed, letting him explore her mouth, his tongue curious to taste something that didn't belong there. He sank his teeth into her lower lip as he pulled away, freeing himself to ask: "Any luck?"

Her bottoms were off, she had rolled from side to side to let him pull them off, and now his fingers were finding the hot liquid between her legs. He smiled at the discovery, eyes on hers.

She mewled: the hot touch of his skin had ignited her, and she wanted him inside of her, even if it wasn't exactly what she wanted. Her hands tugged at his shorts, she dipped inside of them to find his cock, hard as steel, and it throbbed in her grip when she closed her hand around him.

"What did you do?" he breathed.

It was a simple enough question, one she'd answered so many times before that she'd actually lost count. It wasn't as if she could answer wrongly: the filthier what she said, the better. That the mouth he was kissing had been full of another man's cock less than an hour ago, that she had swallowed his cum and licked it from her lips. Or that the cunt he was sinking his fingers into was sodden with Rafe's cum, that if he fucked her now he would be lubricated by the hot wet semen of the man who had just ravaged her. But that wasn't true, even if it was what he wanted to hear.

And somehow, the truth was more unspeakable: she hadn't gotten anywhere, she could say, but she didn't want to for some reason.

So instead of saying anything, she grinned, and pushed him gently back a step, sliding off the counter with her eyes on his. She pressed her palms to his bare chest, and sank to her knees, looking at him, watching his expression as her hands moved down his body and pulled the shorts with them.

With her hands on the backs of his calves, she took his cock into her mouth, looking at him as she swallowed all of it. It was a lie with no words, she knew: he might believe that this is what she had done, but she had never really said that.

His mouth opened, and she felt his hand on the back of her head, his cock pulsing in her throat, the salt of his precum at the back of her tongue.

Her eyes watered as she went to work, sucking him with a foreign enthusiasm, a performance of sorts.

Guiltily, she thought: *practice*.

The desire to close her eyes came to her, but she resisted it. She loved to look submissively at any man she serviced like this, to feel the vague humiliation of their stare, to fill her throat with cock and utterly submit to their pleasure, until their warm, bitter fluids exploded in her mouth. She loved the feel of Dane's cock, the bumps of his blood vessels pulsing against her tongue and cheeks when he was near a climax.

But inside her mind, she wanted to think about Rafe's cock, the contours of which revealed it to be large. She wanted to imagine his hand pushing her deeper, the rough fingers, how they would cradle her head differently. Would he pull her hair, drag his crown over her lips, slap her tongue? Or would his dominance be more subtle, like everything he did.

Another cold stab knifed her chest. She kept her eyes on Dane's and was relieved when - unusually for him - he lifted his gaze and looked straight ahead. She closed her eyes, let her fantasy of Rafe take over, and swallowed his cock completely.

Meanwhile, she slipped her right hand between her legs, into the hot, sticky mess of her pussy. She knew her own body, it was nothing to find her clit and rub it exactly as she needed, so that she was shuddering, moaning, in thirty seconds.

The sound of her moan inflamed him, and she felt the strain of his blood vessels, the surge of his orgasm as he seemed to grow even more. And then, just as the waves of pleasure were rolling over her and her whole body was shaking, his fingers balled her hair into a tight fist, making water squeeze from her eyes, and the bitter taste of his hot cum filled her mouth as he thrust into her face and the tip of his cock bounced on the far back of her throat. She gagged slightly, heard the sound of it, but barely registered the sensation because she had come so hard.

Thinking of Rafe, as cum spilled from the corners of her mouth and down her chin.

*

Emma leaned on the doorframe and put her hand on her hip. "You coming, sleepyhead?"

They had made love early in the morning, when Dane had woken up from a series of almost terrifying dreams, in which Brigitte and Emma changed places constantly while sucking his cock, which was erotic but unsettling, and the same could be said about the way they had fucked in the morning.

He felt guilty for what he had done and, before Emma had come home, he had resolved to tell her, then resolved to never tell her, and then changed his mind again and again, unfortunately settling on *not* telling her just before the scene in the kitchen. But after she had swallowed his cum, and it was rolling down her chin, he realized he wanted to go back in time and confess, but that it was too late. He was trapped in a lie of omission.

But something was up with *Emma*: she wasn't being herself. He had tried, after her amazing blowjob, to pry an answer from her about what had happened between her and Rafe, but she was slippery and impossible to pin down. It was unlike her, and it was sort of against their rules: she was supposed to tell him everything, and he sensed that she wasn't.

But his own guilt about not telling her about Brigitte's blowjob - something very definitively against the rules - made him hesitant to just come out and ask her if she was telling him everything.

After all, if she ever found out that *he* wasn't telling *her* everything, that he had let her give him a blowjob right after Brigitte had, his betrayal would be even more stunning if he'd had the audacity to be suspicious about *her*.

And, he had reasoned, there wasn't any proof of Emma doing anything wrong, per se. It was just a feeling that something was off, a sense that she was being evasive. He suspected that it could be his own guilt. The morning had immediately soured for him. This was the first dark turn their relationship had taken, and he didn't like it, but he didn't know what to do to fix it.

He was lying face up on the bed. "Ugh, I'm a little hungover for beach time," he complained, his heart rate fluttering as he basically told another lie.

Emma sighed. "Okay... well, I'm going out to the beach," she sang. "Just in front here, meet me out there when you feel better."

He listened to her pad back downstairs, futz around in the kitchen for a few more minutes, and then open the door. The air in the house shifted,

the curtains picked up as it sucked the warm beach air inward, and then fell back into place. It was a still, stifling day.

To be fair, he *didn't* really feel like being on the beach in this heat.

He reviewed his list of options, none of which particularly appealed to him, and turned over Emma's possible reactions in his head. He reasoned - now, when he was sober and the world was bathed in the stark white light of day - that he had really fucked up. Emma probably wouldn't have been mad if he had told her about his slip-up. *Before* the blowjob she'd given him. But now? He didn't know what her reaction would be.

He was seized by a sudden fear and sat up straight in bed. An image of Brigitte, sauntering down the beach in one of her skimpy bikinis, stopping right next to Emma, flashed through his mind. He kicked the strewn sheets out of his way and practically ran to the large window, using the sheer curtain to hide his nakedness, even though he knew no one could see into their house all the way from the beach. Through the palm trees lined up at the end of the yard, by the edge of the pool, it was possible to get a fairly decent view of the beach. If Emma went out far enough.

There was no one on the beach directly in front of their house. After all, it was noon, and natives stayed away at that time. Emma was insane parking herself out there in the strong sun, but she lathered herself in sunscreen and insisted that she enjoyed getting so hot she lost track of time.

His heart beat, feeling like it was lodged in his throat, as seconds passed and he held his breath. And then, emerging from the palm-tree border, came Emma's floppy black hat, her sand-colored skin, her tiny black bikini riding up a little on her ass, red beach towel in one hand.

He scanned the beach to the left and right for Brigitte's unmistakable figure, not that he could see much in either direction.

He stepped back from the window and took a breath.

Hot or not, he should probably keep an eye on this. Brigitte didn't seem like the type to cause trouble, but her final statement to him ("This is going to be so much more interesting than I had thought") made him wonder if she might not be a little psychotic.

Alternatively, he thought, a faint pulse thickening his cock, she also could just be a twisted nymphomaniac who wanted to suck his cock.

He shook his head, hoping that the bad ideas inside of it could be shaken away the way dogs shed water, and started to look for his swimming

trunks, a search that had to be done daily even though he had three pairs here.

*

"I can't believe you sit out here in this heat," Dane said, leaning over to kiss Emma, who was radiating heat from her skin like a baked rock.

"The hilarious thing," Emma murmured, "is that I'm not even getting a tan." She shifted on the towel, and Dane enjoyed the roll of her breasts. Droplets of sweat that had been collecting into shiny bubbles rolled away sweetly into the fabric of her bikini.

"You need some more sunscreen," Dane said, smiling. "Let me put it on for you."

Emma smiled, and didn't move. "Okay, but can I just lie here and get lubed up? I'm in that overheated zone." She was referring to her heat-coma.

Dane rubbed his hands together. "Not a problem."

The sunscreen had warmed almost to the point of being too hot, so he held it in in his hands to cool it down as he knelt next to Emma and surveyed the expanses of creamy skin that would soon be sliding beneath his palms. Then he got to work, starting on her chest, dipping his fingers beneath her bikini, his cock throbbing to life as he massaged Emma's skin. She had a faint smile on her lips, but he knew she wasn't taking this in quite the same way he was: Emma really did just want to continue lying in the sun and enjoying the feeling of being, as she called it, "naturally baked."

"Am I getting tan lines?" she murmured, as he lingered on her breasts.

"A little," he told her.

Emma hissed. "I guess maybe I could just go topless like *Brigitte*." She said Brigitte with a fake French accent.

Dane didn't expect to hear her name, and his hands lurched to a stop, his heart pounding in his chest. He hurried back to rubbing in the lotion, hoping that Emma hadn't noticed how he had stiffened, or somehow sensed that his entire abdomen had turned to ice at the mention of Brigitte's name.

Until that moment, it had seemed like the precarious situation he'd gotten himself into might evaporate in the heat. The beach was hot and Emma was content, baking in the sun and getting shinier with each passing moment. He had located a beach umbrella and struggled with it for thirty minutes, but it was at last situated and blocking the sun, and he was content

with a beer that had at least started out cold. The beach wasn't particularly busy, and, most importantly, he had not seen Brigitte loping down the beach to possibly ruin his marriage.

He moved his way down Emma's body, rubbing her toned legs, enjoying the feel of her lean muscle beneath his hands. A measure of awkwardness hung in the air because he hadn't said anything in response to Emma, so he tried to fill it by saying - much too late - "Yeah, you should."

Even as he said it, he realized it was coming almost a minute after Emma had spoken, and he wished he could take the comment back. It had dropped, like a stone, into the silence. He watched Emma's face: if anyone was going to pick up on something being "off," it was Emma. But she just rolled slightly with the movement of his hands and said nothing. The faint smile was still on her lips. He hadn't aroused suspicion in her, but oddly, his guilt only deepened for a moment.

Emma's smile was the kind he enjoyed seeing: Emma was daydreaming, and it would have delighted him to know that she was daydreaming about Rafe while he rubbed lotion into her body. Emma had been doing this for a long time, and she only got filthier and put on more of a performance with every new lover, to the point that he was practically salivating to see what she would come up with next. His troubled thoughts about Brigitte were crowded out: maybe there would be no more Brigitte, and hopefully there would be more Rafe, and then they would go home.

Emma moved after he rubbed lotion into her feet. She rolled over, and settled onto her stomach. It was an invitation to rub the rest of her, and hopefully, if he did it right, Emma would no longer be interested in sun-baking.

He started at her feet, lingering behind her knees, watching goosebumps as they traveled up her thighs, spread across the backs of her arms when he dribbled the hot lotion onto the indentation where her buttock and thigh met. He used a single finger to drag the sunscreen lightly along the crevice, and Emma smiled and shuddered. He rubbed, and then let his fingers wander under the fabric, onto her firm ass, down to the crack, seeking her perineum, and then toward her pussy -

Two long, lean legs were standing at the head of Emma's towel when he looked up, and his fingers stopped, along with his heart. He jerked them from under Emma's bikini bottom and froze, and Emma complained in a throaty murmur. "I was just getting into that..."

The legs were Brigitte's: he knew this before lifting his eyes. One foot bearing more weight than the other, slightly crossed at the knee, hand on hip. The scent of her cigarette drifted into his airspace, as his eyes traveled up, over the cream crocheted bikini bottom, the golden navel with the deep oval belly button, the overripe breasts that seemed to be caught in a fisherman's net rather than a swimsuit.

"Don't let me interrupt," Brigitte murmured, in her dry way, laughing a little in her eyes and her mouth.

Emma pushed herself up onto her elbows. "Oh, Brigitte," she said, in a truly friendly tone, which only served to make Dane more terrified and feel much worse. He himself was poised with both hands in the air, like a deer in the headlights. Brigitte was - sort of - smiling at him.

His stomach sloshed in circles, filled with ice.

"We were just talking about you," Emma said, putting a hand to her forehead and arching back to look up at her.

Brigitte's response was to bring her cigarette to her lips and inhale thoughtfully.

"I am going to a party this night," Brigitte said, as though people told her all the time that they were talking about her, and she clearly was not the type to care. "It's unexpected, some locals who know friends of other friends, but you see it will be a lot more interesting than these old people you see on the beach every day." She lifted a hand to the entanglement of crochet that was serving as her swimsuit and extracted a small piece of paper. "This address is at the end of the beach, a blue house."

Emma reached up for the paper. "Hey," she said. "Thanks. That's... that actually sounds like a lot of fun. Doesn't it, honey?" Emma looked behind her.

Then, in a series of terrifying seconds, Emma looked back at Brigitte, then back at Dane, as though she was figuring something out. His heart fell through the floor, beating so quickly that he thought he might suffer an attack.

"Oh, sorry," Emma said. "I forgot. You two don't know each other. Brigitte, this is my husband, Dane. Dane, Brigitte."

"We have met," Brigitte said almost immediately, and Dane's heart attack picked up speed. His mouth fell open. Brigitte had a mischievous smile on her lips. His groin felt like someone had kicked it.

Emma looked back at Dane. "Oh yeah? When was that?"

In books, the world was often described as "spinning out of control," and it was one of Dane's least favorite expressions. But at that moment, his world actually did seem to be spinning around him, and he struggled to make his lungs work.

"At the margarita bar, the one with Jose," Brigitte said, after letting Dane panic silently for a few beats longer than necessary.

Emma looked up at Brigitte. She squinted both from the sun and befuddlement. "Oh. Okay. Well... thanks so much for the invite."

She sounded very pleased when she said that.

Dane's stomach was contracting with such force he was pretty sure it would turn into a black hole in a minute or two. "Yeah," he said, and his voice was creaky. "Uh, thanks."

"Do you want to join us here?" Emma continued cheerfully.

The pause between this question and Brigitte's answer seemed like an eternity to Dane.

"I am going to the store," Brigitte said. "Come to the party if you can be away from your *newlywed* bed for the evening."

She called this last bit over her shoulder, because she was already walking away, lovely long legs moving lazily, ass taut beneath the cream crochet suit.

Emma looked at her for a minute, and then back at Dane, who she hit playfully on the thigh. "You didn't tell me about your margarita time with *Brigitte*," she said.

Dane's heart was racing. Now. Now was the time to roll onto his ass, fold up his knees, stare at the water, and say, "Listen, Emma..." and tell her the whole story. Right now.

If not now, *never*.

He put his hands together. "I forgot about it," he said. "It wasn't that memorable."

Emma looked at him, something probably sinister behind her eyes, but he couldn't see because of her sunglasses. Then she turned and lay down, arranging herself on the towel. "Must not have been," she said.

He started to rub lotion into her back, his mind completely taken off the joy of massaging Emma's supple skin.

"So?" Emma said after a while. "What do you think?"

"About?"

He really was that distracted.

"The party, silly," Emma said, putting her chin on her hands. She looked behind her, reaching with one hand for his thigh to tickle him.

"Where *are* you?"

She put her hand back. Dane continued to rub lotion into her back, her playfulness turning his guilt into an acid, eating away at him. He actually did feel a little ill. He sighed. "I, uh, think I drank too much. And it's too hot."

"Go cool off in the pool," Emma said simply, turning her cheek to her towel. "I'll be up there soon."

When Dane didn't move, she added, "I vote for party."

"What about Rafe?" he said. He felt hollow.

Emma shrugged and turned her head the other way.

"No sense putting all your chips on one number," she said quietly.

CHAPTER 4

The party with the enigmatic Brigitte seemed like the perfect solution to her problems. For one thing, it would occupy her time, so she wouldn't be tempted to return to Rafe, who was beginning to feel a little like a drug habit: something she should quit while she still had the chance. It was for the *best* that she never saw him again, and maybe one Rafe-less night would clear her head.

There was always the possibility, however slight, that these friends of Brigitte's would be attractive, open-minded people, and something could come from that. She and Dane could reset their game, start over again, and she would be back in control like she always was.

And preferred to be.

Or did she?

She dismissed that final thought and threw things out of her suitcase looking for a dress that would be sophisticated enough to wear at something Brigitte was attending, and yet not too over- or under- dressed to look out of place no matter what the atmosphere of the party was.

She let out a sigh of frustration. "I wish I had asked her what kind of party it is," she complained loudly.

Dane was in the shower, and he didn't answer.

She put two dresses side by side on the bed. One was a black, loose-fitting cotton dress that had the magical property of being easy to make appropriate for anything. But it wasn't particularly sexy, except for the cowl neck. The other dress, an olive crocheted beach dress with a severe dip in the center and a very short hem, looked hot on her, but if this party turned out to be in any way formal, she would look as ridiculous as she had last night in a cover-up.

She chewed her lip and tsked. That really hadn't been that much of a problem.

And she wanted to look good. More opportunity, she told herself.

New opportunity. A chance to escape the strange grip that Rafe had on her.

She tossed her hair over her shoulder almost defiantly. She was having an argument, she realized, with herself.

Because deep down inside, she knew, as she picked up the olive dress, that she wanted to look good for a reason that had nothing to do with Brigitte's party. Because somewhere in her darkest soul, she was already playing out scenarios by which she left the party and wandered back home on her own, and ran into Rafe.

And then, he came through with his promise.

She rolled her eyes. That wasn't going to happen, and that was *why* she was insisting on going to this party, which Dane seemed curiously reluctant to go to.

"Why is it you want to go to this party so much?" he asked again, as though reading her mind. She was walking into the bathroom, tugging the crochet dress into place. "I thought you were making good progress with that guy."

She felt a punch of guilt in her chest and picked up some earrings to hold them against her ears. They shook in her hands. "He's just... I don't know," she snapped. Hearing her own voice, she moved quickly to smooth it over. "I'm hedging my bets. He's a slippery character."

Dane put his hands on the shower door and peeked over it at her. "That dress is hot," he said, after seeming to think for far too long.

Emma looked at herself from several angles and decided to keep the dress. She left the bathroom, calling out behind her that she was going to make them some drinks.

*

They walked to the party along the beach, because, like all "addresses" on the island, the one Brigitte had given them didn't quite make sense. If the name of the street scrawled on the paper in her square, French script existed, it was a secret that not even Jose the bartender knew about. They knew because they stopped to ask him, and have a margarita on their way, and Jose squinted mistrustfully at the paper and shook his head.

"Just walk on the beach until you hear a party music at a blue house," he suggested, when they repeated Brigitte's directions.

This had made Emma laugh, and so Dane smiled warily. He had been hoping that they wouldn't find the party in the end. Going to a party with

Brigitte and her casual, overflowing sexuality, and her damaging secret, felt like lying underneath a blade, swinging on a pendulum, creeping ever-closer to his neck.

Emma was drinking, but not with as much abandon as she usually did on vacation, which also worried him a little. It might have been helpful if she had gotten blasted, dulled her senses, and been impervious to whatever little crumbs Brigitte might accidentally drop.

Emma gave her hair a toss and pushed her half-finished margarita toward Jose. "Okay," she said. "Let's head."

"You're not done with your margarita," Dane objected.

Emma shook her head. "It's giving me brain-freeze."

He was done with his own, and he didn't need to be blasted walking into the dragon's lair, so he shrugged. "Okay. That's a first." He paid Jose, and they started off down the beach in the direction of the party.

As it turned out, there was no need to go looking: the jazz music, the clattering of dishes and glassware, and the murmur of people on the cusp of having a very good time, could be heard a long way off, and as they approached, it was plain to see that all of it was tumbling from the porch and open doors of an enormous, purple-blue beach house.

Emma gripped his arm as they approached. "Oh my God," she whispered, smiling. "I think I see... yes, I do... *several* people under the age of seventy."

Dane slowed to a stop, and Emma kept walking until her linked arm tugged on Dane's. She looked back at him, bewildered.

"This isn't even Brigitte's house," he said, as one final, possible "out" occurred to him. "We're going to look like we're crashing."

Emma looked at him skeptically, opened her mouth, and then turned back to the party. "We just say -" she began, and then she unlinked her arm and stepped forward. "There," she said, raising a hand and waving at Brigitte, who had appeared like a genie on the porch and raised her own arm in greeting. "There's Brigitte. Problem solved."

Emma started walking toward the party, looking back only once at Dane, her face a mixture of teasing and confusion, but she didn't look long.

Heart heavy, Emma's shoes in his hand, Dane followed. Brigitte, stunning in a white sheath of a dress that looked like little more than a long, wet, wife-beater tank top, out of which her obscene body was spilling

beautifully, leaned against the railing of the porch and stared as they approached.

Right at him.

A terrible smile on her bee-stung lips.

*

Brigitte made his heart stop on multiple occasions during the first half of the evening. She pulled Emma into the house right away, taking her by the hand and waving Dane over to a table with drinks as she hustled his wife away.

There were maybe thirty people in the house, and Dane was certain he had never seen most of them on the beach: he would have remembered. No one was as stunning as Brigitte, but they were mostly much younger than the usual beach crowd, and had the kind of tanned, bleached look that people can only attain by living in a tropical climate for months or years.

They had brought a bottle of wine and a bottle of rum, but apparently there was no need for either, because there was a man in a tuxedo, who was evidently a caterer, behind a table set up like a bar. Dane set the bag with the booze down in an inconspicuous corner and vowed to leave it there and deny it being his if anyone asked.

Despite the caterer's tux and the open bar, it seemed like a casual party: everyone was dressed in nice clothes, but beachwear abounded. He ordered himself a Rum and Coke but waited for the ladies' drinks. Spinning around, he looked for Emma and Brigitte, and found them huddled with a small cluster of people, Brigitte's long arm slung over Emma's shoulder like they were best friends.

His mind filled with images of Brigitte and his wife together, kissing, tongues darting between their open mouths, lips sliding down the length of his shaft until meeting at the crown, where they battled to suck the precum from his dripping hole. His cock was hard when he ordered his second drink, and by the time it was made, his mind was already sinking into terrifying, non-erotic possibilities: like Brigitte leaning in close to Emma to whisper: "I sucked your husband's cock on the beach last night."

He staggered towards them and slipped a hand around Emma's waist to interject himself in the group. He ignored Brigitte, stared at the man directly in front of him, and nodded and sipped his drink while his thoughts

were miles away, bouncing between fantasies of Brigitte and Emma together, and the expression of angry betrayal that Emma would wear if Brigitte told her what had happened.

"Oh. Here he is. Here is Dane." Brigitte told her friends as she introduced him. "Emma and Dane are here on their honeymoon," she declared, which elicited a round of congratulations and puzzled looks. Brigitte put her hand on Dane's shoulder, sending a jolt of fear through him. "But they have decided to take a break and come visit us."

Brigitte dropped her hand from his shoulder, but not without dragging her fingers along his spine. Knowingly. Dangerously. His cock thickened, and his gut went ice-cold as he strained to see, in the corner of his eye, where Emma's line of sight was trained.

Emma turned to him. "You didn't get me a drink?" she complained. Her tone was light, her mouth turned up in a smile.

"I didn't... know what you wanted," Dane stammered. "This is a rum and Coke..."

Emma took it from his hands. "That's perfect," she said. She leaned in, close to his ear. "I'm going to go mingle around, see if there's anyone, you know, interesting."

She had turned to face him, and she leaned in close to his body, her fingers wandering to the contours of his hard cock. It pulsed as she brushed over it, and she smiled, turning, chipper, toward the rest of the party.

A stab of guilt traveled through Dane: Emma was probably thinking that his hard cock was for her, and the temptation of a performance that she was going to seek a chance to put on. She could have no way of knowing that it was, in part that, but in a larger way, it was a hard-on related to Brigitte, to the dangerous way she was flirting with him, and to the guilt he was feeling that, almost impossibly, was as arousing as it was awful.

He made his way back to the bar.

Brigitte appeared at his side, floating to the edge of the table and bumping against it slightly, several feet from him but too close: her scent, the heat of her body, the memory of her mouth on his cock, all invaded his space. She turned and leaned her small, pert ass against the table, surveying the party. "She certainly goes to work very fast, your little hotwife," Brigitte said, making Dane's heart stop yet again. He jerked his face in her direction, wanting to shush her. She was speaking loudly enough that anyone could have heard her.

She looked over at him and smiled. She was obviously enjoying his discomfort. "Come outside while I have a cigarette," she said.

Dane looked nervously over at Emma, while Brigitte took him by the arm. "Give her some space to do her 'thing,'" Brigitte cooed. She looked over her shoulder as she pulled Dane with her. "Don't worry, we won't let her out of our sight." She shrugged, and then, incongruously, in a breathy voice, added: "I want to see her in action."

Brigitte pulled him halfway across the porch and then released his arm, as she continued to walk to a bench seat, where she plopped herself down and crossed her legs, flashing her bare pussy as she did. She didn't seem to care if Dane followed her to sit down, but she had marooned him there in the middle of the porch and he felt like an idiot, so he sat down next to her, edging a foot away.

Brigitte's eyes were on the living room, and through the shifting throng of people, they could occasionally see Emma's olive-colored dress. Brigitte blew a plume of smoke lazily at the sky and smiled.

Dane cleared his throat. He wasn't used to women making him nervous: Emma was the only one who could do that, and she only did it because he wanted it done to him. Brigitte was a much different animal, and it didn't help that she was as hot as she was. The white dress she was wearing was barely a dress, almost see-through, and left nothing of the shape of her magnificent body to the imagination. Combined with her infuriating, deadly calm, and the hint of malice behind her smile, she was driving him wild, even though he very much would have preferred she wasn't there at all.

"So... how do you know all these people?" Dane asked, idiotically.

Brigitte smiled, let out a puff of smoke, and turned to him. "Are you really interested in the answer to that question?"

Dane huffed. "Brigitte," he began. He took a sip of his drink. "This is really... a bad situation."

Brigitte ran her tongue along her upper lip, and blinked slowly, as though her long lashes were too heavy to flutter. "Did she get her man?" she asked, and the question was so unexpected to Dane that it seemed like another language, and he had to pause, beneath Brigitte's impassive stare, as his brain tried to make out what it meant.

"Did she...?"

"Emma. The man she was out with the other night? Did she *get* him?"

Dane stammered a few half-formed words, trying to start a sentence. It wasn't any of Brigitte's business, and he felt like he ought to tell her so, out of loyalty to Emma. It felt a little traitorous, speaking to Brigitte about their secret plan, when he hadn't even told Emma that he'd spilled the beans about their relationship to Brigitte.

And he had almost spilled slightly more than that, which really made things worse.

But also, he realized: he didn't really *know* the answer to Brigitte's question. Emma had seemed to answer him by sucking on his cock, but that wasn't a real confirmation of anything. He wanted to ask her, clarify it more, but he felt too guilty about what he had let Brigitte do to him to ask any detailed questions about blowjobs.

"Not really," he finally answered, just as Brigitte began to look annoyed with him.

"Hmm," she answered, noncommittally.

Then - and Dane was grateful for this - she rose, putting her cigarette out in a plant pot, and began to walk back into the party.

Dane huffed again and remained where he was. He wanted to follow Brigitte, who he had no trouble believing might have been planning to slink into the house, up the stairs, and lay down naked on a bed for him. But his legs felt like lead and his erection was embarrassingly evident, so he stayed put and wished for his Cuba Libre, watching Brigitte disappear without looking back.

"Fucking Christ," he said, under his breath.

*

Emma was pale when she pushed him backward into the bathroom, so for a moment he thought she was sick, and moved out of her way so she could reach the toilet. She spun around and shut the door, locking it, instead. Then she whirled again and stared at him, stunned.

It was then that his heart stopped for what seemed like the tenth time that night.

She was stunned, and she was furious, and it was because Brigitte had told her everything.

Dane's stomach twisted, his heart jerked back to life spasmodically in his chest, and he opened his mouth to say something, quickly, to stop the

damage.

"He's here," Emma hissed, before he could speak.

"He...?" Dane said, disoriented yet again.

"Rafe. Him. The guy. He's *here*."

Dane's brain had gone completely blank. A wave of relief had come through and washed everything out to sea.

So he stared stupidly at his wife, without saying anything.

Emma approached the mirror and looked at herself in it, unconsciously adjusting her hair, making her mirror-pouty-face. She pulled a tube of lip gloss from the little purse he had brought and unscrewed it.

"What do I do?" she asked, as she looked at the bottle.

Dane watched her apply the gloss, smearing it sensually over her lips. Her eyes seemed more troubled than usual.

"Why... why is he here?" Dane said stupidly.

Emma met his eyes in the mirror. "Of course he's here," she said, almost as if he had started an argument with her. "I mean, we should have figured that... out. This is like, a party for all the expats and seasonal people who live here and are under a thousand years old. Of *course* they're all friends." She sighed, looking at herself in the mirror. "We should have known."

Her tone was strange.

Dane's blood was pounding. He leaned against the wall. "You don't sound happy," he said.

His mind was flying, though: he didn't know if Emma sounded happy or not. *He* should have been happy, but he wasn't: if Emma dedicated herself to Rafe now, it would leave him alone at the party with Brigitte, and no supervision. Brigitte might even see Emma leave with Rafe, and who knows what insane idea Brigitte would come up with after that?

And he would probably go along with it.

Emma was looking at herself. "No, I'm... it's good, I guess," she said. "I just... didn't expect it, is all."

"Has he seen you yet?"

Emma met his eyes in the mirror and shrugged.

It was a curious gesture. One he would have thought more of, if he had not been so preoccupied with Brigitte and the problems she was causing him. Then she narrowed her eyes and turned toward him. "Hey. Are you okay?"

"Why?"

Emma looked at him. "You just look... weird."

Dane's stomach flipped again, and he found himself rushing, blindly fumbling, trying to dispel the idea in Emma's mind that *anything* unusual was happening. He slid his hand along her cheek and smiled, pulling her toward him with gentle pressure from the pads of his fingers. "What? No. I'm just surprised, that's all." He moved his lips over hers. "It's exciting," he whispered, and his cock throbbed against her leg. "Maybe him being here is a sign."

They kissed, and he started to feel better as Emma softened and blossomed beneath his fingers and the movement of his lips. He could tell by the way she was moving beneath his hands that she was turned on.

He slipped his fingers under her skirt, working them beneath her panties. When he found her pussy drenched, he gave her a knowing smile. She obviously *wanted* to chase after Rafe. "You're glad he's here," he told her.

He had meant for it to sound like a question, but it didn't come out that way.

Emma gave her head a small shake to get her hair from her eyes, and looked at him, her eyelids half-closing as he stroked her clit. "I am," she said.

If he had been listening better, he might have heard that her answer sounded more like a question than a statement, that it was missing her usual confidence, that it sounded almost like a resignation.

Instead, he heard what he wanted to hear, and he bit gently into her lower lip. "Go get him, tiger."

Brigitte had flown out of his mind.

Emma looked down at the counter, thinking, then back at him. "How should I lure him in, though?" she whispered.

Dane bit gently into her lower lip again.

"Make sure he sees you leave. Alone. He'll follow."

Emma's eyes searched his. At the time, he took it for her processing the possibilities of his suggestion, mulling over whether or not it would work. She looked as though she was about to say something, and then she slid away from him, adjusting her skirt, and paused at the door, looking behind her.

"Wish me luck," she said.

"You don't need it," he told her, which is what he always told her.
She slipped out of the bathroom.

Dane exhaled sharply.

Now all he had to do was get out of here before he got into trouble more with Brigitte.

*

The scent of tobacco preceded him, and she knew, without ever having seen him smoke, that it was him, without turning around. His footsteps were unhurried, but he caught up to her just the same, and just before he slipped a hand around her waist, her chest went tight: what if it *wasn't* him?

He turned her as he caught her, and she looked toward him. The features of her face refused to cooperate to convey surprise, or the fear she had just felt: instead, she could feel her mouth moving in a hybrid smile. She was nervous, she was relieved, she was happy to see him, and she was afraid of him.

But she didn't speak, or protest, or hesitate, even if some of those ideas occurred to her. Once she was turned, he slipped his hand down to hers, and pulled her along and into one of the passageways between two buildings that gave access to the beach from the street.

They were in the shadows. Around the corner of one building, a feeble streetlight cast an indirect sodium-orange glow into the darkness, but it barely penetrated. Moonlight bathed the beach, and reflected off the sand, but his face was stark contours, his eyes dark. He pushed her into a wall and pinned her there with the weight of his body. She could feel his cock against her thigh: it was hard, sizable, and its shape aroused her. The hand he had guided her with was pressed to the wall, but he left the other free. She let it hang by her side, a gasp escaped her lips, and then there was a moment of burning quiet while they breathed heavily and said nothing.

"Do you know something Emma?" he said, using his own free hand to trace his fingers down her neck to her collarbone, where he paused to stroke it gently while looking down at what he was doing. "I'm starting to think that there is something very different going on here than what you've told me."

The uncomfortable but also delectable cold pang of being caught coursed through her, and her lips parted, but she didn't know what to say. Rafe was looking in her eyes. "Your husband does not seem very bothered that you are wandering around late at night, on the beach, like bait. In fact," Rafe dipped his fingers into her shirt, stroked her skin in circles, avoiding her nipple and making her arch her back slightly, to better offer it to him as the need for him to touch it gnawed at her. "It almost seems as if he *wanted* you to get followed by a man. By me, in fact." Then he rolled her left nipple between his thumb and forefinger, and Emma mewled. He was an expert with his fingers, and she instinctively knew that he would be an expert with everything else.

His lips had moved closer to hers, constantly, so that now they brushed over her mouth as he spoke, driving her wild. "Is this right, Emma? That your husband wants you to be a dirty slut?"

He was staring at her, and when she tried to kiss his mouth, he pulled back ever-so-slightly. He wanted his answer. He was smiling, even more dangerously than before.

"Yes," Emma whispered, because she was sure she wouldn't be able to say anything else.

Rafe bit into her lower lip, gently, sucking in with pleasure as he did so, sending a thrilling chill down her spine. His hand moved to her thigh, found it trembling, and began to move slowly along her inner muscle, creeping toward her panties, sticking slightly where her skin was damp and hot. "So this was a game you play, this newlywed game?" he asked.

Emma smiled, though it was laced with fear: there was no reading in the shadows what Rafe's face was actually expressing, no way of knowing what his reaction would be when she told him the truth, which he seemed to already know. She was suddenly acutely aware of the strength of his body, the firmness of his muscles enticing but vaguely threatening. "It's just a game," she breathed.

His fingers reached her panties, and he stroked the damp material lazily. She thought he smiled, but couldn't see clearly, his lips were too close to hers to have had a view of their shape even if it had been light enough to see.

"A game you intended to play, all the way to the end?" he asked. "Is that right? Or are you the sort of couple who only tease, and then lose your nerve?"

He hooked a finger under her panties and sank it into her slit. This time the grin of satisfaction was evident when he brushed his lips over hers. When she didn't answer, he pushed against her clit with his thumb, and her muscles jerked, her abdomen tight. "Hmm?"

"I don't lose my nerve," she whispered shakily.

He gripped the wrist he was pressing against the wall and brought it over her head, at the same time that he ripped her panties away from her skin. She heard them break, twisting, sinking between the lips of her pussy before he tugged again and they slipped, loose, away from her cunt. He plunged two fingers inside of her, growling, as his mouth engulfed hers and her head hit the wall behind her. He finger-fucked her for a few moments, and her abdomen knotted up tightly with the pulsing excitement that grew in waves until she almost crested.

Then he paused, causing her head to spin with the disappointment of being so close to coming. "What are the rules of your game, then, Emma?"

She shook her head. "Nothing," she whispered. "They're... it's just for fun."

He started to stroke her clit again, clawing toward the root of it from inside her. Her pussy pulsed around his fingers. "Nothing," he repeated. And then his fingers slowed.

She could not help letting a mewl of disappointment escape her.

"No rules?"

She shook her head, though with less conviction than she might have liked. She couldn't see his eyes or the expression on his face, only feel the way his body tensed and his cock pulsed against her. He didn't believe her, and with his fingers he communicated to her that she would not be released from this torment unless she told him what he wanted to hear.

Her breath left her mouth, in a hot, desperate, puff. "They're just... basic rules," she said.

Rafe burned through her with his stare. "Elaborate."

"I have to tell him what I do..."

Rafe rewarded her by pulling the hood of her clit away from its face, but no more, the promise of his fingers gently swirling her to relief implicit in the way he stroked her from the inside in weak caresses that would take ages to break her open.

"I don't do anything with you that I wouldn't do with him," she whimpered.

"Mmm," Rafe said, his lips on hers again, just barely touching them. "And is there anything? That you wouldn't do?"

Emma stared at him, her chest cold with fear, her pussy pulsing with wild arousal. Rafe drew her close to the edge again and stopped, waiting for her answer. "I don't... I don't know."

Her pussy stung slightly as he pushed a third finger inside of her, deep. He tipped his head to her ear, his breath hot against her neck, lips grazing her lobe. The tip of his tongue traveled the half-circle of her outer ear soundlessly, expertly, and she shuddered. He impaled her further, and his mouth was fully covering her ear as he whispered:

"Do you want me to make you come, Emma?"

She tipped her head back, and her cunt squeezed around his fingers. Somehow, she managed to say "yes," in a whisper, before a whimper left her mouth. He stroked her clit, and she ground against him, wanting mostly at that moment to be flung over the edge, because the boiling of her blood, the severe cramping in her abdomen, the ache in her pussy, were all too much to bear.

"Then I want something from you," he breathed, and a fire of gooseflesh raced down her neck, down the center of her back, spreading over her arms and her shoulders. Another whimper left her throat, one she was unable to stop.

She waited, trying to move, but could not extract from her confined movements enough of a caress to free her from her fever.

"I want you to break some rules for me. Do you think you could do that, Emma?"

She was panting, desperate, and thoughts were evaporating as soon as they formed in her mind. The only thing she could think of was her hunger to come, to feel Rafe inside of her, to submit to him, to please him. If only to get what she wanted.

His hand stopped moving, and her head tipped forward to his neck as she let out an anguished howl.

"Okay," she pleaded, "okay, okay."

"Say it for me," he growled, his fingers going deeper, stretching her pussy, "tell me you will be a very bad girl, and break your hotwife rules, for me."

Emma breathed into his chest and squirmed. Her voice was anguished, she was making noises that she never made. Somewhere in the

back of her mind, a thought flickered: she could just tell him what he wanted to hear, and that wouldn't really be breaking the rules.

"I won't... I mean, I will. I'll break the rules."

"For me," he said, nudging her head back against the wall.

His fingers were slipping from inside of her, the pain of their absence threatening to drown her like a wave.

"For you," she gasped. The desperation in her own voice scared her, thrilled her: it was as raw as her flesh felt. She had begged before as part of an act, part of a role-playing game or submission. But she was really begging now, and her legs went weak as the twisted pleasure of it overwhelmed her senses. "Please," she added, when his fingers slid from inside of her and their absence hit her forcefully.

As her legs quivered and she trembled against the wall, he brought his fingers to her mouth, and she opened it to take them in, licking her pussy juices from them, putting on a show. She wanted him to feel the expertise of her tongue, be drawn to put his cock in her mouth and fuck her until she gagged. But later. What she wanted right now was to be sent over the edge, because the fire inside of her was consuming her.

And then, he was suddenly standing two feet away from her, and the light of the streetlamp illuminated the shape of his mouth, curled into a smile that could have been wicked or amused, or both. She was shaking. She blinked, confused. Her pussy throbbed violently.

Rafe slid a phone out of his pocket and held it at his hip, dialing. He put it to his ear and his eyes shifted back to her, one hand moving lazily from her waist to her stomach, between her breasts, pausing on her racing heart. With no change of expression he said something in Spanish, and then hung up the phone and slipped it back into his pocket.

Emma was still breathless, her head spinning.

Rafe stepped close to her again, his freed hand finding hers, guiding it to his cock, which seemed even larger now that her palm was against it.

"Now, Emma, you need to think very hard: what rules can you break, hmm? What is it that a slut like you won't do with her husband?"

His hand came up to her chin, tilting her head back, his thumb sliding over her lip. "And don't lie," he growled. "Because I will know if you do."

And then, he was in front of her again, her wrist in his hand somehow, turning, walking, pulling her behind him. Her head was spinning so much that she thought she might faint, and the ache between her legs was more

violent than any she had ever felt. Danger, an alert to it at least, was gnawing at her somewhere, but that place was deep underwater now, engulfed by the most profound, carnal desire she had ever felt.

So, walking unsteadily, she followed.

A taxi was idling by the street lamp, and Rafe opened the door and moved so that she could climb in.

Which she did, stomach turning in somersaults.

*

"This is my acquaintance, Dane."

Brigitte's slender arm was linked through the tanned and slender arm of a lovely young woman, almost as tall and lean as Brigitte, probably gorgeous, but overshadowed by Brigitte's almost lethal beauty. She was almond-eyed, and shoulder-length dark hair in round curls gave her a vintage look. She was wearing a slip of a red dress the color of her lipstick, and her waifish figure brushed against it when she moved, hinting at her lean lines.

Brigitte unlinked her arm and produced yet another cigarette and lighter like a magic trick, truly from nowhere, and lit it, while Dane lost control of his eyes and scanned her tight, almost transparent white dress for a place to hide her paraphernalia.

"This is Alicia," Brigitte said, after taking a drag and blowing the smoke elegantly away. As she introduced Alicia, Brigitte brought the cigarette to the girl's lips and held it for her while she smoked. "Her English is quite terrible. But she understands. You can tell her what to do, for example."

Dane watched, the way one watches an impending collision, knowing what would happen next and also that he would be turned on by it, and also that it was trouble. But what could he do? Brigitte pulled the cigarette away from Alicia's mouth, turned to face her, and they kissed.

It was not a light peck. Their pink tongues darted between their lips, and they lingered, Brigitte's free hand lazily trailing over Alicia's hip.

Brigitte swung her head around suddenly. "I have to talk to Dane about something, Ali. I'll meet you by the pool. Go-go." And she sat.

Alicia winked at Dane, gave a sensual snarl to Brigitte, and drifted away, red dress spectral above her very long legs that reminded Dane of a

Barbie doll's.

"Your Emma has left with someone, I take it," Brigitte purred, crossing her leg over her own, part of her calf crossing over his.

Dane wasn't sure if he could speak without bungling it, so he raised his eyebrows and hoped Brigitte would carry the conversation.

"So you are free," Brigitte said, tipping her head, giving him the sort of half-smile that seemed more confrontational than inviting, more sinister than happy.

His cock throbbed.

"I should really..." He cleared his throat. "Probably get... back to... the house," he managed to say.

Brigitte shrugged dismissively. "Why? She is leaving with this gentleman from Argentina, no? Rafael?"

Dane stared at her, feeling something dangerous in the air that had nothing to do with her mouth closing around his cock the night before.

"Why?" he asked.

Brigitte smiled. She took a drag of her cigarette. "No reason. Just..."

She ended the sentence there, a kind of heavy question mark almost visibly hanging over her head. Her legs unfolded and she rose in one fluid, dancer's movement, and was walking away before Dane knew what she was doing.

"What?" he managed to call.

Brigitte, a devastating silhouette in a bright light hanging over the porch, hair shining and swinging sexily, called back over her shoulder. "I'll tell you if you come have a drink with Alicia and me."

Dane watched her trot down the steps toward the pool area. As she descended, she looked over at him. An infuriating smile was on her lips: it was the smile of having won, of knowing that he would follow like a little puppy.

He leaned forward, elbows on knees, and sighed, looking down at the ground. His stomach turned over and over, a cold, jellied beast. The image of Alicia and Brigitte's tongues flashed through his mind, the ghost of Brigitte's lips closed around his cock.

I only followed her, he could hear himself telling Emma, *because she seemed to know something about Rafe.*

He sat up straight, looked at the sky, then looked at the beach. From the pool area, he heard a splash.

In his mind, he stood up and made a right turn, and he could hear the soft smush of the sand under his sandals, hear the party fading, feel the door against his back when he locked himself inside the house.

But all of that was in his mind: in the real world, he was trudging toward the pool, heart racing, guilt biting inside of his chest, and in front of his eyes in the real world was the shimmering surface of the pool, Alicia's naked body floating face-up, her hair spread around her head like a mermaid's. Her nipples were cocoa-colored and hard, the tips of small dark aureole at the peaks of firm, small mounds of toffee-colored skin.

Brigitte with her infuriating smile was already peeling her white dress away from her body, and the sheer material deflated into a scrap no larger than most women's underwear at her feet. A small triangle of pale skin faded away into the line-free almond skin of her body. She met his eyes and dipped a toe in the water. "It's warm," she purred.

*

He said nothing as the taxi drove them up a winding hill, and it could have taken five minutes, or an hour, to arrive. He opened the door for her: she barely looked at where they were when she stepped out. It was a quaint house above the rest of the town. Lights glittered in the shape of the land, and beyond, in the center of the lights, was the yawning black void of the ocean. The walls were white adobe, it looked like a modern build, he had his hand on her neck as they walked to the front door.

He unlocked it, and they stepped inside, and then she was swallowed up by the darkness as he closed the door and pushed her against a wall. His fingers found the bottom of her skirt and shoved her dress up and over her head in one swift and sophisticated movement.

She heard the dress hit the floor, his hands finding her breasts, his fingers rolling her nipples into hardened balls before his mouth was against her jaw, his breath hot and his stubble scraping her exactly as she had imagined it would. He pinched her nipples until she gasped at the same moment that he breathed in her ear.

"So. Emma, my little slut in sheep's clothing. What is it you are going to do for me that is very, very bad?"

His fingers paused, his mouth hovered next to hers, demanding an answer as she squirmed against him.

"I don't... I can't think," Emma stammered. And she really couldn't. She couldn't think of a single thing, not a rule, not a sexual act, not a *thought* entered her head. Her mind was all sensation now: the ache of her pussy, the taste of Rafe's lips, the soft grating of his stubble, the sweet pain of his pinch that connected like a hot string directly to her clit. The pounding, torturous craving that was left inside of her like a caged animal when he stopped.

A light switch snapped, and she squinted as the room was lit: they were in a living room, sparsely filled, with paintings leaning against the walls in almost every part. But she barely took any of that in. Rafe still had her left nipple in his fingers, and he was almost twisting it, a throbbing pain building as he pinched harder. His eyes glinted as he looked directly at her, the fullness of his wolfish control now evident. "You had better think of something, Emma. Otherwise, I am going to use your mouth, and your tight little ass, and make you service me over and over, but I am never going to let you come, not even once." He leaned in, brushed his lips over hers, and smiled. "Don't think I don't know how to do that."

Emma sucked in her breath, and a visceral tremor passed through her, as if he had brought her to orgasm without touching her. But the relief was temporary, false, and her need came flooding back, fiercer than before. Her legs actually felt like they might deflate beneath her and leave her in a heap on the floor. She could feel them shaking.

He stood back, appraising her body. His eyes traveled down and then back up, and she could almost feel his gaze traveling over her body, as if it were a physical touch.

"Well?"

Emma shook her head. "I don't... I can't think," she panted.

He reached forward, his fingers sinking into her loose hair, gently, sending a shiver down her spine. She knew that they would close tightly as they did, until the follicles of her hair were screaming, but she wanted that. As he balled her hair into his fist, and his grip on the back of her head became utterly complete, she realized that she wanted to see for herself if he could actually do what he had just said.

Her knees were bending almost before he began to push her downward, and she met his eyes defiantly, eliciting a smile of pleasure, as he used his left hand to unbuckle his belt, unzip his pants, and take his cock from inside.

She brought her hands up to grasp it, felt its warm smoothness for just a moment, and then gasped as he jerked her head back with a sharp pull on her hair. "Put your hands behind your head," he growled. "And show me what you can do with that slut mouth of yours."

Emma obeyed, interlacing her fingers behind her head, over his hand. She opened her mouth to lick at his cock, dropping her eyes to look at it, but Rafe jerked her hair again and growled: "Look at me while you suck all the cum from my dick, *puta*. Just get it inside your throat, all the way."

His cock was thick, pulsing in her mouth, and the inches of it stretched her mouth wide. Her eyes began to water, and the crown brushed against the back of her throat, making her gag. But more kept coming, and she was determined to keep her eyes on his, on his parted lips, his dark, powerful stare, even as much as she wanted to look down and see how much more she had to take.

Her breath became labored through her nostrils, and then, as he still kept filling her throat with his cock, she was suddenly unable to breathe at all. She tried to make a sound, but couldn't, and a throb of fear gripped her. "Keep going," Rafe coaxed. "Stretch your mouth open, you can take it."

She wanted to, so she tilted her head to allow more of him to slide inside of her. Her lungs were beginning to burn from lack of air when his ball sack at last crushed against her chin. He thrust gently into her throat deeper, and then smiled. Slowly, knowing -she could tell from his eyes - that she was screaming for air, he pulled his meat from deep in her throat. She could breathe through her nose first, and sucked in loudly, like an animal, before he finally pulled out of her mouth and she could gasp for air as spit fell from his cock to her chin, running down to her breasts. He bent to put his hand on her jaw.

"Good girl," he said, squeezing her. "Now you can do it again." He fed his cock to her again, but this time, his hand was on her throat when he filled it, and he squeezed gently, massaging himself through the fragile muscles of her neck.

His dominating stare was almost more invasive than his dick in her throat, and it was all Emma could do not to look away. She enjoyed submission, it had always been the biggest part of the thrill of being a hotwife. Most submission, though, had always seemed like a game, somewhere beneath the surface of the ropes and spankings, the dirty talk,

the spilling of cum on her face. What Rafe was doing to her was a completely different sort of dominance: darker, and more real.

The sensation that coursed through her body was *like* fear, and close enough to it to thrill her the way that fear did. Her pussy was gushing, and she could feel her hot juices rolling down her thighs with every convulsion of her cunt. Rafe let her breathe again, a perfectly timed release from his gagging cock, just as the desperation to breathe reached a crescendo that bordered on pain.

Emma was no stranger to sucking cock. It was one of her favorite foreplay activities as a hotwife, and she had done some wild things. But Rafe was the only man who had ever gagged her with such precision, used her so thoroughly while managing to only make her want more. His hand squeezing her throat to rub the contours of his cock, close her around him, bring her lungs nearly to - but never past - the point of screaming pain, drew every single part of her body into a whirlwind of arousal that she had never felt before. Her arms began to ache from holding them on her head, and unconsciously she lowered her elbows, and let her fingers fall apart. Rafe grasped her fingers in the hand cradling her head and squeezed tightly.

He shook his head. He didn't have to say anything, but the message was clear.

He fucked her mouth like this, in ever-lengthening deep thrusts, until she could feel the blood vessels wrapped around his cock straining, pulsing, and she knew he was going to come.

He pulled his dick from her mouth slowly, holding it in his hand, resting the crown against her lips. Her jaw ached, her throat was sore, but she craved his cock in her mouth again.

He tipped her head back, stroking himself slowly - a man in no hurry. "Open your mouth, Emma. And smile for me."

Emma obeyed him, a wave of humiliation rippling through her as she forced herself to smile, mouth wide and open. He stroked himself at a leisurely pace, forcing her to hold her open-mouthed smile for what seemed like forever, until at last she felt the hot, sticky squirts of cum splashing against the back of her throat.

"Stay like that," Rafe breathed. "Just like that. I will tell you when you can swallow."

Cum fell across her chin, her cheek, almost into her eye. She blinked to keep it away, as three full squirts landed in her throat. Rafe lifted his still-

hard dick and let it slap against her lips, then slowly rubbed it over her mouth as she panted through her nose, mouth open, showing him the wad of cum at the back of her throat.

His cock slid down her neck when he let it slap her lips a second time. It was still hard, barely drained, and in her chest the realization that he was far from done with her twisted pleasurably and terribly. "Now swallow," he said.

She did, the abuse of his throat-fucking manifesting in a soreness as she closed her throat to swallow the bitter cum. He smiled and let go of her hands. The exhaustion overtook her, and she fell forward onto her hands and knees as he stepped back.

When she looked up at him, he had his cock in his hand, stroking it back to life with the same, lazy caresses he had used to come in her mouth. Her pussy throbbed again at the sight of it. She could imagine its thickness inside of her, the feel of the same creamy liquid she had just swallowed bursting inside of her.

"Stand up," Rafe said.

Emma struggled a little to get to her feet. She lifted a hand to wipe the cum from her cheek, but Rafe's icy glare stopped her without him uttering a word. He stepped toward her, grasped her sodden panties in one hand, and ripped them harshly with two jerks. Then he spun her around and pushed her against the wall.

She offered him her hands almost automatically, and she felt his hot breath against her neck as he laughed lightly. The material of the panties was so wet it could have been taken from a bathtub. He wound it around her wrists, pulling tightly, making a tidy knot of some kind with very little fuss.

And then he was against her, his stubble grazing her shoulder blades, his lips skipping over her skin and making her body shake with each feathery caress. His fingers delved between her ass-cheeks and plunged into her convulsing pussy, making her mouth fall open in a silent gasp. He drew the liquid up, passing over her asshole, playing with her anus until that, too, was trembling, and all she could think of was how he would feel filling her ass with cum.

And then, suddenly, he was gone, and she was alone against the cool wall, her legs weak as she took a step back, stumbling a little in her high shoes. Her cum-stained cheek and sweaty skin made a sticky noise as she peeled from the wall.

Rafe was walking casually to a piece of furniture against the far wall of the living room, which in short time revealed itself to be a bar. Emma turned and leaned against the wall with her back to it, feeling like a damp, used rag, uncertain what to do with herself as she watched him pour himself a drink. His cock was fully hard, pointed in front of him, a blunt instrument that Emma couldn't stop staring at.

Rafe swirled his drink and turned toward her. "So. Emma. Have you thought of your rules at all? Which one you are going to break for me?"

Emma was panting lightly. Her pussy throbbed. Her mind was still spinning wildly, and she searched for the answer to the question, but it was like grabbing at leaves in a hurricane.

Rafe was walking toward her, sipping his drink. He stopped a few feet in front of her, and placed his finger on her cheek, drawing the still-wet glob of cum toward her mouth, pushing his finger inside for her to suck it off, and then traveling down her neck, between her breasts, over her navel, and tracing the line of her gash. His fingertip was feather-light on the hood of her clit, and her body jerked involuntarily. His fingers left her body without giving her any further stimulation, and she had to stifle a mewl.

He took another sip of his drink. "You will."

*

The bedroom was bare: a large bed covered only by simple sheets. But she saw it for such a short time before Rafe blindfolded her that she didn't have time to contemplate what it meant, only have a wandering thought that it seemed like a strange bedroom for a man with a watch like his. But the thought was quickly vaporized as he pushed her onto the bed and she fell onto her chest, blindfolded, hands tied behind her.

"Do you let your husband fuck you in the ass, Emma?"

He edged her legs open with his knees, so that she was spread wide, her ass in the air toward him. Her pussy was dripping, and she could feel it convulsing, knew that it was doing so visibly for him.

"Yes," she whispered.

He was walking around the room, and she heard the jostling of objects beneath the bed, and the same delicious thrill-bordering-on-terror - or perhaps the other way around - traveled through her.

"How unfortunate," Rafe said. "This won't be a rule-breaker, then."

She felt the weight of his body on the bed, behind her. He lifted one of her feet, and when he set it down, it was cradled in something. He lifted her other foot, shifted the object beneath her, and her ankle was set down into a soft, cylindrical mold about four inches in length. It was not terribly uncomfortable, and while she wanted desperately to know what he was doing, she didn't dare ask.

Anyway, she sensed he wouldn't tell her. Another flutter of terrifying arousal squeezed her.

His fingers found her pussy, and she exhaled, her body reacting with relief at his touch that she knew was a false hope. He had plans for her, and they were going to be long and drawn-out. He slid his sweetened fingers over her anus, playing with it for a while, and then up to her hands.

The underwear were untied with a single tug, and the hardened panties fell open, releasing her hands. She let them fall to the sides of her head, fingers tingling from the rush of blood.

"I want your hands between your legs, Emma," Rafe's voice said quietly behind her.

Uncertainly, she moved her fingers toward her pussy, hoping that he would ask her to play with herself, the crescendo of her orgasm building preemptively in her blood. He slapped her hands down and her knuckles grazed a solid object. She drew in a sharp breath as he guided her hands to a similar indentation as the ones that cradled her ankles.

The reality of her entrapment washed over her before he closed the top half of his contraption over her ankles and wrists.

"I built this device myself," he said. "I've been told it is quite comfortable. Please tell me if you want out. Do you have a safe word, Emma?" His fingers were on her ass again, playing with the eyelet, teasing her. She squirmed, and the device held her nearly frozen. She could only buck ever so slightly, and it would get her nowhere.

"Let's make it... 'Yankee.' Yes?"

Emma nodded.

"Say 'yes,' please, Emma, I have to know you've understood that if you want me to stop, this is what you need to say."

"Yes."

"Good."

There was a long pause, his fingers gone, the weight of his body seemingly shifted so that she didn't know if he was on the bed anymore or

not, and Emma's breathing was so loud, the blood thundering so furiously in her ears, that she couldn't hear his graceful movement in the room.

The weight on the bed shifted again, and Emma could do nothing more than wait. She yelped when the inside of her thigh was suddenly on fire, mewled as ice water snaked down her inner thigh, and then howled quietly as he slid an ice cube along her thigh, through her gushing pussy juice, and over her asshole. He made slow circles with the melting cube, until the pain of the ice began to torment her, and then it was gone, replaced instantly by his very hot tongue.

Emma's legs were shaking almost uncontrollably, a fever building inside of her that she knew would not release, as he darted inside of her and teased her ass. When he slowly slipped his cock into her pussy, so slowly that it only made her wilder but offered no relief, and then slid slowly out, Emma lost control of the sounds coming from inside of her.

The crown of his cock was against her asshole for a long time, as if he wanted to emphasize how it would stretch her when he entered. Even if she had done it countless times, even if she was a pro, it still stung when a man first spread her ass open. It was part of the thrill, the slow dulling of the first painful bite, peeling away to a stretching ache and satisfying fullness, and then a raw soreness that would eventually burst into a hot, wet explosion in a place so rarely touched that it was never fully describable, even to her own senses. Like masturbating with the wrong hand, strangely satisfying and overwhelming, as much as it was dissatisfying and never enough.

It was as if Rafe wanted her to wait for it, to think about what he would be doing and what she would feel, to feel it ahead of time and then to actually feel it. When his crown pressed inward and stretched her open, the seconds while it seemed like he wouldn't fit elongated, and it felt like minutes rather than moments as her ass seemed to tear and she had to suck in her breath and howl in pain. And then he was inside, moving slowly, inch by inch, the bite fading and the craving building, so that by the time his entire girth was stuffed inside of her she was desperate to feel him.

Rafe's hands moved over her lower back, along her spine, teasing her. He thrust even deeper as he leaned over to push her hair away from her face.

"Do you have anything to tell me, Emma? Before I fuck your ass full of cum? I would like it very much if I could make you come while my cock is in your ass, I like to feel you squeezing me. Hmm?"

For a moment, Emma had some clarity. Really there were no rules to break except for the rule of getting video and audio, of putting on a performance, and she could tell him that.

But then she wondered what he would do. Would he stop tormenting her?

Emma moved her head.

No.

He fucked her for a long time, which only made sense because he had already come. He fucked her slowly at first, drawing every exquisite pleasure from each inch of her body. Emma knew she couldn't come unless he touched her clit, but there were moments when it seemed possible. No, it seemed *impossible* that she could reach another level of screaming desire, and not fall down from it. But she only became more desperate, her pussy throbbing and quivering like a wild animal, pleasure beyond any orgasm she had ever had clawing inside of her but never letting her feel relief.

When he finally began to fuck her for his own pleasure, she realized that she was screaming, but it was like she was outside of her body in one way, and much too much inside of it in another. Her voice was not her own, but the pulsing, twisting ache in her entire body, sexualizing even her fingertips that clawed at the bedsheets beneath their imprisonment, was too *much* her.

Rafe seized her waist with one hand and squeezed hard as he hammered his cum deep inside of her. The wet explosion sent her flying upward, and she was sure that she would finally crest, but a deep disappointment set in as she did not. He thrust deeper three times, so far that her ass stretched again, straining as he drove the whole base of his cock into her. His balls slapped her pussy, jolting her clit and taking her even closer to relief.

But then, he was slowly sliding out of her, and her ass was empty, throbbing, and she had nothing but the wild pain of desire unfulfilled as his cum gushed for her in pulses while she sobbed into the pillow.

"Please," she whispered finally. "Please, let me come."

Rafe's weight left the bed, and she squirmed. She couldn't hear him over the pressure built up inside her head, her own heartbeat muffling the sound. So when another searing pain began, it was completely unexpected, and she howled at some volume she could not identify. The realization that Rafe had pushed an ice cube into her gaping asshole, that he was holding it

in place with his fingers, that it was melting into the heat of her ass and his cum, came slowly.

"Oh God," she said, and squeezed her eyes behind her blindfold. All she had to say was "Yankee." The pain was so intense, but the cold trickles of water traveling deep inside of her were so deliriously foreign, and some of the ice water was slowly, slowly rolling down to her pussy, where if she waited, and tilted high enough, it would lick her clit and maybe she would finally be released...

But the ice cube melted, and the pain rolled away in waves, and she was left with nothing, as her gaping ass pulsed closed.

She started to sob. "Please, please. Please. Let me come."

Rafe's hands were on her ass, one cool, the other hot. He massaged her, kneading her ass, playing with her flesh carelessly. "I'm not ready yet, my little whore. And you still haven't told me what I want to know."

Emma mewled. "He's... the only thing I can think of, it's... I can do whatever I want..."

"And it seems, you do anything," Rafe mused, stroking her back.

"I have to put on a performance," Emma panted. "If he can watch or hear me. That's all," she was practically crying like a child now. "That's all I can think of. Please, Rafe."

Rafe made a noise, a sort of growl, and then he played with her eyelet, and Emma whimpered. She knew he wasn't going to travel further down, to touch her engorged clit. A single touch would do it, that was all she needed. But she let herself hope for it anyway, so it was even more devastating when he did not.

His weight left the bed, and even then, many minutes passed before Emma realized that she was going to be left there for quite some time.

*

"I'm, uh... just going to sit here with my feet in," Dane had said. "I hate chlorine."

Just watching. There was no real law against that in his and Emma's relationship.

No rule whatsoever about watching Alicia and Brigitte, shiny and slippery, make out in the pool. Most of the time they were just swimming, anyway. Or floating, long lean bodies shimmering where they were just

beneath the water, shiny and dripping where they rose above the surface. They giggled when they reached the edge of the pool at the same time, and kissed, and caressed each other. Dane wished he had a drink, wished he had the willpower to get up and go home, felt a sense of impending doom, but could not tear himself away from the scene, which reminded him of watching otters at the zoo.

Sexy, x-rated otters, swimming and swimming around.

Alicia swam over to him, her scary eyes on his like a huntress, and he froze. She paused, smiling, dipping her chin just below the water, sultry eyes looking smutty from the slight smear the water had given her. She said something in what sounded like French, and Brigitte laughed.

Dane snapped his eyes to Brigitte, who was floating on her back and looking at him with that same very maddening smile, and Dane could feel the burn of testosterone - a desire, almost, to slap her - and a sort of wild humiliation, wash over him at the same time.

Brigitte stroked languidly along for a moment before saying: "She wants you to get her a towel, but she cannot pronounce this word. Tow-el," Brigitte said, loudly, looking at Alicia.

Dane looked at Alicia, who smiled. She had a very Euro-trashy appeal suddenly, an intoxicating contrast to Brigitte's Paris runway appearance.

"No problem," Dane said quietly, and stood up, sincerely hoping his erection was not incredibly obvious.

There was a cabana that looked promising for towels, so he walked toward it, his only conscious mission being to find a towel and not trip up on his own hard dick as he walked. Perhaps he did hear the dripping water, the sound of two bodies pushing themselves up and out of the pool, the wringing out of hair, the pat-pat-pat of feet behind him.

Perhaps he didn't.

But it had dawned on him, by the time he heard a giggle, that he had not been sent to the cabana for a towel.

There were perhaps three yards between him and the door of the cabana when he realized what was happening, and in the time it took him to cross through that space, he did what he would later adjudge to be some both remarkably good and remarkably bad thinking.

A man, after all, does not get accosted by two super-hot women every day. It was, he reasoned quickly, the sort of fantasy you had to confront, and not get involved in like a clown.

A man had to have a modicum of dignity if he was going to get accosted by two super-hot women.

He kept walking, opened the door, and stepped to the side of it. The women were walking behind him, glistening from head to toe. Brigitte, with her sensual, depraved smile.

He gestured them into the cabana. "After you, ladies," he said cheerfully.

Alicia, non-adversarial, smiled, and put a hand on his chest as she passed by.

Brigitte's smile changed, and her chin jutted out slightly. The smile was still sinister, but it had a begrudged tint of respect to it. Her hand went out to his chest as well, but it lingered there, and then dropped slowly to the contours of his cock as she made her turn, and disappeared into the cabana.

Dane teetered on the edge of a precipice, his cock throbbing, his head pounding, a ringing building in his ears and a colorful starry mist invading his vision from the outer edges.

Brigitte laughed, and Dane stepped backward, back into the light. "I just, uh... I'm going to sit out here, you two, uh, enjoy yourselves."

He sounded like he was twelve.

He gave a sharp turn, and walked a few paces with steely resolve, before arranging himself on a lounge chair and squeezing his eyes closed, praying silently for several, incompatible things to happen.

*

The throbbing never fully subsided. She didn't know how long she was there, alone, craving. Her shoulders began to hurt. She twisted her head in the other direction and wriggled her feet. The cum draining from her ass dried on her thighs, but her pussy never ceased to well up with fresh juices, and her clit still throbbed painfully.

She could hear better, though, when he returned, because she heard a door click that she had never heard close when he left. His hand was warm on her ass as he caressed her. She felt a pop as the contraption he had locked her into released her, and he lifted her wrists from the restraints, placing them in turn by her head. "Do not touch yourself," he whispered in her ear. "Or you will regret it."

He gently lifted her ankles and moved the contraption out from under her, while she remained obediently still as he had maneuvered her. Her stomach twisted with reignited arousal, a thrilling fear of losing her reward, a deeply satisfying humiliation.

A warm, wet cloth touched her ass, and he cleaned his cum from her thighs, her bottom, briefly toweling her pussy, but not enough to make her tip over the edge. He pushed her over, so she was on her back, and lifted her hands above her head. He secured them, together, to the headboard. She felt him straddle her, his heavy cock, hard again, on her stomach.

He slipped the blindfold from her eyes. She blinked in the brightness for several minutes. He squeezed her gently between his thighs, keeping her from squirming too much.

The picture came into focus: he had her phone in his hand.

"So it is a performance you must give," Rafe said. "Screaming, dirty talking, what?"

"Yes. All of that."

He tsked. "I imagine you are very good at all of that. Emma. How does it work? You call him? Take a video?"

"Yes," Emma said.

"Does your... what do you call him, stud? take the video? Or how does it work?"

"Sometimes. Sometimes it's a secret. I call, leave the phone somewhere."

Rafe let his hand drop to his side and looked down at Emma with an interested smile. He leaned over and grazed her lips with his, making her arch her back to press against him. He watched his fingers as he moved them over her chest, through her sweat, smiling. "And this would be one of those secret times, will it not? Because you are a sweet, innocent newlywed, aren't you, Emma?"

Emma exhaled, another finger of fear traveling through her. Rafe met her eyes. "So we will call him. Set the phone down over here." He rested his hand on the bed, and teased her again by letting his mouth hover just above hers. "And then, Emma, I am going to at last let you come, after I fuck you, and lick your pussy, and put my cock in your ass. But you," he licked her lips slowly, "are going to break your rules, and give no performance at all. In fact, you are going to lie here like a rag doll and let me do whatever I

want, and you aren't even going to make a noise." He rose up on his knees. "I wonder if you are any good at that, Emma?"

Emma looked at him, stunned.

He cocked his head. "If you move so much as an inch, or let even the tiniest moan escape your lips, I am going to put my dick in your mouth and fill it up with come, and then leave you here again without letting you come. Do you understand?"

Emma's eyes darted to the phone. "I..."

Rafe smiled. "You either understand or you don't. But I am not asking what you *think*, Emma. Or if you *want* something. I am telling you what you are going to do. And you are telling me if you have understood."

He backed slowly down her body, and moved his cock through her gushing slit, making her shudder as the crown rolled over her clit.

Then he waited.

"I understand," Emma whispered.

Her voice was hoarse.

*

He called Dane, the phone to his ear, a smile on his face when her husband said nothing. It wasn't the first time Emma had made a phone call to Dane while out on one of her trysts, and he knew not to answer.

Rafe set the phone next to her on the bed, close to her head. As he moved down her body, he dragged it with him, but this was something she would only realize later.

What did Dane hear through his phone, while Rafe did what he did to her? Rafe put his finger to his lips one final time before he attended to her, and his eyes gave her all the further warning she would need. So while he kissed her mouth, she let him, and when he rolled her nipples between his lips, she fought the urge to mewl and squirm. When he bit into them gently, then more sharply, watching her face, her eyes watered and tears rolled down her cheekbones, but she obeyed him. Her breath was one thing she couldn't muffle: it was heavy, raspy, quickening almost to the point of hyperventilation. But that was all.

Rafe was the performer: when he sucked on her nipples he did it with a slurping, unmistakable sound. He rose onto his knees, edged up to her face, and pulled her jaw open to stuff his cock inside of her, and the sounds

of her gasping for air through her wet spit, the cacking as he rammed himself deep into her throat, were loud and sloppy.

He moved between her legs, prying her open, teasing her with his able tongue along the insides of her thighs, lapping up the juices that had poured from her pussy and coated her legs. He grasped her ass and pulled her to his face, breathing on her clit, promising to flick at it and give her the release she so craved. She lay there, as he had commanded, savoring the sweet pain of taking whatever he gave to her, bottling the screams and moans inside of her. But she couldn't will her body to remain supple as she neared an orgasm, it betrayed her by shaking, going rigid, telling him just when to pause and let her cool so that he could take her closer to the edge again and again.

When he sank his cock into her pussy, he pulled her onto his lap, so that the motion of his thick dick could only graze the root of her clit from the inside. He took his time, moving slowly, and her legs flopped at his sides, her shoes weighing them into floppy pendulums.

How long did that go on? She never could have said. The call, she would see later, was thirty minutes long, so it was nearly that long that she suffered as he sawed slowly and patiently inside of her and her eyes leaked the only evidence of the sensations that burned inside of her.

At long last, when she thought she could no longer keep her screams inside her, he slid his cock from her pussy, and pushed her legs up to her head, tucking her ankles beneath the ropes that held her hands to the bedpost. She would never know if he said it, or only mouthed it, but his lips formed the words:

"I'm going to be in your ass when you come." And he shook his head as her mouth opened, before pushing her thighs apart slightly and lining his cock up with her ass.

So much pussy juice had oozed from inside of her that her asshole was slick and he sank into her easily. Her rim parted with a sharp soreness, and she squeezed her eyes closed, turning her head to bite her arm to keep from screaming as his cock filled her, hot and throbbing. Tears began to pour from under her closed eyelids as he fucked her slowly, and she thought he might torture her for quite some time, never touching her clit.

"Look at me, *puta*," he said - and he must have said it, because her eyes were closed. When she met his eyes, her limbs began to shake uncontrollably: his face was blurry, her chest felt like it was being crushed.

Rafe reached down and closed his fingers gently around her neck. The tenderness in her throat from his many abuses of it was massaged softly to life, but he didn't choke her. Not yet. He lay over her, and his groin rubbed against her pussy at last.

He fucked her in earnest, at a steady pace, and she was sent spiraling out of control, up and up and up to a height of pleasure that was too intense to bear. She felt like she might lose consciousness, but she found that she *couldn't* make a sound now, her body had actually become so rigid and convulsive that it was doing nothing that she wanted. Blood rushed in her ears and stars began to mingle in the corners of her field of vision, her mouth fell open, and she was shaking so uncontrollably that somewhere in the back of her mind she worried she was having a seizure.

His fingers closed around her neck, and it was only then that she realized she had been panting like a horse. The mild, filling headache of blood rushing to the head pounded against her temples, and then, she was coming at last.

The orgasm began in her abdomen, and traveled through her, a shockwave that sent her back arching, her legs straining wildly against their restraints until somehow, one of them fell loose and slammed against Rafe's shoulder. He was smiling, and his hand had released her throat. She sucked in a gulp of air, but she was still rocketing to some new, dangerous, unbelievable height and it actually frightened her. She could feel her ass squeezing his cock, feel the gush of her pussy as it spewed cum, and then, after a while, she could hear herself screaming. It took a moment to recognize the sound because it sounded more like an animal than herself.

It seemed to last forever, and then she was spent, and couldn't move, as if she'd run a marathon. Her freed leg flopped uselessly to the side and her body went limp, so when Rafe threw her left leg over to the side, his cock still in her ass, she fell like a rag doll, exactly as he had asked. He fucked her for a bit, and then manipulated her some more, his cock leaving her throbbing ass with a filthy squirt, then more spluttering as he pushed her ass up and face down. He fucked her savagely, pulling out completely, then hammering back in, but she had ceased to make any sound or any movement, because she was still utterly destroyed and her legs still wobbled with the aftershocks of her orgasm.

A deep thrust finished him off, deep inside of her, and the heat of his cum spread inside of her, wet and beautiful. Panting, he remained there,

jerking his last spurts of cum into her hard, his cock still filling her aching ass.

Still inside of her, he leaned over and picked up the phone, which had slid next to her right calf. He tossed it next to her on the bed and panted behind her for several minutes.

He slapped her ass hard, and it was unexpected, but her body didn't have the strength to react any more than to just mewl softly. "You disobeyed me, Emma," he said. Another slap landed on her ass, and the sting of it was harder. It faded to a burn, and throbbed, and Emma whimpered - not because it hurt, which it did - but because she knew that she would be punished.

And deep inside of her, her exhausted pussy throbbed, because she couldn't take any more. She was sure that she couldn't.

But she wanted to.

*

He could hear them, and he knew that he should get up and move further away.

But he did not. He moved closer, so that he could hear the occasional thumps against the walls of the cabana, and the female laughter from inside. And then, seeing that they had turned on a light, and that it seeped from beneath the closed, pull-down divider, he edged even closer. And then, after taking a quick look around to make sure he was as secluded as he felt he was, he bent over, and peered into the cabana.

Not much, just flashes of skin, but enough to put the picture together: they were on a pile of cushions, heads to pussies, skin damp and slippery, hands moving everywhere. Alicia was moaning, the smell of female sex, tangy and sweet, filled his nostrils.

He was aware that he looked like a twelve-year-old boy looking through a peephole, but that awareness was in the back of his mind. They began to grunt between wet slurping sounds, and their limbs flexed, and then one of them erupted in a string of high-pitched squeals.

Brigitte had been on top, and her hair arched through the air suddenly. She was on her knees, her pussy still over Alicia's mouth - presumably, Dane could not see. She rocked slightly and rolled her own breasts in her

hands, moaning something in French. Her head fell back, and she moaned loudly, dropping one hand to her pussy and her lover's face.

She finally stopped rocking and panted with her face turned up at the ceiling. Her head dropped down, and she smiled, then began to stand up.

Dane jerked away from the scene and scurried, rather hilariously, to the chairs opposite the side where he had been sitting. Deciding better of it, he looked left and right, and saw to his right that there were steps to an unlit area, probably out to the beach. As he heard the door open, and the girls' laughter, he was leaping toward the steps, almost falling as he frog-ran, hands on the banisters to hold up his weight and move quickly without being heard.

He found himself in a strange small area, enclosed by vegetation, cool, with no exit. His shins collided with a sharp stone and a metal clang followed shortly. He collapsed on a stone bench and concluded that he was in some sort of fire-pit area. When he breathed in sharply, he realized he had been holding his breath. His cock ached.

Jesus.

His eyes were only beginning to adjust to the dim light when Brigitte's form filled the opening of the stairs. Her golden-brown hair was lit from behind, less coiffed than usual, like she had been out on a windy beach all day. She dropped down the stairs with her odd grace and he heard a low laugh. His heart was racing, though the reason was not easy to identify: the thrill of what he had seen, the danger of Brigitte coming after him, how close he was to breaking the rules, how silly he must look to her.

"If you are worried about Alicia," Brigitte murmured in the dark just as a flash erupted in her hands, "she is all lesbian." The scent of smoke drifted past him and Brigitte moved in the darkness. Another flash of the lighter and a candle flared brightly, lighting the curves of her body with an orange glow. For a moment, it was impossible to tell if she had put her dress back on or not.

Brigitte turned to face him. "But this is a barbecue, *cherie*. What are you doing here?" She moved close to him and sat quickly - anyone else would have plopped at such a speed, but Brigitte gave off the athletic grace of a ballerina, and never "plopped," he could see. Her cigarette glowed and she turned toward him. "I thought you would be interested in the show I put on for you, with Alicia."

She looked around, as if she had never seen the place before. "Instead you are here in a barbecue with no one."

Something about her tone made Dane feel the need to apologize. "I...uh, well, I watched."

Brigitte rolled her head toward him and smiled. "I know that, *idiot*." She curled her right leg up as she swiveled to face him, leaning her elbow against the back of the bench and bringing her cigarette lazily to her mouth. The smoke snaked into her nostrils and she turned her head to blow it casually away from his face, emitting a sound a bit like a chiding laugh as she did. For some reason, it felt like she raked her fingernails over his balls by doing this.

"Men cannot avoid watching two women having sex," she said. "It is like... eh, *papillons*, these things they are night butterflies... to light." She turned to him and cast her eyes up and down his body almost disdainfully. "You could have had a much better view."

Dane's mouth was open suddenly, and he was making an "eh" sound, because he really did have a few things that he wanted to explain to Brigitte. And one of those things was the reason he needed to get up and leave.

But Brigitte had already moved with her ephemeral grace to slide her hand over his cock while she crossed a leg over his.

"I... Brigitte..." he stammered.

Brigitte flicked her cigarette at what he could now see was a barbecue pit and placed a finger on his mouth. "You have already broken the rules, am I right? And your wife is now off with this man Rafael, and you are waiting for her?"

Dane stared at her and she slid down to the ground, and moved between his legs, her right hand working all the time with a terrifying skill and efficiency to remove his cock. He lamely put a hand out to her head, as if he believed that he was going to actually stop her.

She stood up on her knees, making his hand drop, and shook her hair behind her shoulders. Her right hand was playing with his rigid cock, her fingers finding the oozing precum and deliberately swiping it around the head, as if to point out his level of arousal. He exhaled, about to say something, and Brigitte put a finger to his lips. It smelled like pussy, and she smiled as she saw that he recognized the scent. "That is Alicia's pussy, taste it," she said.

His tongue left his mouth without his express permission, and the tangy taste of Alicia's pussy came to life with the moisture as he dragged his tongue along Brigitte's finger.

Brigitte laughed again, low and infuriating. Her right hand squeezed his cock, and precum oozed from the tip. Brigitte met his eyes and held his gaze as she lowered her face toward his cock. Her breath was hot against the length of his shaft as she teased him, lips inches from his skin, mouth poised as though she were about to play a flute. When she spoke, her lips grazed his skin for certain words. "You have already broken these rules you have, no?"

She brought her mouth to just in front of his crown, her hand grasping the shaft. Her lips were close enough that when his dick pulsed it barely touched them, and they were poised in a kiss-shaped pout. She moved his cock back and forth over her lower lip, and he shuddered. He needed to stop her, but he was incapable of saying anything.

And then the hot wetness of her mouth engulfed his crown, her lips slid over his coronal ridge and further. Inside her mouth her tongue darted over the ridge and flicked at it, but then he was sinking further into her, deeper, until her lips were stretched around the base of his dick and his pubic hair curled against her skin. He felt the softness of the back of her throat, and a pulsing as she massaged the bottom of his shaft with her tongue. Her throat closed more tightly on his crown and he nearly lost it, closing his eyes shut to block out her amber-flecked eyes that had never left his.

He didn't want to come just yet: Brigitte's mouth felt so good he could have remained there forever, but she was making short work of him. He struggled to think of something un-sexy, but the taste of pussy still lingered in his mouth, and Brigitte's tongue was flicking at the ridge of his cock on her way back to service his crown. Dipping into his hole, swirling around his head...

Vaguely, through a haze, he felt a vibration near his thigh, and he almost thought it was because of what Brigitte was doing to him. Two vibrations as he tipped his head forward and opened his eyes to see Brigitte looking at him, amused, with her tongue wrapping itself around his crown.

He fished it out of his pants pocket, suddenly remembering that Emma was the reason, Emma was calling him, Emma was with Rafe...

"I have to - I have to take this," Dane stammered, fumbling with the phone and almost losing the call as he struggled to make his fingers work to answer it, and mute it, while his hand shook and Brigitte's hot mouth engulfed his balls in a liquid sea. She was looking up at him, running her tongue along the underside of his shaft, her puffy lips in a smile of mischief or cruelty or both, as he strained to hear something from his speaker.

Guilt ravaged him, but he was unable to act, or to stop Brigitte from swallowing his cock again at the precise moment when the panting made its way to his ears.

His stomach went cold as the sounds continued: it was Emma's number, it was Emma's phone, and the sounds that arrived at his ears were unmistakable. She was having sex. Here was the sound of a cock popping from her mouth, the sound of her throat being filled with cock, the sound of someone sawing into her pussy, and it was sloshing like an overripe cantaloupe.

But Emma herself was silent.

His stomach grew cold, he tried with futility to indicate to Brigitte that she should stop, but his gestures were just a confused set of meaningless motions and she ignored them. Her lips reached the base of his dick and he felt her wet spit roll down his balls as the sounds burned into his ears and the world spun around him again. His stomach went cold with fear and guilt: could Emma be telling him something with this silence? That she knew he was being sucked off by Brigitte? But Brigitte's able mouth saved his cock from shrinking, there was no fighting her.

His brow was furrowed in concentration, a brand-new arousal painfully building inside of him, the dark beast of betrayal knifing at him in both directions, and so he hardly noticed that Brigitte had released him and lifted her dress up and over her head.

Emma had joked one time about the lame excuses a cheating friend had given to his wife. "I mean, it's like he actually was trying to tell her that pussy just landed on his dick."

But pussy did just land on his dick, and he was deep inside of Brigitte's hot cunt, her small ass rolling on his lap, his mouth open in surprise, and the sounds of Emma breaking their rules still mysteriously coming through the phone.

Brigitte leaned in to hear, and shrugged, as if to say it didn't seem like much. She rocked on top of him, and he let her, mostly because his own

needs were building, because he was too confused to take any action, because Brigitte, obviously, felt so good squeezing her cunt around his cock.

"Look at me, *puta*," was the only thing he heard, and Brigitte made a feline noise and threw her head back, her pussy exploding around his dick, just before Emma's screams reached his ears and sent him over the edge.

He yelled, and Emma's screams continued, but they were cut suddenly short, and the phone fell from his hand as he gripped Brigitte and thrust deep into her, spewing his cum into her sloppy-wet cunt.

Brigitte gave her hair another toss as he fell back against the bench, his mouth open in shock. Shock, of what he had heard, and shock, that he had fucked Brigitte, and shock that had been wrung out of him by the orgasm he had just had.

Brigitte put her forearms on his shoulders and looked at him pointedly. "So this is what she does, your wife? She calls you and breathes into the phone until she has an orgasm?" She didn't wait for an answer, but instead rolled off him, letting his cock slap onto his thigh. Her pussy was engorged, and a fine sheen of sweat covered her exceptionally beautiful body.

Dane felt a pain in his abdomen, but he couldn't identify what it was caused by: the crunch of his stomach when he came, or the psychological torture with no explanation that had been Emma's non-performance. Maybe it was guilt. He breathed heavily, eyes squinting, as Brigitte slipped her dress over her head. "It was not very hot, I thought at first," she said, in her very French way, "but at the end it was really something." She brought her thumb to her mouth and kissed the tip of it. "I think maybe your wife made me come, screaming like that." She cocked her head, looking poised to ask a question.

And then she shrugged, and turned, and sauntered away.

"I am going to have a swim," she may or may not have said.

Brigitte's naked body was slicing through the water when he emerged from the stairs and walked, as normally as he could, to the next set, that led up to the porch and the only sure exit he knew would take him to the beach. He held up a hand to say goodbye. She paused in a side stroke and smiled noncommittally, before she began to swim again.

He took it as a sign and left, legs shaking, hands patting his pockets to make sure he had gathered everything. There was no way he wanted to have to come back here for something he left behind.

*

The sun was coming up when exhaustion finally overtook him and he dozed off, in a chair. His mind filled with a terrible and disjointed, erotic and frightening mix of dreams. His dreams lurched from hot scenarios involving Brigitte and Emma together, to awful scenes of Emma leaving him. At one point he believed he was awake, and he received a call from Emma, who told him she had been kidnapped and murdered. He had to claw his way out of that dream and sit, sweating confusion, for several minutes, before he was able to get his mind on where he actually was, and what had actually happened.

Emma almost always came home before morning, but there had been times when she hadn't. It was usually an encouraging sign, that the sex was amazing and had continued all night. A sign that when he slipped his own aching cock inside of her she would squirm in soreness, and several loads of cum would erupt from her pussy as he sank in, the warm wave of another man's pleasure enveloping his balls.

But Emma always kept in touch somehow. Since her bizarre phone call - he had to check, again and again, to make sure it had even been real - he hadn't heard anything from her.

It was a tantalizing situation, and his fantasies flourished. But it was also terrifying. They were not, after all, in the United States, and he didn't have the first clue who Rafe was, other than "Rafe." What would he do if Emma didn't return home soon?

And if she did, what had she been doing all this time?

The door at last clicked, and he sat up straight as Emma stepped into the hallway, her gait ever-so-subtly altered by an evident soreness. Her face had a freshly-scrubbed look, which was too bad: it meant that she had been so used-looking that she couldn't come home like that. His cock, which had been only at half-mast, caught in a tug-of-war between his sincere fears and his arousal, his guilt and his desire, thickened immediately as he thought of what Emma must have done that made her think she should clean up before

coming home. How many times she must have been fucked to make her walk with slight discomfort toward him.

Her expression was strange, but his arousal was consuming him, and he didn't pay much attention to it at that moment. He beckoned her toward him, and she came to him, but there was a hesitation in her body. When she reached the chair, she gave him a smile, and he pulled her by the back of her knees to situate her on his lap.

The scent of soap reached him first. Emma had showered. But as disappointment started to seize him, it subsided, because the scent of semen reached him next. Perhaps Emma had showered, but she had been too filled up to be able to rid herself of his scent completely.

He slid his hands along her outer thigh and up to her ass: her panties were gone, probably ripped and discarded. She lowered her head and brought her lips to his, sending a shudder through his body that made his cock press violently against his zipper as he remembered the sound of her gagging on Rafe's cock. Her lips were distended slightly. Rafe had spent a lot of time in her mouth.

His fingers made their way to the crack of her bottom, but not before passing over skin that seemed rough. He felt her bristle as he did. There was nothing new to this: Emma liked to be spanked, she had even had a lover who was deeply into BDSM who had whipped red welts into her ass-cheeks that had remained for days.

He lingered on her soreness, letting the heat of his hand reactivate the pleasurable burn of her punishment, and she squirmed and moaned in pleasure.

"Did you get a spanking?" Dane murmured, when she came up for air.

Emma inhaled sharply as his fingers traveled to her ass-crack, where it was slick and wet, juices oozing from both of her holes. He slipped his index finger down, planning to explore the rim of her asshole, to press on it and make her mewl. If she had let Rafe fuck her ass, then he would have to reclaim it, and from the looks of things, he would have to fuck her everywhere.

She shifted to the side as his finger moved over the contours of her eyelet, and then he was the one to inhale sharply, as his finger passed over a hardness in the center of her stretched hole. His eyes, half-closed in pleasure, flew open.

Emma arched her back and let her head fall back, pushing her pussy toward his hard cock to grind against it. "He wants me to leave that in while you fuck me," she breathed.

Dane lifted a hand to her exposed throat, noticing that a mild red mark encircled her neck. He pressed his thumb against it gently. "Does he?" he growled.

Emma let her head tip forward again. Her expression was not a normal one: Emma was a wild vixen, a woman who led and only let herself be led around in sexual situations because she wanted to be. In her eyes, control always shimmered somewhere, even when she role-played. Dane would later reflect that she was doing a good imitation of that at that moment, but something was very different in her eyes.

There was no way to argue with her, though. Not when she had something buried in her ass and had just told him to fuck her with it inside. She lifted her dress up and over her head, and his eyes fell to her reddened, swollen nipples. He was still tracing his finger around the hard object in her ass. It seemed spherical, almost like the crown of a cock pushing outward.

He stood up abruptly, lifting her with him, and moved to the large couch, tossing her on it. She looked tired once she spread out there, opening her legs to let him survey the extent of the abuse she had suffered with Rafe. Her pussy was engorged, cum and her own juices glistened creamily in its swollen folds.

Emma lifted her arms and put them next to her face. "I'm so sore," she said quietly, as Dane hastily removed his clothing. Her eyes dropped to his cock. She gave him a smile. "Be gentle."

He took her by the ankle and lifted her right leg to have a better view of her ass. Her reddened asshole revealed that Rafe had almost certainly been inside of her, but now a brown, spherical shape pushed against the contours of her eyelet. "What's in your ass?" he breathed.

"Beads," Emma said. "He wanted me to put them in and get you to fuck me, see if you noticed."

Dane let her leg drop, giving her a smile. "Seriously?"

Emma's legs fell open again. "Seriously," she said.

He leaned over her, guiding his cock to her pussy, stroking her clit with the crown. Her juices were hot, and she shuddered when he touched her. "And what else did Rafe do with you?"

Emma's expression, which had already been a little false, somehow, fell with a surprising suddenness. She reached for his cock and pulled him inside of her, and there was no way for him to resist the pull of her hot pussy. Her cunt was still stretched and loose, her interior juicy, too wet to be her juices alone.

She mewled as he entered her, and he almost lost control right away. On the underside of his cock, through the softness of her pussy, he could faintly feel a string of hard contours, beads that Rafe had stuffed inside of her. Emma turned her head from side to side, gasping.

"Is that hurting you?" Dane breathed, and he sincerely hoped the answer was no, because he wasn't sure if he could stop himself, and not continue rubbing his cock against Emma's textured pussy walls until he had satisfied himself. Emma looked at him, saying nothing, which meant she was fine. Her mouth was open, she was caught in the throes of pleasure and the soreness of overuse. But this is what she liked, she had told him millions of times.

She pushed up from the couch against him, and he held her up by the back of the neck. Emma liked to look down at him fucking her, watching his cock as it sawed in and out of her pussy. This time, though, she didn't tilt her head to watch. She seemed to have moved out of discomfort, an overwhelming of her senses.

She began to moan, and it quickly turned to a scream, and then she clawed at his chest and her body clenched around him, and her head fell back as she bucked violently and made a noise that he had never heard her make before. Her pussy quivered with such rhythmless pulses that it was almost frightening, like she had lost all control of herself. Her right leg fell off the side of the couch and dangled, open, and she lay like a rag doll as he pummeled his cum into her moments later.

He lay on top of her, still inside of her, as her pussy continued to spasm around his cock. Her legs were shaking. He pushed a strand of sweaty hair from her forehead and brought her face back to his with his fingers on her chin. "Emma," he breathed. "Emma, are you okay?"

Her body shuddered again, and she nodded, her eyes vacant. "I just... I can't..." she said quietly. "I can't... take... any more."

This had the unfortunate effect of making Dane's cock pulse slowly back to life. He was still inside of her, and her pussy was still pulsing erratically, and something about the extreme vacancy of her stare, the

exhaustion that she obviously was suffering, the way she had been used to this point, only served to turn him on like he had never been turned on before.

He traced his fingers over her lips, then her jaw, her throat, down to her nipples, enjoying the jolt of electricity that certain motions sent through her. Her body jolted, but she remained almost half-asleep, as if she really had reached a point of being unable to take any more.

She would tell him all about it, he knew, and the thought of hearing about what had been done to her made his cock thicken inside of her liquid cunt, ready to go again, pressing against the beads in her ass.

"Are you too sore?" he breathed. "Here? In your ass? Here," he said, touching her lips again.

Her eyes met his. "Everywhere."

He bit into her lower lip. "Where do you want me to fuck you? I have to have you again."

Emma said nothing as she lifted her arm and twisted, with him still inside of her, pulling to the left. He backed out from her pussy, and she continued her roll, onto her side, then her stomach. She pushed her ass up and toward him, cum dribbling down her inner thighs.

Her ass-cheeks were red in the form of hand prints, but his eyes were drawn from there to the smooth, polished wood sphere that Emma was pushing from inside her ass. It emerged, stretching her open, about an inch in diameter. Then it popped from inside of her, and he saw that it was attached to the next one, so he grasped it, and began to pull.

Emma moaned and squeaked as each of the anal beads pushed through the opening of her ass, eight in total. Her asshole gaped like a fish mouth when the last bead left her, and Dane drew some of the juices of her pussy up to coat the rubbery reddened ring before trying to slip inside of her. But the beads had been removed coated in Rafe's pearly cum, and it welled up from the dark depths of her orifice. There was no need to lube her up: Emma's ass had already been violated numerous times, by the look of it.

Dane slipped into her hot, velvety depths. Anal sex was not really his favorite thing, but encountering her ass sloshing with cum, the passage into her easy and slippery, he was extremely aroused. Thinking of Emma taking it in the ass *did* turn him on, and Emma had taken it quite a bit.

He moved slow, and Emma moaned and howled, resting her cheek in the crooks of her elbows and looking back at him, her mouth open, her eyes

wandering between vacancy and overwhelmed.

"How many times did he fuck you in the ass?" Dane breathed.

Emma mewled.

"I don't know," she said a moment later, and that was the end of Dane, who thrust so hard and deep inside of her she screamed, and his cum was added to the loads that were already overflowing and dribbling down his balls.

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After Dane came in her ass, his cock rubbing her sore insides until they felt, not so much raw, as pleasantly but intensely achy, so that each movement of her body made her flinch from the pleasurable pain. She faded in and out of the early stages of sleep as Dane fucked her, she was so exhausted from shuddering with orgasm after orgasm that she could barely move, let alone stay fully awake.

She felt the satisfying injection of Dane's hot cum, then, vaguely, the sensation of his lips and fingers on her body.

"You have to put them back," she whispered, as he covered her with a blanket.

When she awoke in the afternoon on the couch, she couldn't remember if it was a dream or real that Dane had pushed each of the beads back inside of her. They slipped in easily, filling her too-sore ass with a new, tender ache, and a desired heaviness that pulled her down to sleep more than anything else.

She was alone on the couch, and when she looked at the clock, she saw it was, incredibly, three pm. When she rolled up to a seated position, she realized that Dane had, in fact, stuffed her full of anal beads again.

Of course it was ridiculous, Rafe's request that she keep them inside her. But she had done it anyway, and now, in the light of day, she wondered if he really wanted her to leave them there until she went back to him. Whenever that would be.

She rubbed her forehead, trying to remember all the details of the night before. A vague sense of guilt lingered with her, and it wasn't hard to get to the general area of where it came from. But it *was* hard to remember everything she had done, everything Rafe had done to her, how she had reacted, how she had been when she came home and Dane had wanted to

fuck her. She had let him, but by then she had been so exhausted that she could barely remember what he had done to her clearly.

Or why she felt... what? Sort of bad about it.

"Hey," Dane said, appearing in the doorway. He had a glass of orange juice, and he held it out to her as he walked forward. She took it, grateful, and slammed it.

"Sorry," she said, realizing too late that it was freshly squeezed. "I'm so thirsty." She held her hand to her throat and realized that she was actually *desperately* thirsty, in a way she hadn't been for a long time. The insides of her throat were still aching from Rafe's cock.

"I'll get you some lemonade," he said. "We have like a gallon."

Lemonade, which they had purchased at the store as a mixer, and which they hadn't touched. She drank three full glasses in a row while Dane smiled at her, his face a mixture of amazement and concern.

Emma wiped her mouth, because she had been guzzling like a lunatic. "Wow," she said. "I was really thirsty."

Dane sat down on the couch next to her, his hand on her inner thigh. He tucked her hair behind her ear. "Wild night?" he asked. He leaned in to kiss her, and his dry, warm lips brought the ache in her jaw to life. She felt her body stirring to life again, all the places that Rafe had driven to in places where she had never been touched awakening to remind her of how sore they were. And craving, clawing inside of her.

Dane released her mouth after kissing her deeply. "I want all the details," he breathed. He was moving on top of her, pushing her backward onto the couch, his fingers brushing over her nipples. She inhaled, her eyes fluttering open wildly.

"Too sore?" Dane breathed. He liked that, she could feel it pulse in his cock. His touch grew lighter, his warm mouth kissed her tenderly on the neck, sending goosebumps racing down her skin, across her shoulders, in a wave along her spine. "What happened on that phone call?"

A jolt made Emma's body shudder beneath him, enough that he noticed and pulled away to look at her with questioning eyes. She had thought of the phone call, tried to find a way to make it something that hadn't happened, tried to think of something she could say to Dane that would not be a lie, but also not be the truth. She wasn't sure *why* she wanted to find that halfway place, why she couldn't find it in herself to just tell Dane that Rafe had told her to be quiet and so she had.

That Rafe had them figured out, and that what had taken place was something else entirely.

That Rafe had told her to tell him that he wanted her to fuck him with the beads in her ass and see if he noticed. That it was Rafe's game now, that she was playing the role that Rafe wanted her to, and not the other way around.

She *should* tell him.

But for the first time ever, she didn't *want* to.

She kissed him, and then pushed him gently away. "Honey," she breathed. "I'm so sore, seriously. I can't even... think straight."

Dane pushed up and away from her, studying her face for a moment. "What's going on?" he asked.

Emma put her hands in her hair and pulled it back, swinging her legs off the couch. "Nothing," she insisted. It was too quick. Dane would know. Guilt stabbed at her and she turned quickly back to him. "Just... it's just..."

And then, she had an epiphany. It struck her quickly, almost at the same time that she was talking. "I'm having a problem," she said quietly, "and it's... I don't know what to do. What do you do, if two rules are, I don't know, in conflict with each other?"

Dane leaned back even further. "What do you mean?"

His voice was quiet, and Emma felt a sudden desire - something that had never, ever happened to her with relation to hotwifing - to start crying. The depth of the conflict she was in was suddenly apparent. She wished she could take it back, but it was too late.

And the worst part was, she had walked right into it, and she had suspected it would happen.

"Which rules?" Dane prompted, when she didn't say anything.

Emma faced the window again. She sighed. "It's... so, you know how we said, there's no point to doing this if the sex wasn't, like, mind-blowing?"

She could see Dane's face changing, confusion playing out in his features. Maybe he thought this was the problem she was going to divulge: the sex hadn't been that great. She could just leave it like this, say nothing more, and let him draw his own conclusions. Like he had when she had given him a blowjob earlier. He could decide that what she was trying to say was that Rafe was a terrible fuck. And then it could all be over.

She looked over at him.

Emma had learned a long time ago not to lie, and the way she combated her desire to do it was to just start talking and saying everything she could think of that was true.

"That's it? The sex isn't good?" Dane said.

She could hear the disbelief in his voice.

She shook her head. "I want to just stop talking now," she said, taking the plunge, and she felt like she was falling, but it was a wild, beautiful feeling. "But that's... not it. It's, um... it's that..." She exhaled sharply. "It's really hot. And he's really... I feel like he's dangerous. Dangerous like, there's something more than just the sex..." her voice faded out. Was that what she meant?

"You have feelings for him?" Dane said, his voice frigid. She could feel his body stiffen next to him.

"No," Emma said, and when she did, she realized that she meant it. "I just have... okay, so, he had us, like, figured out. Last night. And then he just... I don't know, took the whole thing out of my hands, took control of it all. And that was, like, mind-blowing."

Dane said nothing. She couldn't tell from his expression if he was hurt, or angry, or neither. When she looked at him, he averted his eyes and pressed his lips together, which she took for a bad sign.

"The reason that call was so... you know. Weird, was because he told me to do that. *Not* to perform."

"Why would he say that?" Dane said, his voice barely above a whisper.

Emma said nothing.

"Why would he know about that?" he asked.

Emma shook her head. "Because I... I told him," she admitted. "I don't know why, he just like, hypnotized me. I told him everything, all the rules... he just, I don't know. Made me tell him."

Dane said nothing.

"It was out of control," Emma said. "That's... you know, the problem. He wants me to break the rules."

Dane stared at her.

Emma bit her lip, because she could feel the truth welling up inside of her, wanting to come pouring from her mouth, and there would be no taking it back once it did.

"And I kind of *want* to," she heard herself saying. "That's kind of what made it hot."

There.

She had told him.

Dane leaned back on the couch, his mouth open. Emma's eyes welled up with tears. There was a long silence, longer than she could bear, while she watched his face. Regret filled her chest, a writhing, cold beast. Did she regret what she had done, or did she regret telling him? She didn't know.

"I shouldn't have..." she said, and couldn't find the words to finish. She started to say something, words were leaving her mouth, and she was still talking the whole time he said what he said, and his sentence landed over everything she was saying with deafening silence of a heavy blanket of snow, clear and completely understandable. She was still speaking her incoherent blabbering message for some time before she stopped, mid-sentence, and stared at him.

His sentence rang in her ears, over and over, echoing like a gong. His mouth was no longer moving, but she felt like she could still hear him, almost louder with each ghostly echo:

"I slept with Brigitte."

*

The taxi ride was long enough to replay it over and over, splices of the scene, out of order, laid over each other in a dizzying collage.

The glass she had thrown, splintering on the marble floor.

"So before, before the party?"

Just a blowjob, Emma...

She had been shrieking.

...it just... happened.

The door hitting the wall, bouncing back toward her, banging against her shoulder.

Emma. Emma. Where are you going?

The unsteady, shaky view of the street as she stomped along it, Dane's face through the open window of the cab as she pulled the door closed.

"Do whatever you want. That's fine. We'll both just do whatever we want." Her voice was a hiss. She wasn't thinking straight, she was furious.

And she wasn't.

She was elated: she had a pass in her hand and she was going to use it.

The taxi door slamming. Her voice, icy, telling the driver to go to La Colina.

Dane standing on the sidewalk when she turned, and then turned back to face the front after one quick, burning look.

It just... happened Emma. That second night. I should have said something, I wanted to... and then it was too late.

Her voice, cold, as she stared at the broken glass. "You know what? That's actually... fine."

Her eyes meeting his, fire burning between them. The icy heat of betrayal and passion and jealousy stabbing her in the heart. "You, do whatever you want. That's fine. We'll both just do whatever we want."

Her hands shaking as she stuffed things into her purse. The plastic clatter of her phone, the keys, a lipstick tube.

Dane, a presence behind her, one that burned her skin like the sun. Saying nothing until she was already out the door.

Emma, what the hell?

"Up here," she said to the driver. She pointed. "This house, the white one."

Her heart banging inside her chest, emotions ignited to such a level of heat that they had all blended into one, burnt together into a flame of such intensity it was practically consuming her.

A temporary, pulsing silence after she pounded on the door.

Birds. The distant, quiet hiss of the ocean.

"Emma."

His calm, wolfish stare. A twist in her lower abdomen, the fire in her chest leaping like a flame to her pussy, where it grew, hotter than it already was.

His cocked head, his infuriating mouth. The grip of his controlling gaze, and the errant thought that she would be nothing but ashes when he was done with her.

A sinister grin.

"You've come back for more."

*

Emma's phone rang away into nothingness, voicemail turned off. There was no way of knowing if this was something she had done, or if it was just a feature of making calls in Isla Caza, like the strange ring tone, the too-long pauses between the unfamiliar tones. He had never tried to call her here.

Emma's confession had made his guilt boil over, and so he had confessed his own sins without thinking of where that confession would lead. That Emma would just leave, not telling him where she was going, had not occurred to him. But then, he hadn't really *thought*: the words had simply left his mouth as raw feeling.

Yet it wasn't as if he didn't *know* where Emma had gone. *He wants me to break the rules*, her voice replayed, over and over in his head. *And I kind of want to.*

Which rules? The rules about performing for him? About telling him everything? About the sexual experience having to be "worth it" - more intoxicating, more heightened, or why do this at all?

Or was it the rule about not falling for him in an emotional way?

He should have asked, he should have clarified. But instead, he had been suffocating under the weight of his own rule-breaking, and he had shattered the conversation before it even started.

This wasn't *them*. They had never experienced this kind of problem before. They were experienced, professional: this was *their* game, and somehow it had all slipped out of their grasp.

He wants me to break the rules. And I kind of want to.

That's what makes it hot.

He paced the house, calling Emma, fingers hovering over the text box, trying to think of what to write.

Call me

he had finally written.

He knew where Emma had gone, after all. Where else would she have gone?

Back to Rafe, back to break more rules.

Except now, he knew, he had taken away the one thing that would have kept Emma in line. The very thing that made her come back and tell him everything. With his own betrayal, he had taken away the power of

guilt, and somehow, because of the power that Rafe held over her, guilt had become the only thing that was restraining her.

He had just realized it too late.

Jealousy burned through him every time he made a circle in his thoughts and came back to Emma, Emma who had obeyed her lover instead of her rules and laid there quietly, knowing he was listening, and doing not what she had promised to him but what her new lover wanted her to do.

That's what makes it hot.

He took a cold shower, masturbating furiously, trying to release the raw burn of jealousy inside of him, but the relief was temporary, and came back to a boil as if he had set it on a flame.

The hours dragged on, the sun set, and he stared out the window, cock rigid, his balls in a grip so fierce he felt like his kidneys were going to be crushed from the pain. Imagining what Emma was doing now, now that she felt justified in breaking the rules, now that she - possibly - was there as much out of revenge as out of desire. Letting Rafe do almost anything to her. Putting on a performance, almost certainly - but for Rafe, not her husband. What else was there left for Rafe to do to her?

And would she ever come back?

At eight, he started drinking. By ten, he was incredibly drunk, and he could feel the kind of reckless testosterone rush that hadn't held him in its grip since he was in his early twenties. The blinding, violent, crushing desire to go out and do something destructive, or sexual, or both. Bottle of tequila in hand, because it was all he could find, he set out first to the street, planning to hail a cab and have it drive around until he found her.

The foolishness of this idea became readily apparent when a couple - an older, Hawaiian shirt-clad type - gave him an ugly stare as he marched down the road.

He made a sharp turn and headed to the beach.

Turning left, he saw the beach running down into the heart of the town. Brighter lights, more people. Maybe Emma. Maybe Rafe.

But no. The beach near town would just have more people like the ones he had just passed. He would probably end up in jail, and Emma was almost certainly on her hands and knees in Rafe's house right now, Rafe's cum filling her already overflowing orifices. Emma was probably screaming as she hurtled toward her hundredth orgasm, mewling softly, exhausted, as Rafe fucked her relentlessly.

Was she breaking more rules? What was left for her to break, except to have feelings for him?

A terrible feeling came over him:

Or to never tell him what she had done.

Dane took a swig of tequila and pivoted, unsteadily, before making a right.

Sure. It was a bad decision, a reckless decision. The kind of decision, he vaguely knew somewhere deep inside, that would end with him getting mugged or sitting sadly on an empty beach in front of the now-quiet blue house, passing out and looking pathetic, a drunk with a hard-on and no wallet or phone, asleep on the beach.

But he walked in that direction anyway.

*

"You could naht be out ear."

Dane opened his eyes. The voice was unfamiliar, feminine. A fine spray of sand had scattered over his thigh at the same time. Above him, stars twinkled in a cloudless, inky black.

He was cold.

And then, floating into the stars, upside-down, a pretty face, almond-shaped eyes, an upturned nose that looked almost evil, and a pouty mouth. "Dah-een. You ear me? You could naht out ear, eat is dahngeroo."

Dane moved his head to turn Alicia's face right-side up, but because he could go no further than to tilt her to the left a little, he remained confused. He laughed.

"Alicia," he murmured.

Alicia's face disappeared, and he felt more sand moving around him, and then turned his head to the right, where her bare thigh, exposed to the hip, stared at him. The tattered end of a pair of jean shorts barely began to cover her.

He sat up and felt immediately ill. "Whoa."

"What you are doing ear?" Alicia demanded. She reached down to his hand and picked up the bottle of tequila, then held it up to examine the contents. "You drink zees ole sing?"

Dane's liquefied brain struggled to pick apart her very heavy accent, while he took in the impressive amount of tequila he had consumed, all

while attempting to connect the dots of his evening.

Alicia opened the bottle - he had at least managed to get the lid on, he noted, impressed with himself - and took a swig.

"But thees it is *répugnante*," she commented. Then she smiled, and it was as friendly a smile as her crinkled, upturned nose was disgusted by his tequila. "You are searching for Brigitte?"

Dane barked, something between a laugh and a cough. "Yeah. No. No, I am *not* looking for Brigitte."

Alicia looked at him with the same level, unimpressed expression that Brigitte used. It was very French, somehow sexy, and also extremely agitating. The testosterone that had been put into a coma, along with him, percolated inside.

"You *ah* searching for ehr, or you *ah non* searching for ehr?" Alicia said.

"Not," Dane responded definitively. "I am definitely *not* searching for Brigitte."

"Well, see is searching for you, I sink," Alicia said. She turned toward him as she leaned back on her elbows, and her eyes traveled over him critically. "You are ave difficulty? Wis your woman?"

Dane shook his head.

Unbelievable.

"You might say so."

Alicia put her hand on his arm suggestively and stroked it. Dane pulled it away, to catch his knees in the crook of his elbow. He almost argued with her that he thought she was a lesbian, but it seemed ludicrous.

"Zis is *bizarre*," Alicia said, almost with feeling. "I sot you ad *arrangement*, you and your woman? No? See did not leave wis ze man of Brigitte yeestehrdy in ze night?"

Dane was looking out at the ocean, already scoffing at what Alicia was saying, purely annoyed and ready to stand up and leave before he did anything ludicrous with her. Her cartoonishly thick accent, her strange word choices, the quickness with which she spoke so terribly, the unabashed French coldness in her manners - every word a brutal, disinterested, shrug - all worked against the *message* of her speech getting through to him for a moment.

"Ah well," Alicia was already saying, started to dust off her incredibly long legs, moving to stand up, when the meaning of her words reached his

brain.

"Wait, what?" he said, reaching for her wrist.

Alicia gave him a sharp look.

"What did you just say?" he asked, with greater urgency.

"I sot you ad a type of *arrangement*," Alicia repeated. "Zis is what Brigitte, see tells me. I am... *désolée*, *excuses*, *if zees is not ze case*."

She didn't look a bit *désolée*, unless it meant "unaffected."

"No," Dane said. "Not that. The other part. My wife went home with who?"

Alicia blinked at him.

"You said she left with the man of Brigitte," Dane said, losing patience.

"Oh, *oui*, zis is why I sink zat you ave zees *arrangement*, yes?"

Dane's stomach had turned to ice water and was draining slowly through his body.

"Your woman, see goes to bed with Rafe, and you, you go to bed wis Brigitte," Alicia said, dusting both of her hands, as if the matter was closed. She shrugged. Then she smiled cheerfully and looked skyward. "What is zis word, in the English? Exchange?" She put her finger to her lips. "It is some-
sing in... a land for play, like ze children zey use it..." She moved her hand back and forth like a conductor.

Dane stared at her, because her absorption in the translation wouldn't have made any sense to him even if the world had not been spinning wildly around him, a sense of realization battering him, knocking him into awareness one blow to the head at a time.

Of course it all made perfect sense.

Of course they were fools to never have seen it.

Of course the intensely, insanely beautiful and willing Brigitte was not a French, Amazonian, sex beast living alone on an island of old people with no *man*.

Of course the rough-edged, wolflike Rafael was not a rich sex god drinking alone at *El Pescadero*.

El Pescadero. Dane let out a soft laugh.

The very restaurant Brigitte had recommended to Emma.

Of course Rafe hadn't simply appeared at that party, just one more expat "happening" to drop by. There at the precise right moment in the evening...

Dane's jaw went slack, and then rigid.

There was only one question that mattered to him now, and that was this: how much did *Emma* know all along?

Alicia clapped happily and squealed next to him. "Swingehrs? Yes?" She snapped her fingers and shook her head. "Zis word, eat is so *bizarre*."

*

It didn't come as a surprise to him that Emma didn't answer her phone. In fact, as he listened to the sound of it ringing its foreign tones, he almost hung up after two rings. Deep down, he knew she wasn't going to answer.

Hell, it wasn't even that deep down. Emma was going to do what Emma was going to do, and it was likely that she was going to break a few rules while she did it.

That was a mess that he had just as much of a hand in creating as she did.

Provided, of course, that Emma was as clueless as he had been - as stupidly blind, in retrospect - to Brigitte and Rafe's machinations.

Walking back to the beach house, along the beach, in spite of Alicia's offer to "go for some (unintelligible French word)" and her insistence that the beach was very *dahngeroo*.

He was starting to see things differently now. The tequila had been burned up in the heat of his realization, and what little remained in his system, fogging his mind, was worked out by the time he got back to the house.

It was nearly sunrise. Out in the blackness of the water, the thinnest line of blue began to swell between the black of the ocean and the black of the sky. He paused to watch as the blue spread like watercolor across the sky.

The more he reflected on everything that had taken place, the sequence of events, Emma's reactions, the more he became confident that Emma had been just as clueless as he was. And if that was the case - and he hoped it was - then it was almost for the best. Because now they had something to bring them back together, a shared problem, and perhaps some shared complicity.

When he thought that Emma *had* known all along about Rafe and Brigitte wandered through his head, his heart sank and he felt a wild stab of jealousy - more than he wanted to feel, but still, an exciting feeling.

They had both crossed lines that he had believed were long ago erased. And provided that Emma *hadn't* done it with full knowledge of what she was doing - or rather, what Rafe and Brigitte were doing - then it could turn out to be an opportunity for them to test the boundaries that they had pushed so long ago.

He shook his head again and actually smiled, thinking about Brigitte and Rafe and their little game.

Dane admired skill and mastery, in whatever arena he came across it, and even if it ultimately beat him.

You had to hand it to them, he thought.

They were pretty damn good.

CHAPTER 5

He heard the door early in the morning. It was still dark outside, but he had slept and woken in several fitful cycles, so he knew without looking that the clock would read something like four in the morning. He didn't bother to confirm it, it didn't matter.

He heard Emma drop her purse on the floor, and the clack of her shoes as she stepped out of them. He sat up to hear her better: which way would she go? To the kitchen? To the couch? To the pool? Or looking for him?

His heart was being squeezed again. Sweetly, but painfully. Blood pounded in his ears. This wait was less sexual than usual. His cock was hard, but what he yearned for was to hear Emma's footsteps on the stairs and fold her into his arms and know that she had *returned*. Not just physically, but in her heart.

The next sound he heard was from the upstairs landing. Emma had glided almost silently up the stairs.

The pool lights filled the windows with a glow that lit her skin with a slightly blueish tint. She looked ethereal, like a ghost, as she floated into the room. She sucked in her breath when she saw that he was sitting up in bed.

She was wearing a black slip of a dress - not one of hers - and her hair was tied back in a ponytail.

"You scared me," she whispered. Her voice seemed hoarse.

Dane swung his feet over the side of the bed to look at her. He wanted to say something, to pull her toward him, to explain what he had discovered, to tell her he was sorry about Brigitte, to tell her how relieved he was to see her, that she had come back.

She swayed slightly in the doorway, and he had a terrible thought open beneath him like a sudden abyss: what if she was only here to take her things and return to Rafe? What if she was coming here to tell him that she wasn't coming home?

She swayed, first forward, and then back, and with the movement of her body she took his heart, pulling it to-and-fro, as if attached to a string.

And then he saw her face more clearly. Maybe the sun had come up a little, maybe his eyes had become used to the inky darkness, maybe he was

just looking harder. But he saw on her face the expression he knew he wore on his own: fear.

He held up his hands, just as she swayed slightly backward, and by the time she tipped forward again, she was stepping toward him, hurrying toward his open arms.

He enclosed her in his arms and pressed his face to her belly. She smelled clean, like she had showered, but there was no hiding the scent of another man overlying the freshness, as if she had bathed and then fucked him again. But her body melted into his embrace, sinking against him, weighted, *returned*.

"I have to tell you something," he breathed, at the same time that she began a sentence.

"I'm going to tell you everything - "

She interrupted herself and pushed him gently by the shoulders, to look him in the eye. "Dane, whatever it is, it's... before you say it, I just want to, I don't know. Go home. Get away from this." She put her hands up to her face, then pushed them up as if her hair were in her eyes. She seemed exasperated.

The stone-cold feeling in his gut returned. An extreme dip in this roller-coaster of feeling.

Did she want to abandon everything because she had gotten tangled in a web of lies? Because she had been part of their plan?

The coolness turned to ice and began to burn.

"Why?" he asked.

She put her hand up to her head again to push a stray strand of hair away from her cheek. "It's... okay look, I'm just being honest, it's... *too much*. Too intense. I have, like, not *feelings* for Rafe, but *something*. He's making me do things that feel... bad. Not bad-bad, good-bad, but also..." She let out an exasperated sigh. "Okay, like the badness is good, when I'm with him, but then I feel bad that I've done it, because it's against the rules, bad. Against *our* rules. And it feels good, kind of. I thought it would feel good because *you* broke the rules, but it turned out, it didn't. And then it only felt good once I let myself feel guilty about it again, and that was... just..."

She threw her hands up with a shrug. Her eyes were wet. "I don't even know how to say what I'm trying to say."

Dane was silent.

Before he could speak, Emma took his hands in hers. "I don't want to. But I think we should just... I think we should go home. Before it gets out of hand."

Dane was still looking at her. He was clutched by a powerful emotion in his chest and unable to speak.

Emma put her hand on his cheek. "It's... this thing with Brigitte, too, I hate that it happened, but it's, I don't know. I was angry, I still am, but... I just want to get out of here, sort things out away from this." She sucked in her breath. "Nothing's worth our marriage," she said, taking in a deep breath.

He could tell it was hard for her to say that, but also that she meant it.

"Say something," she pleaded, after a moment of silence.

He took her hand and pressed the palm to his lips. He had to close his eyes to shut out the emotions that were overwhelming him.

He looked up at her when he had regained his composure.

"Please don't tell me you have something bad to tell me," she whispered. She shook her head. "If it's..." she looked out the window. "Just don't say it. Let's leave. Quit the game. Go home."

Dane put her fingers to his lips and kissed them. "We can do that," he said.

Emma lit up, and started to move, like she planned to get up and leave right then, which was preposterous because there was only one flight per day off the island, and a ferry that left at night.

He squeezed her hand. "But what I'm going to tell you might make you change your mind," he said.

There was still a chance that Emma was in on Rafe and Brigitte's game. Even as she talked, and he felt relief welling up inside of him, there was still a little flicker of doubt that was not doused entirely: she could be saying all of what she had said, sincerely, and still have been part of the deception. Maybe it had gone too far for her, and now she wanted to leave, not so much because she loved him and wanted to save their marriage, but because things had gotten out of control. Or because her ruse was about to be revealed.

"No," she said. She shook her head. "Let's not do this. Don't tell me. Nothing is going to make me stay. I made this decision already."

Then she narrowed her eyes.

Emma, at the end of the day, was a curious cat.

Which gave him a great way to settle the question of what part Emma had played in all of this. Emma would never settle for not knowing something, no matter how much she professed not to want to know.

"Okay," he said, letting go of her hand. "Okay. Forget it. Let's go."

Emma nodded, and wiped away a tear. She sniffed.

He pulled her toward him, and they kissed. She climbed onto his lap, and his hands traveled up her back, caressing her, drawing toward her chest, stroking her swollen nipples until they were stiff peaks.

It didn't take long.

The pain radiating through his chest was almost intolerable, as he waited to see if his wife would pursue the secret, because she didn't know it.

Or if she had been in on it all along. The thought of it plucked a thick, hot chord of jealousy inside of him.

She pulled her mouth from his and he chewed on her lower lip until the last moment. Her eyes met his. The sun was coming up now, he could see the glimmer of curiosity in her eyes as they moved quickly side-to-side, searching for something.

"Just... out of curiosity," she whispered. "Not changing my mind, or anything. But what was it? What you were going to tell me?"

She really had no idea what was coming. She had the trembling smile on her lips that she got when opening gifts, or when she knew something was going to spook her in a movie.

Dane kissed her, shaking his head. "It might make you change your mind," he purred.

Emma pushed against him and looked at him. Now her interest was definitely piqued, and Dane was sure it was genuine. He slid his hands up her back so she could rest against his palms.

She gave him a strange look and squinted.

"Fine," she said, slapping him on the arm. "I can't take it. Tell me."

"Please," he said.

Emma's mouth turned up in a vixen's smile. "Please," she said. "I'll be very, very good."

Yes, you will, Dane thought, and he smiled.

"Well," Dane said. "I took a drunken walk down the beach the night you left for Rafe..."

It came over her in waves.

She brought her hand to her mouth and felt it open in disbelief.

Of course.

It was all so obvious, now that Dane said it.

She was angry at first. She hopped to her feet and let out a stream of curses.

Dane seemed amused by it, which infuriated her even more.

"Did you know *anything* about this?!" she said. She had expected to be yelling: that was how she felt inside, but she was just shrieking in a whisper.

She was already shaking her head and saying, "Of course you didn't," at the same time that Dane was saying he didn't.

"I'm so stupid," she said, pushing her hair away from her forehead again. She bit her lip. "Of course. That isn't... I bet that isn't even his house, up there, it's..." she looked up at the ceiling. "His studio. *Of course* he doesn't live in some little hut." She put her hands to her face. "Jesus," she said.

She dropped her hands and looked at Dane.

He was smiling, the smile she knew so well.

Dane. Typical. Dane appreciated talent so much that he had once crossed the street in Florence to shake the hand of a guy who had pickpocketed him the day before.

"I didn't feel a thing!" he had told the pickpocket cheerfully.

"I had no idea," Emma whispered. "But it's all so..."

"Obvious, now?" Dane finished for her. "I know."

Emma put her hand on her hip and rolled her eyes. "Of course. You admire them, don't you?"

Dane shrugged and grinned as though he were helpless. "I mean, it *was* pretty skillful."

Emma let out a peal of rage.

Then she held her hand up to her mouth and started laughing.

Dane reached out for her again, and she went to him more easily, more fully than before. She could feel the very thing she had been so worried about losing, the thing that had terrified her most about this trip when it seemed to have gone missing. But now, it was back.

The feeling of being on the same side.

Dane's fingers ignited her skin as he passed them over the back of her neck. He pressed his lips together. "So," he said.

"So," she repeated.

They made love before they talked again. He was slow, gentle, sinking into her sore nipples with the softest of bite, reminding her of the endless, intense heights that Rafe had taken her body to, of how used she was, of all the filthy degradation she had participated in, submitting so completely to Rafe that she had promised - and meant it at the time - to withhold her secrets from her husband.

When he entered her she was so wet, her pussy still slathered in Rafe's come, but also so aroused, that even the rawness of her cunt could barely be touched by the way that Dane gently fucked her. Her orgasm built slowly, gradually, like coming home to something. Usually, she was aroused when she went back to Dane by telling him, or at least thinking about, what she had done with another man.

But this time, though she knew she would tell him someday - this time, the pleasure that she felt came from the act of coming back to Dane itself.

And being safe with him again, on the same side.

*

"So what should we *do*?" she asked, looking at the ceiling.

Dane propped himself up on his elbow and trailed his fingers down her chest. "The idea of turning the tables on them somehow is sort of appealing to me," he said, leaning down to kiss her. "But I haven't thought of how to do that."

Emma looked at him, and then her eyes went back to the ceiling. "Wow," she said, after a long pause.

Dane looked at her quizzically. "Wow?" he asked.

She lifted a hand over her head. "Wow," she repeated, emphatically. "You know? I just..." she looked at him, bringing her hand to touch the contours of his face. Her feelings had run so wild that she felt as tired as if she had physically run a marathon. The same post-exercise high burned inside of her as well, but it was different now. "I just mean that, I know it was sort of... scary, but it was also kind of good. You know? We've been doing this for so long that it had kind of, I don't know, become..."

"Boring?" he asked.

"Not boring, just... well, yeah. Not exciting. Not a thrill anymore. It wasn't risky."

He folded her fingers into his. "Listen. I feel like we have to talk about something. Or, I do. I'm sorry," he said. "I am. About Brigitte, and then about Brigitte and Alicia. It just... happened. Really. I wanted to tell you that night you came home, but then..." he sighed. "And at the party, I was already in so deep with the lie that I just sort of... gave up fighting them -"

"They are really, really hot," Emma admitted.

Dane knew better than to mistake that for complete approbation. But it was better than nothing.

"Listen, I'm glad it ended up all out in the open about Brigitte. I'm glad you told me about what was going on with Rafe. It got out of control, but I think we were on the way to working it out."

"Me too," Emma said quickly.

She was about to say something else, but decided against it, because it was just a jumble of confused thoughts.

But in her heart, she was beginning to understand it. Rafe had pushed her over the boundaries that were so far out there, she had forgotten there was anything outside of them. And if there was nothing out-of-bounds, then there was nothing *in-bounds*, nothing to protect, nothing to come back to. They had begun playing games, games like the one they were playing here - a game, when compared to Rafe and Brigitte's, which seemed so childish and unsophisticated it was almost laughable - in order to try and find the edges of their own relationship. To find what it was they wanted to keep between them. The reason for it all.

"I'm glad this happened," she said simply, because she wasn't able to put it all into words.

Dane answered her with a kiss, a long and lingering one. The kind of kiss that translated into the words she couldn't say. "Even if we hadn't found out about those two."

Dane smiled.

"But we did."

"We did, didn't we?"

"So," he said.

"So," she said with a grin.

"What are we going to do?"

Emma rolled toward him and scooted back, to prop herself up on her elbow. "Well," she said, raking her fingers suggestively through the smattering of hair on his chest. "I have an idea or two."

Then she smiled. "Both of them are about breakfast. I'm starving."

CHAPTER 6

Two Days Later

"*You* are a long way from your house," Brigitte commented dryly, approaching him from behind. He had recognized her cat-like walk, the coiled energy in her sinewy legs, a pussy ready to pounce, even before she spoke. The skin on the back of his arms and legs tingled, and then surged, right up to the base of his skull. Thinking of Brigitte's body, her mouth around his cock, combined with the myriad images that Emma had planted in his mind after telling him what Rafe had done to her for almost two days, had his cock pressed up painfully against his swim trunks.

His stomach fluttered nervously. The excitement they had been looking for was here, coursing through him. It felt like being on a hunt, but now the hunter had become the prey, and he had her in *his* sights.

He waited in silence, heart thumping, trying to remember all the delicate threads that he needed to keep in place in order to trap the nimble Brigitte in his web.

Brigitte's sarong floated in his peripheral vision, cascaded to the sand, and then her legs stretched out to the side of him, first one, then the other. "You are having trouble in paradise?" she asked. She seemed almost gleeful about it. "Gleeful," of course, manifesting itself quite differently in Brigitte's sour, pouty French beauty than it would in an ordinary woman.

"You did not get what you wanted from Emma's tryst with this man at the party?"

He leaned back on his towel, resting on his elbows. "Not really," he said. He did his best to sound dejected, but it wasn't easy: now that he and Emma were back in control of their game, it was hard not to feel high.

He enjoyed the faint, ephemeral surprise that lifted Brigitte's sunglasses a bit as her eyebrows arched. It was gone as quickly as it came, and she was lighting one of her cigarettes expressionlessly in no time.

Curiosity overtook him. "*Where* do you keep those things?" he asked.

Brigitte smiled, and dropped the lighter into her bikini top, which explained nothing, because he never saw her take it out of there. As to how a cigarette could survive rolling around in loose, flimsy material with her enormous globes of flesh, he had no idea.

She smiled mysteriously at the ocean, and he knew that was all the answer he was getting.

"So. Then. What are you doing *here*?" she purred.

Dane squinted and picked some sand up, letting it pour through his fist. "I don't know," he said.

There was no way of knowing - yet, and perhaps ever - what Brigitte's role in this game was. Was she Rafe's pawn, there to seduce Dane into a trap so that Emma would be more pliable? Or was there some vested carnal interest of her own? Or was Rafe, like Dane, aroused by his wife's sexual exploits even more than his own?

Whatever it was, Dane could see the ripple of pleasure that traveled through Brigitte, and almost hear the gears turning in her seductively evil mind, as she stretched her legs again - purely for the effect of drawing Dane's eye to them - and gave her hair a sensual toss, before brushing the back of her hand along his leg, a tickle of flesh on his outer thigh.

She purred, just like a big, scary cat, before folding a knee up and leaning her head against it. The sunglasses went up, her devilish amber eyes gleamed, and her lips puckered slightly. "Maybe it is fate then, that you meet me here. Hmm?"

Dane sucked in his breath, reminding himself of the endgame.

He pulled his thigh away from Brigitte's hand, just half an inch, as if it were a reflex. "Everything is fucked up with Emma, Brigitte," he said. "I can't... do this right now."

"Fucked up?" Brigitte said, doing a terrible job of sounding concerned. "How is it so fucked up? I thought you liked that your wife sleeps with another man?"

In her incredulity, her accent had become stronger.

Dane shook his head. He tossed a small rock that had remained in his fist as the sand drained through it. "She's leaving," he said, bitterly. "She..." he sighed. "She found out about us, she went back to him, she came back, and told me she was confused, and now she's going home early."

Brigitte folded her other knee up and rested her elbows on both of them, touching her lips thoughtfully as she squinted into the ocean. "So why are you here on my beach, like a hobo?"

What a question.

"She told me to leave until she was gone."

"Ah," she said, almost amused.

He wondered what Brigitte could be thinking. For a moment he felt bad for her, because it seemed that she might have been having a moment of remorse, for her part in the breakup of a relationship, or at least the turbulence.

"I am sorry this has happened of course," she said, indifferently.

Dane let out a small laugh. "Of course."

Brigitte flipped her hair again, grazing his arm. The sunlight caught her skin in a perfect glow, and she looked almost impossibly beautiful. Maybe not beautiful: sexual, predatory, dangerously irresistible. "I am afraid we French do not have the same... what is the word for this? Hang-up? As Americans, when it comes to having lovers."

"No," Dane agreed.

Brigitte shrugged. "If she is mad at you," she said, crossing her right hand to his thigh, her fingers stretching toward his cock, which was, in spite of - or perhaps because of everything - hard and dripping into his shorts. "And you are already alone, and you are in trouble... why don't you relax? With me?"

Dane did his best to look hesitant.

"You are not going to sleep on the beach, are you?" Brigitte's fingers found their way beneath his shorts, and when her touch made his cock pulse, her lips turned up at the corners, because she had her answer.

She leaned in very close to him, her lips a few, tantalizing inches from his mouth. "Come with me."

Brigitte led the way, without looking back, because Brigitte was not the kind of woman to look back.

Dane sending a text to Emma, therefore, went unnoticed.

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"You want something to drink?" Brigitte asked, strolling into a white kitchen after kicking off a pair of flip-flops Dane could not remember her having acquired on the walk down the street parallel to the beach. She lived, evidently, less than a block from the blue beach house, in a house surrounded by a deceptively ratty cinderblock wall that hid a manicured garden with this modern, expensive building in its heart.

"Nice digs," he commented, closing the door that Brigitte had left open.

"What is this, 'digs?'" Brigitte asked, with a smile. She seemed in less of a hurry to have sex now that she had convinced him to come home with her, which made him wary.

"Your house," he said. Brigitte was pouring two glasses of white wine into chilled glasses.

"Digs?" she repeated. "But this makes no sense." She shrugged and lifted a glass, holding it out to him, making him come to her. "I am sorry, but all I have is white. It's also a very bad wine, but Ra-"

Brigitte cut herself off. She did it skillfully, the sort of slip-up that Dane realized he would never have noticed before. He smiled and took the wine, trying not to appear curious about whatever it was Brigitte had stopped herself from saying. "Really it is all they have."

He sipped it. "It's okay," he commented. His eyes drifted to the bottle. "Is it... it's not Mexican, is it?"

Brigitte rolled her eyes. "Argentine," she complained. "Even worse. But," she shrugged again, "It is all you can get here."

She took her wine with her and set it on the expansive counter, turned to face him, and hopped with a graceful movement up onto it. Her sarong rode up her hips, and the tiny patch of bikini between her legs winked from between her swinging legs.

"But we did not come here to talk about bad wine," she said. "Did we?"

Dane put his hand in his pocket again, to check for his phone, as if touching it might will it to buzz sooner.

Brigitte leaned back, her fingers pulling the sarong open as she worked her elbows and forearms to the countertop, spreading her legs open at the same time. Her hair swung just above the surface of the counter. When Dane froze in place - his best impression of being torn about what to do in this situation - Brigitte lifted her right foot and brought it to his cock, brushing it lightly over the contours of his hard dick. Her mouth was open, her tongue running along her teeth, her signature, infuriating smugness creeping into the features of her face.

"Come on, Dane. You are not feeling so bad as you say."

He finished his wine and set the glass down on the counter. He was not feeling bad at all, actually. And he had taken quite enough of Brigitte's shit, to be perfectly honest. So, while he had planned for a long seduction scene, one that might even get interrupted before reaching its... well,

denouement, as Brigitte would say, he found himself doing something else entirely.

He lunged toward her and flipped her over with a harsh jerk of her left hip to the side. He pulled her as he did so, so that when she slipped from the counter, her feet dropped neatly to the floor. It would be easy, now, to bend her over and fuck her right there on the countertop.

Brigitte flipped her hair to look back at him, and her smile conveyed that she was game for this maneuver, in fact, she seemed to have been waiting for it, pushing him toward it. He pulled the bottoms of her bikini over the hump of her ass, peeling them slowly from her sun-toasted skin. The scent of her pussy rose from between her legs, and nestled between her soft flesh, the pink of her asshole and the slit of her cunt were shiny and wet.

He placed his hands on her buttocks and kneaded them, then pushed them apart so that when he lowered his head, it was a simple trick to lick her from her clit, over her gushing hole, along the perfectly smooth patch of perineum, and over the tight, rubbery center of her ass, slick with her pussy juices. Brigitte murmured with pleasure, so he passed his tongue over her a second time, lingering on her tiny eyelet, darting his tongue into her hole. She squirmed in his hands and squealed a little, so he spent some time there, dipping into the metallic tang of her ass, enjoying the way she reacted as he tickled her.

His cock was throbbing, but he wanted to spend a little more time on Brigitte, take control of her rather than the other way around. He circled her anus again with the tip of his tongue before standing up, using his thumb to drag her pussy juices from her cunt to her ass as he took his cock out, letting his shorts fall to the floor. Hastily, he reached behind him to pull his shirt over his head, because it was interfering with his view. He tossed it somewhere into the kitchen before bringing the crown of his dick to her dripping pussy. Brigitte nudged backward at him with her small ass, rising onto her tiptoes to align her cunt better with his cock. Her pussy lips enclosed him in a hot, liquid kiss, and he entered her slowly, enjoying the slow enveloping of his dick in her velvet heat. As he entered her, he pushed his thumb into her ass. Brigitte gasped: except for a smear of her pussy juices, his finger was unlubricated, and she tightened around his finger and gasped.

But when she looked back at him, she was smiling. Her ass relaxed around his finger, even when he began to drag it, squeaking a little, out of her hole and then push it back in, slowly, savoring the trembling of her body and the pulsing of her pussy as he did so.

"Do you fuck your wife in the ass?" Brigitte breathed, smiling.

Dane didn't answer, except to jam his thumb deep into Brigitte, whose mouth fell open before she smiled again. "What about her lover? Does he fuck her in the ass?"

Dane could not stop his cock from pulsing inside of Brigitte, which made her smile in that particular, infuriating way she had.

"I bet she likes it. She likes it better from another man than from you, don't you think?"

His cock spasmed again, his eyes on Brigitte's mouth, the wide smile she made as he pressed deeper with his thumb. She said something in French in a low, guttural whisper that sent a chill down his spine and the back of his legs, where it vibrated in his right foot. His balls clung to the sticky mess of her pussy as he pulled back. Through a haze the vibration against his foot surfaced in his consciousness, and his half-closed eyes flew open as the meaning of it struck him in the chest.

But the pull of Brigitte, her pulsing cunt around his cock, was too much for him to break free just then. He sank into her again, and began to fuck her with abandon, palm gripping her right buttock, thumb squeezed by her contracting ass. Brigitte urged him on in French, and he struggled to hold back until he felt her pussy clamp around him, and she screamed in pleasure. He thrust deep into her with a filthy squelch and emptied his load into her quivering cunt.

Brigitte lay her head on the table and pushed her hair aside, stretching her arms, as he panted above her.

The phone.

Emma.

He withdrew his thumb and let his cock slide from inside of her, still turgid, he noted with satisfaction. "I have to..." he said breathlessly, bending down to fish his phone from the crumpled pants at his ankles.

Brigitte rolled around to look at him, still grinning with her maddening expression. The wild look in his eyes did not have to be faked when he opened Emma's message. He stared at it as if he had not expected it at all, because that was the plan.

Emma had outdone herself and sent a picture along with her message. It did take a little bit of genuine open-mouthed staring to decipher it.

Brigitte watched him for a few moments, her eyes glinting with curiosity.

He waited for her to ask him what it was, because it would come across as more authentic that way, and Brigitte was a lot of things, but not an amateur at games like this. He ran his fingers through his hair, exhaled, then swiped his palm over his open mouth, all while staring at the picture.

Her fingers closed around the edge of his screen but did not pull the phone from him. "What is this? A message from your angry wife?" Her tone was playful.

He let her take the phone and turn it toward herself. She flipped her hair and smiled at the picture, then squinted.

"But what is this?" Then she smiled even more. "Ah," she said. She gave the phone back to him and rested her forearms on his shoulders. "You should send her back a similar picture," Brigitte purred.

The picture was of Emma's wet cunt, thick, male fingers dipping into her folds.

"She's taking him home," Dane said, the excitement of the game that was being played making the choked rasp in his voice very real.

Brigitte's eyes were on his, and the image of a hawk floated through his mind: she was watching him, thinking, and it was intimidating as hell. She bent her right elbow and brought her hand to her hair, pushing it up sensually. She drew her fingers lazily down her cheek to bite her pinky and smile. "But this is what you were wanting, no?" She dropped her hand between his legs and found his cock, almost fully hard again. It seemed to delight her. "This is an invitation, is it not?"

Her fingers closed around his still-wet dick, and her palm slid easily over his throbbing skin.

"Are you going to go?" Brigitte asked, as if she were asking about the grocery store. She leaned closer to him, her smile more malevolent and bewitching with every passing second. "You like to watch your wife with another man, but have you ever had someone suck your cock while you do that?"

Even though it was Brigitte, and even though he could not have written her a script that was closer to his plans than the very words she had just said, the suggestion still hit him with force. His balls throbbed with a

painful ache, and he was unable to speak. Brigitte's fingers were tapping lightly on his sac, almost grazing his skin, but each tap felt like a bruising stab. This amused her, he could see.

Her mouth was on his, and then her fingers were closing tightly around his balls, squeezing. She bit into his lip as her fingernails sank into his tight flesh, and he held the sound he wanted to make in his abdomen, where it kicked at him from the inside. His body jerked, and Brigitte smiled. "What do you think?" she growled. "Watch this man fuck your Emma like a filthy whore, while you come in my mouth? Hmm?"

She squeezed him again, and the sensual pain cut through him in every direction.

Brigitte was not a woman who needed a verbal answer. She pulled her swimsuit bottoms up, gave a slinky, feline stretch, and slid from between him and the counter to walk toward a doorway to the rest of the house.

"I need just something to wear," she said casually over her shoulder.

Dane exhaled, and looked one last time at the picture in his hand, before he put the phone in his pocket. He wanted to send something to Emma, so that she knew he was on the way.

But their plans always required a certain amount of trust, a certain high-wire act, and the danger that something would not work out as they had hoped.

If they didn't, he reminded himself, then they wouldn't be any fun.

He pushed himself up and found his shorts, edging them carefully onto his body. He scanned the floor, unable to find his shirt.

Brigitte was back, in a loose black dress very similar to the one Emma had worn home from her long nights at Rafe's studio. "I am ready," she announced. "What is wrong?"

"Can't find my shirt," he said, truly confused.

Brigitte shrugged indifferently. "Do you really need it so much?" She stepped toward him and raked her fingers over his chest. They stopped at the reddened claw marks on his pecs, and she laughed lightly. "Perhaps you do," she conceded.

She disappeared, and returned with a black t-shirt that had Spanish writing on it. It was a man's shirt, flecked with paint. It was obviously Rafe's, and he had a hard time taking it from her with no reaction. "Hmm," he said, pulling the shirt over his head.

Brigitte was looking at him, her eyes amused. "You did not think I was monogamous," she told him.

And then, in that indifferent way of hers, she spun on her heel and walked through her house, without looking behind to see if he was coming, or verifying that he did in fact want to drop his balls into her mouth while his wife got pumped full of cum by her husband, or whatever Rafe was to her.

But he did, so he followed.

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Brigitte only paused for him to catch up when she reached the back fence where the yard of his rental let out to the beach. She stopped as if that exact spot had been her intended destination all along, and so Dane also paused there, and for a moment he didn't realize that Brigitte was handing the reins over to him.

He looked through the vegetation at the back of the house. There were scattered lit-up lights throughout the house - hallways, maybe a bathroom. The sort of lighting that results when two people who are more preoccupied with sex careen through a building on their way to wherever they are going.

He squinted at the glass windows, but they were too dark and too reflective to provide him with any clue as to where in the house Rafe and Emma were fucking.

His stomach fell: maybe they weren't even there.

"What if they're not here?" he said aloud, quietly.

Just then, as if in answer to his question, a wild moan escaped the house. Emma's voice, more tortured than he had ever heard it. Then the sound was gone, and the ocean swallowed up the silence with a hiss.

Brigitte bit into her lower lip with most of her front upper teeth and her eyes flashed. Nimble, she stepped between him and the fence, and was hopping through the backyard like a nymph before he could stop her.

His stomach twisted with the fun fear of getting caught as he followed Brigitte.

But really, there was no danger of being caught, because even if they *did*, everyone present knew about mostly everything going on, and while it might ruin the fun of sneaking around, it wasn't as if it was actually *dangerous*.

Following Brigitte, who walked upright and calmly, he wondered if she had been in touch with Rafe. Did he know that she was coming, and know what she planned to do to Dane while Rafe used his wife? He had never seen Brigitte with a cellphone, and he hoped they didn't know what was going on.

Brigitte entered the house via a side door like a cat burglar, smiling at him before she stepped into the shadows. Once inside, he could hear that Emma and Rafe were in the sitting room on the other side of the house. Emma howled again, intense pleasure rippling through her throat. Their heavy breathing echoed through the house.

Brigitte turned to him, and he pointed her toward the dining room. Emma had done her part well: the living room had been their first choice to stage this scene, because the two rooms were divided by an accordion wall that could be pushed open. The faux wood was partially folded in, so that at any of the hinges between the slats, there was a gap of about an inch for Dane to peer through and view the scene in the living room.

Brigitte had already tiptoed over there and made this discovery for herself.

She flashed a look at him as he approached, smiling, happy with what she saw. She crooked a finger and beckoned him, reaching toward his groin with her other hand as he approached.

Behind the wall, Emma squeaked and squealed, and her breath came in wild huffs. Dane leaned in toward the crack and saw only a blur of shadows for a moment, bouncing. But slowly, they came into focus, lit up by the streetlight coming through the window.

Emma was sitting on Rafe, buck naked, her pale skin glowing and shiny with sweat. She was propped on his lap as though she were sitting on a chair, her legs together, her hands resting on the arms.

But as he looked closer, he saw that her arms were held in place by Rafe's fingers, which encircled her wrists and held her small forearms against his tensed muscles. Emma was slowly bouncing on his lap, her head lolling slightly as she did, her breasts rising and falling with each slow bounce.

"Good girl," Rafe's voice rasped. "Nice and slow, ride my cock, get it nice and wet, squeeze it. That's it."

Emma gasped, and then squirmed, and Rafe's hand shot up to her head, taking her enclosed wrist with it. He pushed her forward, bending her

like a limp rag doll, making her gasp. Her head shook as he pushed on her, shaking her a little, bringing her to a stop.

"Not so fast, you little *puta*, do you remember? You are not going to come for me yet. Not until I say you can."

Rafe pinned her like this, his bicep flexing, her forearm still held fast to the arm of the chair. She was bent over her own lap, face to the floor, and she squirmed against his grip, but it was clear she couldn't free herself to move. Rafe's hips rocked slowly, and when Emma's wasn't whimpering, Dane could hear the slurping stickiness of her pussy as Rafe slowly rocked inside of her.

She had described his domination of her as torture: pleasurable, something she would go back for, but ultimately torture, because he seemed to have an infinite capacity for taking his time, sensing when she was about to come, and making her earn it.

Dane glanced over at Brigitte, who was on her knees, halfway resting on her calves, looking through the slit next to his. Her lips were turned up in her devious smile, and she was mesmerized by the scene in front of her.

Dane looked back at Emma and Rafe, in time to see Emma's legs begin to shake, and her ankles twist as she tried to manage her body's response to Rafe. She had told Dane she wanted to trick him, to glean an orgasm from his control, but he was too good. Too attuned to what was happening inside of her, the tensing of her muscles, the shaking of her thighs.

The noises coming from her elongated, until she was squealing between clenched teeth and a closed mouth. Rafe smiled.

Brigitte leaned over to Dane, stroking his cheek with a finger and pulling him close to her mouth. In a very low, non-sibilant whisper, she growled: "Is he going to fuck her ass, do you think?"

She let the question linger in the air a moment as she worked her hand into his shorts and began to shift the fabric around to free his cock. Her thumb swirled over the damp crown, slick with his precum. She slid her nail along the coronal ridge and added: "I love watching women get fucked in the ass."

His cock was freed, and he shifted onto his shins, rising so that Brigitte could pull his shorts down. He took off the t-shirt, tossing it to the side. It was soaked in sweat.

Brigitte put her tongue on the outer edge of his ear and tickled him before pressing her lips to him to whisper, loudly, "Tell me if he is going to put it in her ass, I want to watch."

She slid down his torso, giving him a devious look until it was too hard to contort herself to meet his eyes, and when he looked up to watch his wife, Brigitte's tongue began to slide along his shaft, moving quickly, wet and hot.

In the living room, Emma was howling into her knees, and her toes had curled until the joints were white. Rafe was still moving slowly inside of her.

He released the hand he was holding at her neck at the same time as he released the hand he was holding against the chair. Roughly, he pushed Emma forward, and the slosh of her pussy echoed in the room as his cock slipped out of her abruptly. Rafe pushed her to the floor, on her hands and knees. He stared at Emma's ass for a moment, his cock pointed up, throbbing, thick like a slab of meat, almost gnarled.

Emma looked back at Rafe, who leaned forward to slap her ass. The smack coincided with Brigitte lapping at Dane's balls, and he could feel the shape of her sucking mouth turn to a smile when she heard the sound. A growl of pleasure vibrated through him from her throat. Brigitte's entire mouth closed around his ball sack, and she rolled them around in her mouth with her tongue.

Another slap cracked through the air. Rafe was at the edge of the chair now, swatting Emma's ass and watching the burning stain he had surely left as it spread across her skin.

"You've been very, very bad, Emma," he said. "And so you are going to get spanked. And after I spank you, you are going to get fucked in the ass." He slapped her again, and Emma yelped.

"What do we say, Emma?" Rafe growled.

Dane's cock bounced against Brigitte's face, and she sucked his balls with pleasure as Emma squeaked: "Thank you."

This went on for another good while, perhaps eight more solid spans, each one louder than the last, Emma shrieking in the end, her voice shaking as she thanked him for the final swat. He massaged her ass, rubbing the burn of his spanking into her skin, while Emma squirmed and mewled.

Dane closed his eyes as Brigitte began to work on his shaft again, enclosing his head in her mouth and playing with his crown with her

tongue. She moved up and down, glancing through the slit in the folding wall after each trip to the base of his cock.

"Get your ass in the air for me, *puta*. The way I like it," Rafe commanded Emma, who leaned forward onto the floor and pushed her ass up for him. "Now put your hands there. Good. Rub your ass. Make it sting."

Brigitte's interest was piqued, and she released Dane from her mouth to sit up, still stroking his cock as she watched, but lazily: her interest was now on Rafe and Emma. Which was fine, because Dane was almost ready to blow, especially as he watched Emma bring her hands to her ass-cheeks and rub them while Rafe stared down at her work.

Rafe rose up on his knees and leaned over Emma's ass to let a huge drop of spit fall onto her hole. Next to him, Brigitte shook with pleasure. Her hand squeezed tightly around his cock and she stopped stroking him. She seemed to sense that he was otherwise going to explode all over the retractable wall, and probably yell, and Brigitte seemed *very much* to want to watch Emma take it in the ass.

Rafe lined his cock up with Emma's hole and moved it against her, teasing for a moment. Brigitte's mouth fell open slightly, and her hand went limp as she became totally absorbed in the scene in the next room.

Emma let out a scream of pleased pain as Rafe's torso sank forward, and a sticky sound, almost with a low murmur of snapping, came from behind her. "Oh, oh, oh!" she howled, and her right hand dropped from her ass and shot forward, next to her face. She looked up, trying to push herself up to her hands and knees, but Rafe jerked her hips and slapped her ass again. "Put your hand back on your ass," he snarled. "Show me you remember how to be a good girl, Emma, or we will have to train you all over again."

Emma put her hand back up on her ass cheek, and Rafe smiled as he looked down and slowly fucked her ass, Emma moaning all the time.

Rafe started to fuck her harder, and faster, and Emma's mewling turned into squeals, and then shrieks, before, mysteriously, as he began to really hammer her, she went silent. Her body slid on the floor as Rafe pounded her, each thrust seemingly deeper and more forceful than the last. When Emma's hands began to fail her, and drop from her ass, Rafe seized her wrist and held it so that her palms were always on her buttocks, holding herself open for him to see his dick sawing in and out of her. His mouth was open slightly, eyes narrowed in pleasure.

Dane stole a look at Brigitte, whose mouth was also twisted in pleasure.

Rafe's stomach tensed, and he paused his assault on Emma, thrusting in deep - for a second, Dane was disappointed, and thought Rafe had come. But when he slid from inside of Emma's ass to rise up and sit back on the chair, his cock was still solid, if anything, it had swollen larger and looked more grotesque as the veins strained against his skin and pulsed with pleasure.

Emma remained on the floor, panting, obedient to his whims, her hands displaying her ass for him.

Rafe stared at her for a long time, watching the gape he had stretched out as it pulsed. At last, he nudged her with his foot. "Now get up, get back on my lap. You're going to ride my cock until I fill your ass up with cum."

Emma pushed herself to her hands and knees and looked back at Rafe, who grinned wickedly at her but also gave her a sharp look, one that indicated that if she was going to say anything, he didn't want to hear it.

Brigitte smiled, leaning closer to Dane, as Emma rose to her feet and turned. When Emma wobbled to Rafe's legs, he lifted a finger and moved it in a circular motion, indicating that she should turn around.

"Her ass is probably so sore," Brigitte murmured in Dane's ear. She pushed him so that he was turned toward her, with the slit in the wall still lined to his right-side line of vision. He could still see into the living room, as long as he turned his head to watch.

Rafe had Emma's hips and was pushing her legs apart with his knees. At the same time, he pulled her down, lining up his cock with her ass.

His hand shifted to her lower back, and Dane could see that he was pushing Emma down, putting weight on his crown. His prick bent slightly, and Emma moaned, trying to look back at what he was doing.

"Ride it," Rafe commanded, a snarl on his lips.

"I can... I can't..." Emma panted. "I'm too sore. Oh!" She tilted her head back and let out a long, high-pitched cry as her body lowered toward Rafe's lap, his fat cock disappearing inside of her. Her legs shook with the effort, and finally she seemed to collapse, screaming as she impaled herself and plopped down onto Rafe's sweaty thighs, sending his cock ramming deep inside of her.

Rafe wrapped her hair around one hand and pulled, then put the other on her hip. "Now get to work," he ordered. "Pump me hard, and if you do a

good job, like a good girl, I'll treat you to a surprise."

Brigitte was climbing onto Dane's lap now, her skirt hiked up at her waist. A drip of pussy juice let him know that she was wearing nothing else. She rested her forearms on his shoulders and turned her head in the direction of the living room, still smiling her infuriating smile. "He's going to fuck her ass full of cum," she whispered in his left ear. She was sinking her pussy onto his cock, rocking slightly. "Do you like to fuck her after he's done with her, right away, while she's still dirty and smells like another man?"

Dane wasn't sure what to answer, or what kind of trouble it might get him into with Brigitte, and in the time it took for him to think of something to say, Brigitte was already whispering something else against his neck with her hot breath.

But he missed it, because Emma by then had begun to bounce on Rafe's cock, rising up to a difficult-looking crouch and then letting herself fall, plop, into his lap. She grunted with each bounce, and then her voice turned to a whimper, but continued to pump his cock even while he moved his hands to her chest, pinched her nipples, and closed his hand around her throat to control her bouncing.

"That's it, good girl. Keep riding that cock. That's it. Be very good, if you please me, maybe you will get a treat instead of just a sore ass."

Brigitte, meanwhile, was lifting her leg up and hooking it on Dane's shoulder, in one of her incredible displays of core strength. He tore his eyes away from Rafe's swollen column, oozing from his wife's pussy and then plunging back in, just below Emma's swollen, drenched pussy.

Brigitte's body was tense, and she lifted herself a little and used one hand to nudge his cock toward her gash. Emma grunted again and a wet slurp signaled another deep plunge into her ass. Brigitte pushed down gently on Dane's cock, and he felt the rubbery circle of her asshole kiss the crown of his dick.

Emma continued to howl and pant, bouncing diligently on Rafe's cock while he growled, "Keep going, milk my cock, show me what a good girl you are." Brigitte thrust her hips, pulled on his shoulder, and his cock sank into her tight ass. Her hot, velvety flesh wrapped tightly around his dick after it passed through her rubbery ring.

"Keep going," Rafe growled to Emma. Dane tore his eyes away from Brigitte's wicked grin to watch as Emma bounced and bounced until Rafe

grunted and then yelled loudly, grasping Emma's hips with both hands and thrusting so deep into her that Emma screamed. Her ass belched with wet, slurpy smacks, and Rafe lifted her and slammed her down several times as he filled her up with his cum.

Rafe gathered Emma's hair and pushed it aside. He licked her, starting at the neck and traveling up to her ear, pulling her back against him. "Good girl," Rafe said, breathing into her neck. One hand wrapped gently around her neck, and the other traveled over her chest, pinching her nipples on its route to her abdomen, then her pussy.

Rafe cupped Emma's pussy, and then drove three fingers into her gash and began to finger-fuck her, rubbing her clit as he did. Emma's spread legs began to shake, so much that her feet, dangling now as Rafe spread his legs apart causing them to lift from the ground, bounced wildly at the sides of his calves. Her pussy squelched as his fingers plunged in and out of her.

Brigitte had her cheek pressed against his to watch. She was rocking lazily on his cock by shifting her hips. "He is really destroying her," she whispered, drawing her face back to get her voice into his ear. "Will you fuck her ass or that loose, loose pussy first?"

As she said this, Emma squealed, because Rafe pushed a fourth finger - almost his fist, into her pussy. The lips of her cunt appeared to be turned inside-out, and beneath his fist, his still-hard cock remained buried in Emma's ass.

Emma's body went rigid, and then jerked wildly. She was coming, and the sounds coming from her ass and pussy were filthy and wet as she spasmed around Rafe's hand and cock, screaming.

Dane could feel himself boiling over. Shifting his eyes back to Brigitte in front of him, he rose up and pushed her down to the floor roughly, without removing his cock from her ass. Her right leg was hooked on his shoulder still, and he swept her ankle up as they fell to the floor, pushing her left leg up and then straightening her leg to place that ankle on his right shoulder. Brigitte looked surprised, and amused, and as he began to fuck her hard - loudly, not caring if they would be heard anymore - her body began to tense up. Her ass closed tightly around his dick just as he felt himself exploding.

"Tell me," he panted into her ear as the first spurt of cum blew into her ass. "Does Rafe. Like to fuck your ass? When it's full of fresh cum?"

This sentence left his mouth in huffs, contorted by the orgasm that was racking him. He knew his voice was loud, and he had to close his eyes as the heights of his orgasm consumed him. Brigitte was also coming, shaking, mewling beneath him.

When he opened his eyes, her mouth was open. Surprise registered on her face as he rammed the final squirts inside of her. But it flickered there only for a moment, and then turned to a wicked smile. She squeezed his cock with her ass, still smiling, and began to laugh.

It was, Dane noted with satisfaction, the laugh of someone who, like him, was impressed with a good game.

*

"Rafe, did you hear this?" Brigitte yelled, after smiling for a moment. Dane slid himself from Brigitte's ass and rested on his knees. "Apparently our American friends are less game than we thought."

Brigitte smiled at Dane, who was too fucked-out to sort out what Brigitte had meant by that, or by the next thing she said. "Or more," she purred to him in a low voice.

Dane heard a grunt from the living room. He couldn't see Rafe's face from where he was sitting, but the grunt sounded friendly, and he could see Rafe slap Emma's hip playfully, two quick swats. Rafe said something in Spanish and Brigitte let out a squeal of laughter, but neither one of them looked like they had any intention of translating it.

Brigitte had dropped her legs and sat up now, her skin sliding on the cum that welled from inside of her ass. She rested on her wrists as she sat up, legs to either side of Dane, her pulsing pussy spread open for him. "Well," she said, looking him up and down. "Is that all you have in you? Or are we going to have some fun?"

Dane's cock was still semi-hard, and he took it in his left hand to stroke it back to life as Brigitte watched him, while tugging on the retractable wall to pull it back into its recess and open up the rooms to each other.

Emma was lying on the couch on her side, to the left of Rafe, her legs draped over his lap, her hair sweaty and strewn across the pillows. She met Dane's eyes, and her mouth was in a loose smile of satisfaction, but she also looked a little stunned and vacant. It was clear that before his arrival, Rafe

had used her quite a bit: her lips were puffy and no lipstick remained on them, her mascara had streaked one cheek, and every part of her body glistened with some kind of fluid: sweat, tears, cum, saliva.

"It's Emma's call," Dane said, still moving his left hand on his shaft.

Rafe grinned at him and patted Emma's hip as his eyes dropped down to her ass. His thumb dropped behind her and Emma squirmed as Rafe stroked her somewhere in her crack. "I think our little *puta* can take some more, can't you, Emma?"

Emma's eyes, half-closed, went wide suddenly. Rafe clearly had slipped his thumb into her ass and was fucking her gently with it. Her hole slurped wetly around his digit. Emma's body rocked slightly, but she didn't make a sound.

"She's nice and lubed up now," Rafe said.

Brigitte reached for Dane's cock, and enclosed it in her fingers. "We all know Emma can take a lot of cock," she purred. She pulled slightly on his dick as she folded her legs under her and leaned toward him, using her magical gracefulness to come to sitting on her knees, still holding his dick in her hand.

"I want to watch her take some more," Brigitte said breathlessly, looking over at Emma and licking her upper teeth in her predatory way.

She stood up and walked over to the couch, cum snaking down her thighs as she walked. Dane remained where he was, unsure of what Brigitte's plan was or how Emma would react to it.

But this had been the gamble, the excitement of their plan.

As Brigitte approached, Rafe rolled Emma's legs, forcing Emma to turn her whole body and lie on her stomach. Emma's eyes met Dane's, but her expression remained the same: exhausted, a little vacant. Yet he knew that she had a safe word with Rafe, and she knew that she could stop things if she wanted to. Instead, she let Rafe push her knees to the side so that her ass moved up into the air, with her shins resting across his lap.

Brigitte plopped onto the couch next to Rafe and kissed him, before climbing onto her knees, facing Emma's ass.

Brigitte put a finger to Emma's hole before looking over at Dane. "You should really see how big this gap is," she said. She ran her finger along the edge of Emma's asshole while Emma mewled and squeezed her eyes shut, her mouth falling open slightly. Dane could see Rafe's cock

swelling and twitching back to life, grazing Emma's thighs. He tugged it and let it slap against her right leg with a wet smack.

Brigitte gave Dane a smile and then leaned down, putting her face close to Emma's ass. Her pink tongue left her mouth and swirled the rim of Emma's gaping, bubbling asshole. Emma mewled again. Brigitte made several passes around her rim, flicked her tongue in and out of the hole, and then plunged her face into Emma's ass and began to eat her out, hands clasped around her butt.

Rafe's hand went to Brigitte's head, resting lightly on the back of it. The glugging sounds from Emma's ass were filthy and wet, and went on for several minutes as Emma started to squirm and turned her face to the couch to make a sound Dane had never heard her make into the cushions.

Brigitte traced her tongue around Emma's rim again as she finished off, putting on a spectacular show of plunging into her a few more times with her long, whipping tongue.

"Are you ready for more cock now, Emma?" Brigitte asked her. She rose to her knees and dipped a finger in Emma's ass. "I want to watch you take it again."

Emma turned her face toward the dining room again and howled something incomprehensible.

Brigitte stood up, still watching Emma's ass, and looked over at Dane before moving to the end of the couch where Emma's head was resting. She climbed over the arm of the couch and put her feet on either side of Emma's head. Then she bent forward to push Emma up to her hands and knees, while Rafe scooted out from under Emma's shins.

Brigitte pulled Emma toward her by the back of her head, and Emma walked on her hands and knees until her face was between Brigitte's legs. Brigitte slid one hand between her legs to spread her cunt open with her fingers for Emma. She pulled Emma's face toward her, and Dane heard the sound of Emma's tongue lapping at Brigitte's soaked cunt, even though he couldn't see it because of her thigh.

Rafe was positioning himself behind Emma, holding his cock in his hand, stroking it casually. He dropped one hand to draw some juices from Emma's cunt up to her asshole, and then he dipped a finger inside of her and felt around. "I hope you didn't clean her ass out too good," he said, staring at his fingers. Then he turned to Dane. "This is the third time," he told him. "I'm going to be fucking her for a long time."

He lined the fat crown of his dick up with Emma's hole. With a slurp, her ass closed around him, and Emma whimpered into Brigitte's pussy as he sank inside of her.

"Keep licking," Brigitte coaxed, pushing against her head. "He's going to fuck you nice and slow as long as you keep licking my pussy."

Rafe made good on this promise, drawing his cock inch by torturous inch from Emma's ass, then slowly sinking back inside of her, while Emma diligently ate out Brigitte. It went on for a long time, until Brigitte's head tipped back, and her jaw fell slightly open. She pressed Emma's face to her and tangled her fingers in Emma's hair to shake her head violently against her snatch.

As Brigitte moaned in ecstasy and came, shaking Emma's face against her cunt in sloppy jerks, Rafe picked up the pace and began to hammer Emma. His thighs slapped against the back of her legs, and his cock thrust deep inside of her.

Brigitte reached her own satisfaction and pushed Emma away from her. She watched Emma for a moment as Rafe fucked her mercilessly, then Brigitte's eyes shifted up to her husband's cock slamming into Emma's asshole.

Rafe thrust and finally, just when Dane was wondering how much more Emma could take, his fingers dug into her hips and he thrust so hard it looked like Emma might split. She howled, and Rafe groaned loudly as his seed poured into her ass, leaking from the sides with wet gurgles.

Brigitte let Emma rest her cheek on her thigh, and she ran her fingers through her hair as Rafe slid his cock from inside of her. Rafe grinned at Dane, who was already standing up, going to take his turn.

"Emma," he said, not sure if she could take any more.

Brigitte pushed Emma's hair from her face and stroked her cheek, smiling. "What do you think, Emma darling, can you take another cock?" Brigitte looked up at Dane. "She can. No, Emma?" Brigitte shrugged. "She is not using this safe word."

Rafe collapsed in a chair to watch. Emma was inert, her head lying on Brigitte's thigh. Her gaping ass was red and stretched, an ooze of Rafe's white cum spewing from it as it pulsed closed.

Dane guided his cock to her hole, and when Emma did nothing more than let her mouth fall open, he slid into her.

Her ring barely squeezed him before stretching wide again, the rubbery grip of it relaxing almost immediately. Cum belched from around his cock as he sank into her hot, quivering channel like cutting through butter.

Dane looked up to see Brigitte staring at his cock sinking into Emma, who made a low, strangled noise. Brigitte bit her lip, her eyes lighting up salaciously. Her eyes dropped to Emma's face and she stroked her hair slowly. "Her ass is so sore, but she likes it."

Emma's ass was so full of cum that even though it was tightly closed around his cock, there was not enough friction as he sawed into her slowly to make him come for a few, long minutes. Emma's eyes closed, and then opened again, and he felt her squirm as he moved inside of her. Incredibly, it seemed that she would come again if he helped her.

He leaned over her and slid his right hand into her spurting, swollen gash. He found her clit, which felt foreign to his touch because she was so engorged. Her whole body shuddered when he stroked it, and her ass squeezed around him. He plunged deep inside and focused on her clit, rubbing it furiously as Emma's body went stiff and jerked, and she turned her face into Brigitte's thigh and bit the inside of it.

Brigitte smiled with satisfaction when Emma screamed into her flesh. Her ass squeezed tightly around Dane's cock. He fingered her until she was screeching and trying to move away from his fingers. Then he began to fuck her, hammering her in wet spurts until his own orgasm gripped him and his cum filled her again. Semen squirted from the sides of his dick and belched from inside of her as he hammered his final squirts home.

*

"So," Brigitte said, looking at Rafe, arching an eyebrow. "Who wins, then?"

Dane stroked Emma's thighs as his wife's eyes fluttered open, but she was too tired and too listless to pay attention to the conversation. Her heavy lids closed as her mouth opened to say something, but no sound left her lips.

Dane looked at Rafe, who was smiling, grinning. His hand dropped to his pants, which were crumpled next to the chair. He fished something out of the pocket and tossed it to Brigitte, who caught it expertly.

It was a box of cigarettes, and Brigitte took one out along with a lighter. Dane vaguely thought of telling Brigitte there was no smoking in the house, but it seemed ludicrous now, so he leaned his head back and watched her light her cigarette.

She blew the smoke carelessly and then glanced at Dane, smiling. "I guess it is a tie, *cherie*. I did not suspect our American friends, do you know?"

Dane looked from Brigitte to Rafe. "A tie?" He cleared his throat. "What's this?"

Brigitte shrugged and took another drag of her cigarette. She was sitting casually, with her legs crossed, totally naked, as though she were at a party in a cocktail dress. "Rafe and me, we had a bet, when we thought you were just a... *quel est ce mot?*"

Rafe lifted his fingers in exasperation. "*Quel mot?*"

"This... *malchanceux*..."

"Unadventurous," Rafe offered.

Brigitte looked annoyed and spat at him in rapid French, which made him laugh.

"Unlucky," Brigitte said. "No... happen... happenstance? Oh, *merde*..."

"Hapless," Dane offered.

"Yes," Brigitte said excitedly, temporarily delighted, then suddenly blasé. "When you were this *hapless* couple. We made a bet, which one of us could get to you first. And then, when we realized you were playing a game of your own, it was most unexpected. We changed the bet."

Dane looked at her.

"I am flexible," she told him.

Dane laughed. "You certainly are. What did you change it to?"

Brigitte's mouth flickered with another devious smile. "It was something like... what we could get you to do. It was not very official." She took another drag of her cigarette.

Dane shook his head. "Dare I ask what you get if you win?"

Brigitte looked at him pointedly and gave him another, very French, shrug. "Satisfaction?" she said, as if he were an idiot.

"But now," she said, "I think this is..." She looked at Rafe. "I don't know, a victory?... for our American friends?"

She finished this with something in French, which made Rafe say something in agreement.

Brigitte stood up and walked to the dining room, putting her cigarette out on a small plate that she seemed to have known was there all along and planned to use for that purpose. She scooped her dress up and lifted it over her head. "So, what now, cowboys? You are coming to our place, no?"

Her eyes were laughing as she said this, and Dane regretted that he was already saying, "I think Emma is probably done..." before he realized that Brigitte knew this already.

She winked at him. Rafe was standing up, pants in hand, looking around at the floor for his shirt. He shrugged and reached down to squeeze Emma's foot, then walked over to Brigitte, who scooped the shirt Dane had "borrowed" from the floor.

"This one is yours," she told Rafe, holding it out. She looked at Dane. "I still have yours somewhere. Maybe we meet up sometime for a hostage exchange?"

There was something of a smile beneath the expression on her face, but she had reverted to her unflappable French persona, and was already turning to leave as though she either expected no answer or didn't care what it was.

"*Ciao, Emma,*" Rafe said, shirt in hand. He gave Dane a chin jut, and they walked out of the house. Brigitte's giggle lilted through the open window from the pool area.

Emma was already practically asleep, so Dane scooped her up and carried her to the upstairs bedroom. There would be plenty of time for them to enjoy their "victory" later.

CHAPTER 7

"So," the voice said, and Dane turned to see Brigitte pouring herself into the barstool next to him. She was wearing a loose, low-cut black blouse and a pair of tan pants that clung to her so tightly it was almost possible to believe she was naked from the waist down. Her long hair was tamer than usual, and she had applied a bit of sultry mascara. Matching jewelry and expensive-looking shoes converted her from her sexy beach-goddess from to a sexy, almost business-like Parisian. "This is not hapless now, but happenstance?"

Emma's eyes went wide and she almost choked on her drink. She brought her hand to her mouth and looked around quickly for Rafe, who was at the end of the bar ordering a drink from the busy bartender and having a genial conversation with him in Spanish. Rafe looked like Rafe always did: wolfish.

"What...?" Emma said.

"Everyone comes through this airport after all, no matter where they are going," Brigitte said. "But it is quite a... coincidence... that we are here at the same time."

Emma lifted her drink to her mouth as Rafe made his way to their end of the bar and slid a wine toward Brigitte, who scowled as he said something to her in French. He leaned against the bar and sipped his own drink, which looked like a whiskey, but Dane somehow suspected it was not.

"Small world," Dane commented.

Rafe lifted his drink to toast him without comment.

"So what do you think, you will come back again? Perhaps some other hapless couple will wander onto the island?" Brigitte purred. "I think we are, how do you say this, well-suited for the *Caza*."

Rafe lifted his drink to his lips and winked at Emma, who seemed confused and tipped her head to the side.

An announcement came over the PA system, and Brigitte sighed, setting her wine down. Rafe shot his drink, and Brigitte removed a piece of paper casually from somewhere, the same mysterious vortex from which she materialized cigarettes and lighters.

"You have a pen," she asked-told the bartender, who had stopped to stare unabashedly at her. He fumbled for the one behind his ear looking like he would willingly stab himself with it if Brigitte were to ask or tell him to do that next.

She scrawled on the paper with her squarish French script. "You should call us if you come for holidays, next time. This property you stayed at, we are friends with the owner. We can get you a discount."

Emma's mouth fell open. Dane laughed and swept the paper up. Brigitte, whose tone had been thoroughly French and blasé as she said all of this, kissed Dane on the cheek hurriedly, and began speaking rapid French to Rafe, who was now seated expressionlessly and appeared disinterested in moving.

He stood up at last, stretched, winked again at Emma. "Who knows? Maybe we will find some more fun game."

And the two were off without so much as a goodbye.

Dane looked at Emma, who was shaking her head. "Jesus," she finally said. "I don't know what to make of that."

Dane sipped his drink.

"Why are they always calling it '*casa*'?" she mused aloud, after a long pause. "I thought it was *caza*."

The bartender was standing in front of them. "*Casa*," he said.

"No, yeah, *casa*, that means 'house,'" Emma said. "But we went to *Isla Cazzza*." She dragged out the "z" sound for emphasis.

"*Casa*," the bartender repeated. He poured Emma another drink and set it in front of her with a smile. "*Casa, caza*, they say the same way. No *zeta* in Spanish." He made a "z" in the air with his finger.

"Oh," Emma said. "Okay... so what does '*caza*,' with a 'z' mean then? I actually never thought to ask."

Dane had his phone out and was looking it up already.

"This is like a... uh... what is the word... when you shoot at ducks, bang-bang," the bartender was saying.

Dane smiled, turning the phone to Emma. Emma's eyes scanned the screen quickly, and when they reached the final entry, her eyes went narrow with the satisfied shape they took on whenever she solved a puzzle or remembered something. Then she rolled them.

She brought the small straw in her drink to her lips and chewed on it thoughtfully.

"Well," she said at last. "Those were some pretty hilarious plays on words."

caza([kah-sah](#))
[feminine noun](#)

1. (act of hunting)

a. [hunting](#)

b. [shooting](#)

2. (pursuit)

a. [hunt](#)

b. [game](#)

Readers:

I have a request.

Please, please, if you leave a review (which I greatly appreciate), don't spoil the twist or the wordplay in this book. I think it will take a lot of the fun out of it for other readers. I still haven't forgiven the person who ruined The Sixth Sense for me (who also happens to be the person who ruined No Way Out for me). Not that I am comparing the relatively mild twist here to either of those (totally ruined) masterpieces, but still...

Thanks for your support, as always, and I hope you enjoyed the story.

END

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